PROGRESS REPORT

Legislation and regulation: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-10-14 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

54 countries. Each row below is carried verbatim from that country's own progress report, which answers a fixed frame of indicators over the period; nothing is written here. A country not listed under an indicator has **No evidence** *on it in its own report.*

DATA PROTECTION LEGISLATION · CYBERSECURITY LEGISLATION · LEGISLATION COVERING DIGITAL ID · DIGITAL PAYMENTS LEGISLATION · LEGISLATION ENABLING DATA INTEROPERABILITY · AI LEGISLATION / REGULATIONS · E-COMMERCE LEGISLATION · STATISTICS LEGISLATION · ACCESS TO INFORMATION LEGISLATION

Progress values. *Movement* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Movement, regulations still pending*.

Data protection legislation

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	Law 18-07 stands as amended, its officer and breach-notification duties added by the 2025 amendment. The law was enacted in 2018 and in force from August 2023, and the 2025 amendment added data-protection-officer and breach-notification duties. Nothing amended it further in the window. What moved is enforcement practice rather than the statute: the authority ran a compliance push on officers, processing registers and audit logs, and issued a deliberation treating images as personal data - both under a law whose own text the base does not hold.	NO CHANGE
Angola	The 2011 law stands unamended; a revision closed consultation while an amendment opening electoral data was rejected. The standing instrument has been in force since 17 June 2011, with consent and notification duties, sensitive-data limits and transfer approvals. Three of its provisions matter more than its fines: article 35(6) substitutes a statute or decree for the regulator's authorisation, article 24 does the same for database interconnection, and article 4(2)(a) puts processing under state-secrecy, state-security and judicial-secrecy rules outside the law altogether. 2026-06-17 — public consultation closed on a revision adding a data-protection officer duty for high-volume processors, stronger oversight and sanction mechanisms, and fines redenominated into local currency, due at the Council of Ministers and then the National Assembly. No draft text is held. 2026-06-25 — parliament rejected in plenary an amendment that would have opened the citizen databases and the electoral registers to parties and citizens, after it had cleared committee in April. The registers stay closed.	MIXED a revision consultation closed while an amendment opening electoral data was rejected

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Benin	The digital code's data-protection provisions stand; the authority enforcing them had its membership renewed on 1 July 2026. The operative instrument is the 2021 data-protection law and nothing in the period amended it. 2026-07-01 — what did move is the body that applies it: new members were designated to the data-protection authority. A recomposition is not a change in the law, which is why this reads as no change.	NO CHANGE the statute stands and its authority was recomposed
Botswana	The 2024 Data Protection Act has been in force since January 2025, repealing a 2018 Act that never commenced; what moved in the window is enforcement. The Act came into force on 14 January 2025, repealing a 2018 statute that was never commenced. It did not change in the window. What changed is that it began to bite. The commission that had three contract officers, no premises, no published address and no website in July 2025 issued a determination and enforcement notice against a government directorate in July 2026, reported under the authority below. The one amendment in prospect is the localisation duty reported under policy, which has no draft. No implementing regulations, codes of practice or approved-country list appear on this ledger. 2021-10-15 - the commencement instrument is now held in full: Statutory Instrument 86 of 2021 brought the Data Protection Act No. 32 of 2018 into operation on publication on 15 October 2021. It dates the regime the base had been carrying from its 2024 re-enactment.	NO CHANGE
Burkina Faso	A new data protection law was voted on 3 August 2026 awaiting promulgation, after the 2021 statute ran five years without its enforcement decrees. 2026-08-03 — the legislative assembly voted a new law prohibiting and sanctioning processing without consent, indexing administrative fines to turnover and scaling them by gravity, prohibiting transfer of sensitive data abroad, requiring prior consent for commercial prospecting, and leaving private video-surveillance lawful but framed where it faces the public highway, reported the same day. No text, number or gazette reference is held and it must clear conformity review before promulgation. Until then the 2021 law remains the operative text, and it ran its whole life without teeth: the commission was still pleading with the Prime Minister for the implementing decrees in March 2025, and they were never issued in the five years the law ran. The lesson the new law has to answer is its predecessor's: a statute with sanctions and no implementing machinery is not an enforcement regime, and publication of the decrees, or their express abrogation, would settle it.	MOVEMENT
Burundi	A personal data protection law was unanimously adopted on 15 January 2026: eight chapters, an independent authority and criminal penalties, where no statute existed. 2026-01-15 — the National Assembly unanimously adopted a personal data protection law with eight chapters, an independent supervisory authority and criminal penalties, aligned to the African Union convention, reported the following day as the country's first such statute. No statute existed before it. The sequencing is stated by the government itself: legislation came first in order to enable the biometric identity card, which is reported under digital identity and is technically ready but waiting on its own instrument. The authority the law creates is not on record as operating, reported below.	MOVEMENT
Cameroon	Loi n. 2024/017 on personal data protection is in force and unamended, with no supervisory authority operating. The law was promulgated on 23 December 2024 and is in force, with no supervisory authority operating, a position restated to the National Assembly in April 2025. Nothing in the window amended it. The promulgated text was acquired in July 2026 and is held as a 24-page page-image scan of which pages 15 to 24 are unread, so what the statute obliges beyond its first half is not established from anything on file.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cape Verde	Lei 133/V/2001 is unamended in the window, last changed in 2021 to require designation of data-protection officers. The general regime closely mirrors the European standard, with administrative fines of CVE 50,000 to 3,000,000, cessation, blocking and deletion measures and criminal penalties up to two years, amended in 2013 to create the commission and in 2021 to require designation of data-protection officers. No amendment is recorded in the window. A named analyst argued in April 2025 for aligning it with artificial intelligence and adding mechanisms for algorithmic supervision; no bill is held. The commission's president said in February 2025 that several institutions had not complied with the officer obligation.	NO CHANGE
Central African Republic	The data protection law has been in force since January 2024 with no implementing decree, and none appeared in the window. The law was promulgated in January 2024 as a comprehensive regime with no supervisory authority and no implementing decree, and that remains the position. The held text is a scan with a poor character layer, so its wording is legible and individual characters are not reliable. Nothing moved it in the twelve months to 2026-08-26: no decree, no amendment and no first application. The authority the law creates is reported below and does not exist either, so a comprehensive statute has been in force for nineteen months with neither the rules nor the body needed to apply it.	NO CHANGE
Chad	No general data-protection law or supervisory authority exists, the function having been folded into the security agency, while a law on biometric data in judicial procedures was adopted by 138 votes to 1. There is no enacted text, number or gazette reference for a general data-protection law, and the function was folded into the security agency in March 2026 (vacuum, finalisation). The biometric-data law was adopted at a plenary in April 2026. Its gazetted text is not held, so retention periods, destruction procedure, oversight body and any requirement of judicial authorisation are unknown, and deputies raised concerns in debate about inappropriate use (law). Legislating the collection of biometric data for judicial use before legislating data protection at all is the sequence, and it is the reverse of the order every other unit in this frame attempts.	MIXED a biometric-data law adopted by 138 votes to 1 while no general data-protection statute or authority exists at all
Comoros	The 2021 data protection law is in force, aligned to the European regulation, with the national authority still not constituted. The law was enacted on 29 June 2021, is extraterritorial, requires seventy-two-hour breach notification and a mandatory data-protection officer and carries full data-subject rights, with the national authority not constituted. Nothing moved. The authority's non-existence was restated in a procurement notice of 12 March 2026. The statute is held only through an analyst review and is cited as analysis; its own text is not held, so what a Comorian controller must actually do is not checkable from anything on file.	NO CHANGE
Congo	Loi n. 29-2019 remains in force, its institutional framework completed by a decree of 31 December 2025. The law was promulgated on 10 October 2019 and stood in force at the window's opening with an incomplete institutional framework and no supervisory authority constituted; a decree of 31 December 2025 completed that framework. The statute itself did not move. Its text is not held, and its number and date reach the base only through a secondary outlet's account of the commission's first session, so what it obliges a controller to do is not checkable from anything on file - including whether registration or notification is required at all.	NO CHANGE
Cote d'Ivoire	Loi n 2013-450 remains in force and unamended, with the telecommunications regulator confirmed as the data-protection authority. The law has stood since 19 June 2013, designating the telecommunications regulator as the data-protection authority, and was confirmed in that role after the cyber agency's creation. Nothing in the window amended it. The base holds no text of the law and no implementing decree, so what it obliges a data controller to do is not checkable from anything on file, and the simplified norms the minister names as an advance rest on the same unheld basis.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Djibouti	The data-protection regime sits inside the Digital Code at 156 articles, with none of its obligations evidenced in operation. The regime is in force within the Digital Code across 156 articles, providing for seventy-two-hour breach notification, mandatory data-protection officers and a public register, and none is evidenced in operation. Alongside it a tiered prior-authorisation regime for national-identifier and biometric processing is in force, with no authorisation on record for the police body-camera fleet. Nothing amended either in the window: what changed is what is being processed under them, not the law.	NO CHANGE
DR Congo	The Digital Code is now enforced on the state's own initiative, prosecutors instructed to open cases without a complaint. The 2023 framework law was in force at the window's opening, its third book governing personal data, with no data-protection authority operational. 2026-08-17 - the attorney general at the Court of Cassation instructed judicial police officers to open Digital Code cases on their own initiative and forward them for summary hearing, and the audiovisual regulator's president is contemplating closing a video platform outright after it did not act on a request to block more than 2,000 accounts. The enforcement now running is criminal rather than regulatory: the law's personal-data book has no supervisor, so what has moved is prosecution under it, not protection through it.	MOVEMENT
Egypt	The 2020 data-protection law was operationalised by Executive Regulations issued on 1 November 2025, enforceable from 1 November 2026. The Regulations were issued by ministerial decree on 1 November 2025 and circulated in December, establishing the approvals model, a separate licence for each cross-border transfer specifying destination, purpose, data categories and safeguards, extra approvals for electronic marketing and certain public-space surveillance, registered data-protection officers, and breach notification within seventy-two hours to the regulator and three business days to affected individuals. The obligations become enforceable from 1 November 2026 at the end of a one-year grace period. The Regulations' own text is not held. 2026-09-05 - the regulations went to the market before they bite: the ministry's investment conference of 7 September 2026 carried a session on them alongside ICT investment, artificial intelligence and startup finance, seven weeks before the grace period closes. No guidance, decision or licence issued under them is on the record.	MOVEMENT
Equatorial Guinea	Ley 1/2016 has been in force since August 2016, giving rights of access, rectification, cancellation and opposition and a sanctions regime to CFA 15,000,000. It was gazetted on 22 July 2016 and took effect twenty days later (the law). Ten years on, no implementing decree, guidance or enforcement action under it is held, and the country signed the continental convention on the same subject only in July 2026.	NO CHANGE
Eritrea	A verification pass dated August 2026 confirms no comprehensive data-protection law in force (redetermination). A dated redetermination as of 1 August 2026 confirms the position is unchanged: no comprehensive data-protection law in force, no supervisory authority established and no enforcement decisions published (redetermination). A regional ministerial assessment places Eritrea's data-protection policy area at a nascent stage without legislation or regulatory oversight, grouped with Djibouti, South Sudan and Sudan against neighbours that have enacted frameworks with supervisory authorities (policy matrix). A trade regulatory profile records that Eritrea lacks a comprehensive legal framework for data protection, with no data-protection officer, impact-assessment or retention requirements (profile). This is a searched absence rather than an unexamined one: three independent assessments across four years agree.	NO CHANGE
Eswatini	The Data Protection Act 2022 has been effective since March 2022, and its gazetted text names a Commission while the regulator describes itself as the designated Agency. The Act was gazetted and took effect on 4 March 2022. The mismatch between the body the statute names and the body describing itself as designated is recorded rather than resolved (Act). The Act is being read in press accounts as exposing online naming and shaming to a substantial penalty; that is an account of legal exposure rather than an enforcement action, and no complaint, ruling or authority statement is held (exposure). A statute whose enforcing body is ambiguous on the face of the record is a limit on everything the protection cells below can say.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Ethiopia	Proclamation 1321/2024 has been in force since July 2024, a comprehensive regime with extraterritorial reach and no secondary directives behind it. The proclamation took effect on 24 July 2024 as a comprehensive personal data regime reaching beyond the country's borders (Proclamation 1321/2024). What the base does not hold is any instrument under it: the directives that would give the proclamation operative content were still unissued a year after commencement (a year on).	NO CHANGE
Gabon	Loi n 025/2023 has bound from publication on 15 July 2023, with article 219 setting no grace period and no transitional window. The statute was published in the gazette of 15 July 2023 and took effect at once, article 219 allowing no transition (Loi n 025/2023). It repeals contrary prior provisions of the 2020 ordinance, and the base does not establish whether the funding levy that ordinance created was carried forward (the 2020 ordinance). The gazetted text of the founding 2011 statute is not held, so the earlier baseline is read only through the amending instruments.	NO CHANGE
Gambia	The Personal Data Protection and Privacy Act 2025 was enacted after several stalled years, with extraterritorial scope and seven lawful bases. It carries a sensitive-data regime covering genetic, biometric and health data, and rights of access, rectification, erasure and protection from solely automated decisions (review). Passage was in October 2025 (passage). No implementing regulation, commencement notice or first enforcement action under it is held, and the commission that would supervise it is not separately constituted on the record.	MOVEMENT
Ghana	The Data Protection Act 2012 is in force and unamended, with a 125-section draft replacement that would repeal it outright not enacted. The 2012 statute remains the sole general data-protection law, reaching controllers and processors rather than the data-broker layer an operator names as the source of leaks (the Act). The replacement is held in full: 125 sections establishing a Data Protection Authority and repealing the 2012 Act, so the Commission constituted under it would go with the statute. It carries no month within 2025 and no commencement date. Fourteen years after commencement the base holds no amendment, no commencement instrument for a successor and no parliamentary timetable.	NO CHANGE
Guinea	The 2016 cybersecurity and data-protection statute covers processing by individuals, firms and public institutions, and is held only as an image scan. The agency publishes it as a 57-page image-only scan with no text layer, so its provisions are the agency's summary rather than the statute's own words, and no promulgation date is published (the statute). It reached the base through a summit profile rather than through the gazette (profile). No implementing decree, supervisory authority, registration duty or enforcement action under its data-protection half is held.	NO CHANGE
Guinea-Bissau	The transitional council ratified the African Union, Budapest and United Nations conventions in May 2026. Domestic protection has rested on the regional supplementary act on personal data protection since 2010, with the national policy still in development. The window's movement is treaty ratification rather than a statute: the transitional national council ratified the African Union, Budapest and United Nations conventions in May 2026, having signed the United Nations convention at Hanoi in October 2025. No domestic data protection act has been passed.	MOVEMENT
Kenya	The 2019 Act is in force, and a court awarded eleven petitioners KES 900,000 each for a sustained compromise of subscriber data. The regulator is now stretching the Act's cross-border-transfer duties to reach offshore artificial-intelligence processing (the Act, quality standards). The judgment of 13 May 2026 found a sustained and systematic compromise; the telco is not named in the account held and the judgment text is not on file (judgment). On the receiving side, 15 of 224 betting and gaming firms were fully registered as both controller and processor, with 185 unregistered and given 40 days or licence cancellation, and no follow-up is on file after the deadline expired (registration ultimatum). The gambling regulator has an open investigation into three licensees, with the criminal investigations directorate requesting its entire record back to 2018 — the first move against recipients of leaked subscriber data rather than the leakers (investigation).	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Lesotho	The Data Protection Act 2011 remains in force and unamended, on the most recent account held, dated March 2026. The Act has been in force since 2011 and was recorded as unamended as at 23 March 2026 (review). No amendment, regulation or commencement instrument has been published since, and the base holds no enforcement action, complaint count or guidance issued under it.	NO CHANGE
Liberia	The Personal Information Act was signed into force on 19 August 2026, with no authority yet existing to administer it. It had been referred to a House committee in June 2025 and left unpassed, drafted with a media-development organisation under a European programme and validated in December 2024 (signature, committee stage). The base holds no authority, commencement order, registration regime or enforcement route under it, so what a data subject can actually do with it is unestablished. The country is a regional data-protection signatory and had until this month struggled to enforce privacy law at all (enforcement position).	MOVEMENT
Libya	No data-protection statute is in force; the National Artificial Intelligence Strategy sets 2026 as the target for one, with nothing enacted by August. The strategy published in October 2025 names a data-protection law among its 2026 deliverables (strategy). Nothing had been enacted as at 10 August 2026, and the base holds no draft text, no sponsoring ministry and no parliamentary stage for it. Personal-data systems have meanwhile continued to be built and launched without one.	NO CHANGE
Madagascar	The data-protection law of 2014 has been in force since January 2015 and is recorded as unenforced. The law is in force and unenforced, and excludes part of journalistic practice from its scope (law). Eleven years on, no amendment, implementing decree, enforcement action or guidance under it is held, and the supervisory body it provides for has never been constituted.	NO CHANGE
Malawi	The Data Protection Act 2024 exempted most controllers for twenty-four months from commencement, and that exemption elapsed in early June 2026. The Act commenced in June 2024 with the regulator designated data protection authority, and exempted controllers and processors not of significant importance from compliance for twenty-four months, so most of the economy sat outside its obligations (Act). The general exemption elapsed in early June 2026 so that all controllers and processors are now within scope, while the subsidiary instruments to operate registration and enforcement were still in draft (compliance, terms of reference). The commencement day cannot be settled from this base: the circulating expiry date implies a 2 June 2024 commencement and the commencement notice is not held.	MOVEMENT grace period elapsed
Mali	The personal data protection law of 2013 has been in force since May 2013 as amended, and is the stated basis for the authority's sanctions. The statute is in force and the data-protection authority cites it as the basis on which it fines and issues formal notices (law). No amendment, implementing decree or consolidated text has entered the base since, so what can be established here is that the law is used rather than what it now says.	NO CHANGE
Mauritania	The data protection law has been in force since July 2017, requiring approved codes of conduct and free, unambiguous consent, with no enforcement decision published. The statute covers both manual and electronic processing and requires codes of conduct approved by the authority and free, unambiguous consent (law). The authority runs monthly ordinary meetings and sensitisation days for ministries, telecom operators and financial institutions, and no enforcement decision, register entry, sanction or annual report is published (authority). The held extraction of the law cuts off mid-article, so the chapters covering the authority's powers and sanctions are not captured.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mauritius	Data Protection Officer Regulations were promulgated in June 2026 for January 2027, while the Data Protection Act 2017 is not among the fifty-eight Acts the omnibus amends. The regulations formalise designation, qualifications, independence and reporting duties for data protection officers across public and private sectors, with a six-month compliance window (regulations). Amendments to the Act itself were committed in July 2026 with no text, timetable or introduction date (commitment), and the Act is not among the fifty-eight statutes the omnibus bill amends (bill). The year's expanded inter-agency data sharing therefore arrives with no matching safeguards amendment (assessment).	MIXED officer regulations promulgated while the Act itself was left out of an omnibus amending fifty-eight statutes
Morocco	Law 09-08 has been in force since 2009, and the regulator states on the record that a recast is now in the legislative circuit. The commission's president stated in August 2026 that a recast developed with the justice ministry has been sent to the government's general secretariat, describing it as clarification rather than replacement (statement, account). No transmission date or text is held (framework bill). The statute's own text and gazette reference are not held either, nor any amending instrument, and a 2023 amendment survives only as an analyst's attributed statement (guide).	MOVEMENT
Mozambique	The personal data protection bill was being prepared for submission to parliament in August 2026, with no text, timetable or tabling date published. Civil society argued at a round table on the draft data protection law that the country needs greater national capacity to store and process strategic, sensitive and personal data in infrastructure under its own jurisdiction (round table). The agency's president stated in August 2026 that the draft is being prepared for submission; the Cabinet submission planned for June 2026 is not on record (statement). An independent review of the proposed law was published in September 2025 (review), and the government was recorded as preparing it in July 2026 (preparation). Until it passes, the country's data rules are scattered across a constitutional article, the electronic transactions law, banking and labour statutes and a 2003 central-bank notice, with a ratified regional convention and no domestic statute giving effect to it.	MOVEMENT
Namibia	The Data Protection Bill has not been tabled about thirteen years after drafting began, and the March 2022 draft remains the last version published for comment. A tabling was announced for September 2025 (announcement, return) and the bill was still in finalisation in August 2026, with no data-protection statute in force (finalisation, concerns). The March 2022 revised draft runs to fifty-nine pages and eight Parts, with the supervisory authority at Part 2 (draft). The 2020 version carries a Part on rights of the data subject, together with Parts on recourse to the judicial authority and on offences and penalties, none of which appears in the 2022 version, where access and correction survive only as controller obligations (2020 version, removal).	STALLED
Niger	Loi 2022-59 on personal data protection has been in force since December 2022, replacing the 2017 statute and supplemented by a 2023 law. The statute replaced the 2017 law and is supplemented by a further 2023 law (law, predecessor). No amendment, implementing decree or enforcement record has entered the base since. It is the privacy backstop for a biometric identity programme now in mass enrolment, which is what makes the absence of a caseload figure material.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Nigeria	The Data Protection Act 2023 is in force with an amendment bill before the assembly, and the first damages award under it was made in July 2026. The Act is criticised as structurally weak in placing the commission under ministerial control, and its section 63 gives it primacy over any inconsistent law on personal-data processing; the federal government and the governors' forum have been urging states to implement it, which is an admission that the tier handling civil registration, health, education and land records is not yet compliant (Act, accountability). An amendment bill was introduced in July 2026 (bill). A court awarded ₦15m general damages, costs and post-judgment interest for marketing after consent was withdrawn, grounded on the Act, the constitutional privacy provision and the consumer-protection Act together; it held personal data must be erased on termination but refused wholesale deletion where statutory banking retention applies (judgment). 2026-09-03 - the commission opened validation of a data privacy framework for electronic commerce at an Abuja workshop run with the German development agency, following a private-sector session in Lagos. No draft text, scope, commencement date or enforcement route is published.	MOVEMENT
Rwanda	The data protection and privacy law has been fully in force since a two-year grace period ended in October 2023, and the Act's own text and law number are not held. The grace period ended on 15 October 2023, and the authority's framing of the period since is a year of accountability for controllers (law, expansion). Neither the Act's text nor its law number is held. What the base can say about the regime is therefore drawn from secondary accounts of it and from the appropriation lines that fund the supervisory authority.	NO CHANGE
Sao Tome and Principe	The 2016 personal data protection law is in force and establishes the national authority; it is modelled on a European directive Europe itself replaced in 2018. The gazette text is now held: the law guarantees and protects the personal data of natural persons and establishes the national personal data protection agency as supervisory authority (law). The capture is truncated inside Artigo 45, so the later articles are not readable here. A secondary legal survey records the modelling on the superseded European directive and the penalties, and remains the only source describing the regime's operation (survey). Modelling on a directive replaced in 2018 is the substantive point: the regime the authority enforces is a generation behind the standard its cooperation partners work to. The country is a signatory to the continental cyber and data convention, with ratification status not stated (convention).	NO CHANGE
Senegal	The personal data law of 2008 has stood eighteen years unamended, and a revision bill was taken to a two-day workshop to finalise it with its implementing decree. The law was promulgated in January 2008 and came into force in 2014, and no amending law is found. It did not move through the February 2026 breach of the national identity directorate (law, modernisation). A workshop was convened to finalise the revision bill and its implementing decree; the source is proxy-dated, so the workshop's own date is unknown and must not be rendered as July 2026 (bill). The national data strategy is the frame requiring the bill to be re-levelled, so the revision is being written to a strategy rather than to the breach.	MIXED a revision bill in finalisation while the law in force has stood eighteen years unamended through a breach of the identity directorate
Seychelles	The Data Protection Act 2023 is in force in full, its eighteen-month transition having elapsed, and it expressly recognises participation in a global cross-border privacy system. The Act commenced in December 2023 with an eighteen-month transition; that period has elapsed and controllers and processors are now subject to it in full (Act, force, review). A continental review adds that the Act expressly recognises participation in a global cross-border privacy rules system (reforms). A statute fully in force with an explicit cross-border interoperability provision puts this unit ahead of most in the frame on the law. What it lacks is recorded in the next cell.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sierra Leone	Cabinet authorised a Data Protection and Right to Access Information Bill in April 2026, and the country has had no data-protection law in force throughout the period. The Bill was finalised in November 2025 and Cabinet approved the policy and authorised the Bill on 21 April 2026 (bill, finalisation). No data-protection law has been in force at any point in the period. That is the frame for everything else in this unit: a biometric register covering most of the population, subscriber data disclosed to police, an identity migration in pilot and two competing identity platforms, all operating with no statutory data-protection regime behind them.	MOVEMENT
Somalia	A Data Protection Act has been in effect since March 2023, and a regulatory framework under it was approved by the Council of Ministers in January 2026 and adopted the following month. The Act has been in effect since 23 March 2023 and its implementing regulations were reviewed (Act). The regulatory framework was approved on 8 January 2026 and adopted in February (approval, adoption). A statute in force since 2023 with regulations adopted in 2026 and an authority taking its first nationwide enforcement step in June puts this country ahead of several larger units in this frame on the sequence, if not on capacity.	MOVEMENT
South Africa	The Act is unamended, but binding regulations on the processing of health information were gazetted in March 2026 and the regulator states it is working to amend the Act for AI and privacy by design. 2026-03-06 - the regulator gazetted final regulations on the processing of data subjects' health information by certain responsible parties, effective on publication and binding on confidentiality, integrity, availability and cross-border transfer. They are subordinate legislation under the Act rather than an amendment to it, and they are the one binding instrument the window produced. The statute itself did not move. What is on the record beyond the regulations is an intention: the regulator stated on 18 August 2026 that it is working with the justice department to amend the Act to cover artificial intelligence and privacy by design, and in the same session that it has no capability to test external systems for privacy compliance before launch. The Act's own terms are unchanged and its ceiling is low against the harm it addresses: five years on, the maximum fine remains R10m against an average measured breach cost several times that. No amendment Bill, gazette notice or draft text is held, so that half is a stated programme of work rather than a legislative step.	MIXED binding health-information regulations gazetted while the Act itself is unamended
South Sudan	No data-protection statute or commission exists, only a constitutional privacy right, and the minister states a bill will come after a policy bill drafted in October 2025. What stands is the Transitional Constitution's privacy article and nothing else: no statute and no commission as at August 2026 (absence). The minister stated in December 2025 that a bill will come in 2026, and a policy bill was drafted in October 2025 by a civil-society partnership (statement, feature, drafting). Meanwhile a biometric payroll register, a humanitarian biometric registration and a planned universal digital identity are all being built with no statute governing any of them.	MOVEMENT
Sudan	A draft Data and Artificial Intelligence Law is in redrafting with the digital transformation ministry, legislating data protection and artificial intelligence in one instrument. The draft went to the Council of Ministers with two others and was reported back in redrafting in August 2026 (draft, redrafting). Legislating data protection and artificial intelligence in a single instrument is a design few African states have attempted. Neither text is published, so what it would provide on lawful basis, consent, transfer or supervision cannot be stated. The authority that would enforce it already exists, created by decree ahead of the statute.	MOVEMENT
Tanzania	The Personal Data Protection Act, 2022 commenced in May 2023 with regulations in force, and practitioners record that key terms remain undefined and there is no adequacy mechanism for cross-border transfers. Practitioners record that security breach and without undue delay remain undefined, that there is no adequacy mechanism for cross-border transfers, and that there is no duty to notify data subjects (Act). Those three gaps bear directly on the rest of this unit: the identity register connects to more than 138 institutions, the social-media tax-credential rule publishes trader identifiers, and the financial consumer-protection regulations cross-reference this Act as their data basis.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Togo	A personal data protection law of ninety-seven articles was gazetted in October 2019, and what moved in the period is the base's holding of it rather than the instrument. The law was gazetted on 29 October 2019 and the gazette's own signature block is dated a day after the title date (law, implementation). The instrument did not move in the window. It is the statute that created the protection authority by an article rather than by a separate constitutive act, and it is the basis for the corporate correspondents programme recorded separately.	NO CHANGE
Tunisia	A draft organic law on personal data protection was deposited in July 2025 and reached committee hearings in February 2026, to replace the 2004 organic law still governing. The bill was deposited on 14 July 2025, referred to the rights and liberties committee two days later, and heard in committee in February 2026 (deposit, hearings, update). The tabled Arabic text is held from the Assembly's own dossier and its article count is settled from it at 132: a committee account giving 123 reads as a transposition whose six-part structure matches the tabled text section for section, and a third account's 32 is a leading-digit loss in optical transcription. Whether the committee has since shortened the bill is not established. The 2004 law was still the governing instrument when the replacement entered committee (law, rights).	MOVEMENT
Uganda	The Data Protection and Privacy Act is in force and the office's director stated a shortfall of some 35,000 unregistered controllers against a 50,000 estimate. The statute did not change; the estimate is the office's own and no prosecution outcome is held (shortfall, enforcement, decision, order). Registration at roughly three parts in ten of the office's own estimate of the controller population, three years into the regime, is what the enforcement record below has to be read against.	MOVEMENT
Zambia	The Data Protection Act 2021 is named as part of the operative framework, and a reported Cabinet repeal intent has produced nothing in sixteen months. The Act's number and year of enactment are not established beyond 2021, and the reported repeal intent has produced nothing on the record in sixteen months (framework, safeguards, freedom). A statute whose own enactment reference cannot be established, under a repeal intent that has produced nothing, is the legal basis under which the identity register, the health record and the refugee database all operate.	NO CHANGE
Zimbabwe	The Cyber and Data Protection Act was consolidated in 2022, and Statutory Instrument 155 of 2024 created a data-controller licensing regime a legal expert calls new and strange. The same Act establishes a cyber security centre and inserts a false-data-message offence into the criminal code (Act, overview). The statutory instrument was gazetted in September 2024 with licence applications due six months on; two outlets date the deadline to 12 March 2025 and the gazetted text's own reckoning gives 13 March, and an analyst expects the cost to reach consumers as dearer airtime and data (instrument, warning, fees). Two regulatory notices followed in 2026, neither published by the regulator itself: the first is reported with no signature date held (notice one), and the second sets inspections beginning 1 September 2026 (notice two).	MOVEMENT

Cybersecurity legislation

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	Decree 20-05 founds the national information systems security apparatus and its agency. The presidential decree signed on 20 January 2020 is the founding instrument of the national apparatus: it creates the national council for information systems security and the national agency that carries the work. The security referential the base already held names this decree without carrying its text, so the instrument behind the framework is now on the record rather than cited at one remove.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Angola	The National Assembly adopted the cybersecurity bill on 12 August 2026 by 104 votes to 56, with promulgation and entry into force not on file. 2026-08-12 — the National Assembly adopted the bill in plenary by 104 votes to 56 on a presidential initiative, the governing party for and the main opposition against with no abstentions, after committee approval on 4 August and passage in generality in January 2026. The text sets graduated administrative fines as multiples of the national minimum wage, from 7 to 70 for individuals on minor infractions and up to 500 for individuals and 4,000 for legal persons on the most serious. It also requires telecommunications operators to transmit any communication whose content is criminal or prejudicial to state security, which the opposition and part of civil society object to as leaving unclear which content qualifies and on what terms subscribers' personal data reaches the authorities, a year before the presidential election. No promulgation, gazette number or entry into force is on file. The vote followed a cyberattack on the incumbent operator and came days after the online-falsehoods law entered into force.	MOVEMENT
Benin	The digital code's cybersecurity provisions stand; the investigation centre reported its 2025 activity and an international operation ran in December 2025. The operative instrument is the digital code and nothing in the period amended it. 2025-12-19 — an international law-enforcement operation ran. 2026-01-16 — the national digital investigations centre published its 2025 activity report on online offences. Both are enforcement under the existing statute, which is why the legislative position reads as unchanged.	NO CHANGE the code stands and enforcement is reported against it
Botswana	The Cybersecurity Act was assented in November 2025 and gazetted, and was still not in force at the window's close, its stated April 2026 commencement having passed. 2025-11-05 — the Act was assented and gazetted on 11 November 2025, with commencement on notice, against a Bill only at the start of the window. Commencement was stated for April 2026 and that date passed with no notice on file. Section 3(2) excludes classified information held by eight security and revenue bodies. So the 2018 cybercrime statute remains the operative law, its repeal enacted and not commenced. The authority the Act creates is in the same position. It exists in law with a board, a chief executive, a licensing power over cybersecurity providers, a power to approve software before market placement and a critical-infrastructure mandate, and it is not established, with no organisation or vote in the year's estimates — an authority in law with no money at both the legal and the fiscal end.	MOVEMENT made and gazetted but not in force
Burkina Faso	Two application decrees were adopted on 30 July 2026, classifying critical-infrastructure bodies and fixing periodic audits and auditor accreditation under the 2024 security law. 2026-07-30 — the Council of Ministers adopted a decree identifying, classifying and setting obligations for critical-infrastructure bodies, defined as any entity housing installations indispensable to society's vital functions and expressly spanning energy, water, health, telecommunications and finance, and a second decree fixing conditions for periodic audits and vesting auditor accreditation in the national cyberspace control body. Before them the 2024 law asserted an auditor-accreditation duty with no procedure attached. Two things the decrees do not close. The accrediting body is named by function rather than by institution. And the technical approval and homologation regime for security products, provided by articles 7 and 9 of the law and carrying fines of FCFA 2m to 100m for importing or selling without approval, is still left to a regulation that has not been made. The mapping instrument lands just before the mass biometric enrolment it will have to cover, reported under registration of the population.	MOVEMENT
Burundi	A stand-alone cybercrime statute has been in force since March 2022, with cybersecurity obligations carried in the 2024 communications code. Loi n 1/10 du 16 mars 2022 portant prevention et repression de la cybercriminalite is in force and recorded as such on the official legal database, and the base holds its complete promulgated text. The 2024 code des communications electroniques et postales carries cybersecurity obligations at articles 160 to 167 alongside it. Nothing moved on either in the window. What the base does not hold is any implementing regulation, any national cybersecurity strategy, or any published enforcement action under the 2022 statute.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cameroon	Loi n. 2010/012 remains in force and is invoked to justify network restrictions; no reform is adopted on record. The law has stood since 21 December 2010 and is in force and invoked to justify network restrictions, with civil-society reform recommendations pending and none adopted on record. The recommendations were addressed to government after a workshop in June 2026. Nothing since reports a government response, a drafting instruction or a bill. The statute is the legal basis under which the restrictions recorded elsewhere in this report were imposed, which is why its non-reform is the material fact rather than its age.	NO CHANGE
Cape Verde	The cybersecurity legal regime was enacted by Decreto-Lei 9/2021 and remains unamended, with the first appropriation against it appearing in the 2026 budget. The act applies to the public administration, operators of critical infrastructure, operators of essential services, digital service providers and any entity using networks and information systems, adopts the regional cybersecurity directive, creates the national cybersecurity centre as national authority, the incident response team operating under it and a national security nucleus, and sets security requirements and incident notification duties with a sanctions regime. It was approved in council on 17 December 2020, promulgated on 27 January 2021 and entered into force 180 days after publication. No amendment, implementing regulation or repeal is held. The operating capability the act provides for was launched publicly on 29 October 2025 as a security operations centre and incident response team inside the state's private technological network, five years after the statute. No cybercrime statute of its own is held.	NO CHANGE a standing position the base holds for the first time
Central African Republic	The cybersecurity and cybercrime law has been in force since early 2024 carrying six to ten year sentences, and is named as the instrument now used against online content. The law was voted by acclamation in January 2024 and has been in force since, carrying six to ten year sentences and fines of FCFA 5m to 10m. Its text is unchanged and the statute itself is not held, which is a standing acquisition target. 2026-07-29 — a commentator names it as the instrument now used against online content. That is an opinion column rather than a record of prosecutions, so what the base can state is the claim and not a case. The agency the same law creates has never been established, reported under cybersecurity readiness, so the enforcement side of the statute runs through the ordinary criminal process.	NO CHANGE
Chad	Loi 009/PR/2015 is the cybersecurity statute, and the agency under it was reformed in March 2026 with a cybercrime unit created in June. The regulator's own register of the laws it works under names Loi n. 009/PR/2015 on cybersecurity and the fight against cybercrime, alongside Loi n. 008/PR/2015 on electronic transactions and Loi n. 007/PR/2015 on the protection of personal data (register). Decret n. 148/PR/2026 of 23 March 2026 promulgated the law ratifying the January ordinance reforming the computer-security and electronic-certification agency, widening its remit to cybersecurity, personal data, electronic transactions, cybercrime, video surveillance, drones, social platforms and artificial-intelligence systems (promulgation); the Senate had ratified it 58 votes to 3 (ratification). Decret n. 2010/PR/2026 of 1 June 2026 then created a cybercrime unit inside the agency and appointed its coordinator and deputy (unit).	MOVEMENT
Comoros	Loi n 21-012/AU was promulgated on 18 January 2022; cybercrime sits separately at articles 449 to 505 of the penal code. The base's position on this indicator was wrong and is corrected here. The cybersecurity law was adopted by the Assembly on 25 June 2021 and promulgated by decret n 22-003/PR on 18 January 2022; its own text defines cybersecurity, cybercrime, critical infrastructure and the supervisory commission, sets its scope at articles 1 to 4 and carries an offence and penalty regime covering illegal access, data and system integrity and fraud. It had been recorded as drafted and not enacted, on a 2021 agency account written before promulgation. The penal code, promulgated in February 2021, separately covers technology-specific offences, online intellectual-property infringement and service-provider liability at articles 449 to 505. Nothing moved in the window. No implementing decree, prosecution, caseload or enforcement figure is on file at either end.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Congo	The national cybersecurity strategy remains in development and the security agency joined the African network of agencies. No cybersecurity statute was enacted in the period. The ledger's standing entries are a national cybersecurity strategy in development and a national information systems security agency in place. 2026-06-26 — the agency joined the African network of cybersecurity agencies, which is a membership rather than a legislative act. The Malabo Convention ratification the ledger carries is the nearest instrument, and it is regional.	NO CHANGE the strategy is in development and no statute was enacted
Cote d'Ivoire	Ordonnance n 2024-950, ratified by the Senate in June 2025, is unchanged in law and remains the transfer instrument. The ordinance moved network security, audit, certification and electronic-certificate issuance from the telecommunications regulator to the cyber agency, and was ratified on 16 June 2025, a step carried through the electronic-exchanges ratification law. Nothing in the window amended it. What moved is the exercise of the transferred mandate rather than the statute: the certificate power is now used through the national root of trust. No consolidated cybersecurity statute exists, and the successor strategy is a policy instrument rather than a law.	NO CHANGE
Djibouti	The Digital Code was published in September 2025 and a statutory cybersecurity authority followed in December. The Digital Code, regulating personal data, electronic communications, cybersecurity and cybercrime, was published in the Official Journal on 18 September 2025 after adoption on 30 June. 2025-11-04 - the Council of Ministers approved the bill creating a National Cybersecurity Authority attached to the Presidency, tasked with the national strategy, protection of critical infrastructure and state information systems; the National Assembly passed it on 12 November. A World Bank report records operationalising the Code's telecommunications and cybersecurity books as a priority; no implementing decree under either is held.	MOVEMENT
DR Congo	The Digital Code of March 2023 covers the security and criminal protection of information systems, and the national cybersecurity authority was created by ordinance in May 2026. The statute is one code covering the whole field: its first article scopes it to digital activities and services, electronic writings and trust-service providers, digital content, and the security and criminal protection of information systems, alongside a digital tax, customs and exchange regime, and its definitions include cybercrime, cybersecurity, electronic commerce, cryptology and interoperability. 2026-05-16 - an ordinance under it creates the national cybersecurity authority, with powers to audit public institutions and operators of vital importance and to certify cybersecurity products. Enforcement of the code began on the state's own initiative in August 2026, the attorney general instructing judicial police officers to open cases proprio motu. A code that reaches content offences and is enforced without complaint is a different instrument in practice from one that protects systems.	MOVEMENT
Egypt	A regulatory framework for cybersecurity services rests on the 2018 crimes law, which two bills would now amend. The regulator's operative framework for providing cybersecurity services rests on the 2018 information technology crimes law and the 2003 telecommunications regulation law. 2026-04-22 - two separately sponsored private members' bills would amend the 2018 law: one to strengthen protection of children against newly emerging electronic crimes, the other to address artificial-intelligence-generated deepfakes and tie fines to the benefit obtained. Neither is recorded as passed. The regulator also signed a cross-border cyber security cooperation agreement with a Gulf council in October 2025.	MOVEMENT
Equatorial Guinea	Ley 7/2024 on social media and computer crime has been in force since December 2024, its full text unheld and its provisions known from reporting. Its provisions were reported in rollout from July 2026 (the law). The same statute creates the national cybersecurity and critical infrastructure agency under the Presidency, and that body has no premises, staffing, budget or activity on record, so the law's institutional half exists only on paper.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Eritrea	Computer offences sit in two articles of the general Penal Code; no dedicated cybersecurity statute exists (Penal Code). Eritrea's only identifiable computer-offence provisions are Articles 374 and 375 of the 2015 Penal Code, covering unauthorised use of a computer — unauthorised access, interception, alteration or destruction of data, interference with lawful data use — and an aggravated form (Penal Code). A country cybersecurity assessment records, item by item, no cybercrime legislation, no cybersecurity regulation, no officially recognised national computer incident response team, no national cybersecurity strategy, no governance roadmap and no responsible agency (assessment). Nothing in the window changed either position. Criminal provisions exist; the institutional apparatus a cybersecurity regime needs does not. Nor is there a strategy behind the missing statute: a country profile records no public national cybersecurity strategy, so neither the legislative nor the policy layer exists on the record.	NO CHANGE
Eswatini	Cybersecurity, critical infrastructure, e-commerce and artificial-intelligence legislation was named as forthcoming alongside the capital's smart-city deployment. The communications regulator publicly stated that cyberbullying is a criminal offence under the computer crime statute (statement). No prosecution or complaint figure is on the base. Four instruments were named together in August 2025 (legislation). None has entered the base since as a draft, a tabling or an enactment. Naming a legislative programme alongside a deployment of 59 camera systems and a fifth-generation network is the sequence worth recording: the deployment is in progress and the four laws that would govern it are a list.	MOVEMENT
Ethiopia	Proclamation 1426/2026 designates twelve critical sectors and places eighteen obligations on their owners and operators, commencing about July 2027. The proclamation was signed at Addis Ababa on 21 July 2026, and article 28 sets commencement one year after gazettement (Proclamation 1426/2026). The designated sectors run from information and communications technology, financial services and transport to agriculture, trade and industry; a Critical Infrastructure Cybersecurity Fund is established, and the security agency is to write sector standards, give technical assistance and enforce through the transition (briefing on the proclamation). Ratification, assent and commencement dates are not established in the base, and the regulations the Council of Ministers and the agency may make under articles 26 and 27 do not yet exist.	MOVEMENT
Gabon	Loi n 027/2023 on cybersecurity and cybercrime is in force from July 2023, its text not held. The statute appeared in the same gazette issue as the data-protection law, of 15 July 2023, and is named as present in the captured issue without being reproduced in it (gazette issue). It reaches the base through the security agency's own account of its work rather than through the instrument (agency account). No article text, implementing decree, prosecution or sanction under it is held.	NO CHANGE
Gambia	The 2009 Act still carries the computer-misuse and cybercrime provisions; its replacement is stuck in committee. The Information and Communications Act, assented on 29 May 2009, holds the computer-misuse, cybercrime and data-processing provisions and remains the operative instrument. The Communications Bill 2025 that would replace it went to a second reading on 3 March 2026 and was referred to committee, with concerns over surveillance oversight unresolved. The regional convention on cybersecurity was signed in December 2022 and is still unratified.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Ghana	The Cybersecurity Act 2020 produced its first published penalties in August 2026, three totalling GH¢720,000, of which two are already unsettled. The Act establishes the cyber security authority and a fund, provides for designation, registration and compliance audit of critical information infrastructure, and licenses cybersecurity service providers, with no licence register, designation list or enforcement record held before this month (the Act, in application). The authority fined the companies registrar GH¢240,000 for engaging an unlicensed provider and that provider GH¢120,000 for operating without a licence (first penalties). The registrar contests its sanction as premature and procedurally unfair, dating its procurement to a commitment authorisation of 28 November 2025 and a tender advertised on 4 December and evaluated on 22 December, before the directive it is said to have breached, and has asked the Attorney-General to intervene (challenge). The largest penalty, GH¢360,000 against an accounting firm's Ghana practice, was announced and declared satisfactorily resolved in a joint statement the same day, with no statement of whether it was paid, reduced or withdrawn (penalty, resolution).	MOVEMENT
Guinea	The first conviction under the 2016 statute came in August 2026, and it ordered the deletion of the defendant's social-media account. A court of first instance convicted an activist and entrepreneur of insult and defamation by means of a computer system on 19 August 2026, sentencing him to six months of which five were suspended and a 40 million GNF fine, and ordering the deletion of his account; the conviction rests on article 363 of the penal code and article 29 of the cybersecurity law (conviction). The prosecution had sought a year and argued a conviction would set an example to other social-media users; the defence, which asked for acquittal, said it would consider an appeal. Deletion of an account as a criminal penalty is something the base holds no other instance of. The statute's cybercrime half reaches offences on national territory and those requiring collection of electronic evidence, again on the agency's summary rather than the text (the statute, in application). A presidential decree read on national television on 21 May 2026 made security audits compulsory every three years for every public and private body carrying on electronic transactions, an exceptional audit after a major incident, and a certificate of conformity on a passing audit; foreign firms serving Guinean residents are brought within it (decree).	MOVEMENT
Guinea-Bissau	Three cybercrime conventions were ratified in May 2026 alongside a law against false online information. Guinea-Bissau signed the United Nations Convention against Cybercrime at Hanoi in October 2025, and the transitional council ratified it with the African Union and Budapest conventions in May 2026. The same sitting passed a law against the dissemination of false information online, which the ledger carries as its own row. The institutional side is still scoped rather than built: the feasibility study proposes a security operations centre and a national incident response team.	MOVEMENT
Kenya	The Court of Appeal struck the false-publication sections and a shutdown power, the National Assembly has appealed to the Supreme Court, and cyber cafe logging rules take effect in September 2026. The 2018 statute is narrowed by litigation, with the false-publication offences and the non-judicial website-shutdown power struck and a conservatory order blocking a national internet shutdown; the base does not date the judgments, so whether the narrowing falls inside the twelve months is unestablished (litigation). Operators of public access centres must capture each customer's name and identity number, the terminal used and session times, and retain the records at least three years, on pain of fines of up to 0.2 per cent of annual turnover with a minimum of about US$3,860 (rules). The regulator clarified on 13 August 2026 that the conditions do not require operators to track browsing history; the conditions were gazetted on 7 August and take effect on 7 September 2026 (clarification). 2026-08-31 — the National Assembly asked the Supreme Court to restore sections 22 and 23, which carried fines of up to KSh 5m and up to ten years' imprisonment. The Court of Appeal held the wording too broad, Parliament argues it reaches only knowing publication presented as authentic. The statute's reach is contested, not settled. Accession to the Council of Europe cybercrime convention is planned, with public views invited by 11 September 2026 (accession).	MIXED the cybercrime statute was narrowed by litigation while new logging duties were imposed on public access centres

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Lesotho	The Computer Crime and Cybersecurity Bill was split into a Cybercrime Bill and a Cybersecurity Bill, both awaiting National Assembly approval. Both bills were reported on 29 July 2026 as awaiting National Assembly approval, on no published timetable (forum, account). The Cybersecurity Bill is intended to build the institutions protecting critical digital infrastructure, which is the statute the interim response team now operating was set up ahead of (interim body). No text of either bill is held.	MOVEMENT
Liberia	The Cybercrime Act was signed on 19 August 2026, seven months after passage, alongside sector cybersecurity regulations already in force. The signature ends a delay carried since January 2026, when Senate concurrence was communicated to the House; no commencement date, implementing regulation or enforcement body is published with it, and an international index still places the country in its second-lowest maturity tier (enactment). The regulator's own 2026 regulations require telecom providers to store personal data primarily inside the country, establish an in-house cybersecurity unit within a year, notify the regulator of breaches within 24 hours and customers within 72, run annual penetration testing and keep security-event logs for at least twelve months; penalties are revenue-linked but apply only from a year after the effective date, and the penalty escalation ladder is unreadable in both held copies (regulations). A National Cybersecurity Act scheduled for the third quarter of 2025 by the strategy's own action plan is not held as a draft, bill or enactment (action plan).	MOVEMENT
Libya	A comprehensive cybersecurity law is in drafting on the eastern legislative track, discussed with the National Security Council in July 2026. The House of Representatives established a committee for the draft under the Speaker's decision 115 of 2025, and drafting was discussed with the National Security Council on 16 July 2026 (drafting). No text has been published, no reading has been recorded, and the base holds nothing on how a law passed on that track would apply in the west of the country.	MOVEMENT
Madagascar	A complete recasting of the 2014 cybercrime law reached a plenary vote on 4 September 2026 and the deputies deferred it, with the electronic communications bill, to a later session. The deputies voted to defer five bills, the cybercrime recast and the electronic communications and digital infrastructure bill first among them, saying they needed longer on texts turning on both security imperatives and fundamental freedoms; no resumed date is set (deferral). Commentary reads the contested articles as written to suit the state's own control interests (comment). The cybercrime bill reached the National Assembly carrying prison terms of two to ten years and providing for a new digital protection and investigation unit (report), presented as an update of the state's arsenal against rising digital risk (account). Revision was reported again in August 2026 alongside signature of the United Nations cybercrime convention, with findings that artificial-intelligence-enabled fraud is outpacing African states' response capacity given as the reason (revision). Three of the seven bills on the session's order paper are digital: one on electronic communication and digital infrastructure, one recasting the cybercrime law and one authorising ratification of the convention (order paper). No bill texts are on file.	STALLED
Malawi	The 2016 Act is in force since 1 June 2017; a policy and strategy went to consultation in December 2025. The statute's own text is now held. The Electronic Transactions and Cyber Security Act, chapter 74:02, has been in force since 1 June 2017 and establishes the computer emergency response team. 2025-12 - regional stakeholder consultations ran from 1 to 5 December 2025 to support a new cyber security policy and strategy; no draft or timetable is on record, and the account is an officer's personal post rather than an institutional one. 2026-02 - the regulator reported that the parliamentary committee on media and communications pledged to support review of the legislation governing mobile-money fraud. A pledge to review is the whole of the parliamentary record here.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mali	The cybercrime repression law of 2019 is in force, and a national cybersecurity strategy was approved by decree in March 2026 with a 2026-2030 action plan. Law n. 2019-056 is the statute the specialised cybercrime pole and its criminal chamber work under, and its text is held from the official journal (law). A decree of 6 March 2026 approves the strategy and its action plan; the strategy text itself is not held, so what is established is that it exists and its period. The Council of Ministers approved the creation of a national information systems security agency in June 2026 (agency). No prosecution count under the law is published.	MOVEMENT
Mauritania	The cybercrime law of 2016 is the instrument in force, its text now held; no amendment is on the record. Law n. 2016-007 defines computer data, subscriber data and traffic data and sets the offences and procedure for cybercrime (law). Against it, a national emergency response team and security operations centre were put out to international tender in September 2025 and no award is on the record. The base holds no prosecution count, case record or amendment, so the statute is dated and its use is not.	NO CHANGE
Mauritius	The Cybersecurity and Cybercrime Act 2021 has been in force since December 2021 and carries the fake-profile, cyberbullying and undesirable-content offences. The enacted text as gazetted is held, carrying the offences of misuse of a fake profile, cyberbullying and failure to moderate undesirable content with their penalty scales (Act). It is the statute the ministry's own online-content warnings rest on, and no charge, prosecution or takedown count under any of those sections is published in this base.	NO CHANGE
Morocco	Law 05-20 on cybersecurity has been in force since July 2020, with its own article 53 deferring effect to implementing texts the base does not hold. The law sets outsourcing conditions in article 12 and penalties in article 49, and defers its force to implementing texts in article 53 (law). The decree defining the sensitive data the law turns on is not held, so the statute is on the books and the base cannot establish which processing it reaches. No prosecution, enforcement action or compliance count under it is recorded.	NO CHANGE
Mozambique	A Cyber Security Law and a Cybercrime Law were published on 1 July 2026 and come into force on 29 September, with regulations due within 180 days. The Cyber Security Law was approved by the assembly in April 2026, promulgated in June and published on 1 July, creating a national incident response team seated in the ICT institute and, at articles 67 to 71, a Cyber Security Fund financed by a flat 1 per cent of licensed providers' prior-year gross revenue (law, approval). The Cybercrime Law was published alongside it, providing for preservation and collection of digital evidence and for international cooperation, and repealing six penal-code articles in favour of its own offences (cybercrime law). Neither set of implementing regulations had been made by August 2026, and the Cyber Security Fund's own operating rules are among what they are left to settle (regulations).	MOVEMENT
Namibia	A Cybercrime Bill was named as being finalised in July 2026, with no draft published and no tabling date given. Enforcement has relied on the electronic transactions statute, the communications statute and the penal code; cabinet approved cybercrime proposals in November 2025 (proposals) and the minister named the bill as being finalised alongside the data protection bill in July 2026 (finalisation). The base first names this bill in July 2026, and the national incident response team states in its own report that it cannot fully execute its mandate absent a cybersecurity law.	MOVEMENT marginal

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Niger	The cybersecurity centre and the certification agency were created by decree in October 2025, and the new penal code adds cybercrime provisions. The Council of Ministers of 11 October 2025 adopted the decree organising the electronic certification agency under articles 17 and 18 of the 2019 electronic transactions law, and the decrees creating the national cybersecurity centre and approving its statutes as the body coordinating implementation of the 2022 national cybersecurity strategy. The justice ministry's criminal-chain workshop of 17 April 2026 reports that the new penal code introduces provisions on cybercrime and related offences, with the 2020 national criminal policy to be aligned with the current framework. The 2019 cybercrime statute remains the dedicated law. Neither the centre's operating capability nor a national incident-response team's activity is evidenced.	MOVEMENT
Nigeria	The Cybercrimes (Amendment) Act 2024 is in force, and lawyers argue enforcement agencies misapply it against dissent rather than cyber threats. Civil-society lawyers argue the Act is misapplied against dissent, with most such cases collapsing because complainants never testify; the financial sector alone lost ₦53.4bn to cybercrime in 2024 (Act). No prosecution, conviction or dismissal series under the Act is published, so the claim of misuse and the claim of necessity rest on the same absence of data.	NO CHANGE
Rwanda	The 2018 cybercrimes law remains the core statute, and software security directives were issued in April 2026. The statute in force since 2018 covers offences, service-provider duties, investigation powers and critical-infrastructure protection, and is named as operative by the current national cybersecurity strategy (law). The cyber authority issued application software security directives in April 2026, operationalising security by design across the development lifecycle for internet and intranet-accessible applications in public and private institutions (announcement, directives). Directives are subordinate instruments. The statute beneath them is eight years old and unamended.	MOVEMENT
Sao Tome and Principe	A 2017 cybercrime statute creates the computer-crime offences, sets the procedural powers for electronic evidence and requires a 24-hour police contact point. Artigo 1 states that the law establishes substantive and procedural criminal provisions and provisions on international cooperation relating to cybercrime and the collection of electronic evidence, adapting domestic law to the international conventions (statute). It creates offences of computer forgery, damage to programs or data, computer sabotage, illegal access, illegal interception and illegitimate reproduction of a protected program, and requires the judicial police to keep a permanent international cooperation contact point (statute). A national cybersecurity strategy for 2024 to 2028 exists in draft and went to public consultation in September 2025 (consultation); the statute is in force and the strategy is not.	NO CHANGE
Senegal	A critical-infrastructure protection law was adopted unanimously on 20 August 2026, and both the bill text and the inter-commission report on it are now held. The National Assembly adopted the bill on the protection of critical information infrastructure and digital security (adoption). Adopted is not promulgated; the base holds no gazette text. The Assembly adopted the law unanimously (adoption, detail, safeguard). Every provision reaching the base through the news accounts is the ministry's own description and the enacted text is not held; the base held nothing on this workstream at the window's start (cooperation, security, digital security). The bill's own text and the parliamentary inter-commission report on it are both held, so the base can read the provisions and the committee's reading of them rather than the tabling alone (bill, text, hosting, continuity). During the debate the Assembly's first vice-president argued cybersecurity must become a standing administrative culture rather than a compliance exercise, calling for mandatory staff training and minimum device-security standards — an account of where the state's own practice stands rather than of what the law requires (culture).	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Seychelles	The Cybercrimes Act 2021 was amended in December 2025, widening offences and adding search and interception powers. The 2021 Act created the first standalone cybercrime offences regime, repealing the Computer Misuse Act, and commenced on 1 February 2022 (Act). The amendment passed the National Assembly on 15 December and was assented on 22 December 2025; it widens the offence definitions, defines subscriber information as identity, address and billing or service details, and adds search and interception powers (amendment). Cabinet separately approved a judiciary digitalisation programme in May 2026 expressly requiring stronger cybersecurity and data-management systems around the courts (judiciary). No prosecution, caseload or enforcement figure under the Act is published.	MOVEMENT
Sierra Leone	The Cyber Security and Crime Act 2021 is in force and unamended, with no prosecution under it reported. The Act was gazetted on 25 November 2021 and the text is on the national legal information institute (Act). It remains in force and unamended, and no prosecution under it appears in the base (status). That absence is the finding worth carrying: a statute reaching the conduct exists, and the mobile-money fraud wave recorded elsewhere has produced no reported case under it.	NO CHANGE
Somalia	The lower house approved a Cybersecurity Law in January 2026, and the upper house took only a first reading on 29 August 2026. The House of the People approved the law on 26 January 2026, assigning policy to the communications ministry, technical oversight to the regulator and obligations to critical-infrastructure operators (approval, coverage). The Upper House gave a six-chapter, 33-article cybersecurity bill its first reading on 29 August 2026, at the first sitting of its eighth term (first reading). The chamber's own published procedure requires three readings before a bill passes it (procedure). An earlier stage is on file under a third name: the communications ministry's Cybercrimes Bill took its first reading in the House of the People on 8 December 2025 without substantive debate and was referred to committee (first reading). So the instrument is short of final approval, and nothing on file states that the three named stages are one bill. The country ranked in the international index's fifth tier at 37.39 of 100 in 2024 and is a signatory to the continental cyber convention (index). The law's text is not held, and no implementing regulation, commencement date or enforcement action is on record.	MOVEMENT and the law is not yet through both chambers
South Africa	The Cybercrimes Act is in force, the state signed the United Nations cybercrime convention in October 2025, and a revised strategy awaits adoption. The Cybercrimes Act is the standing substantive statute, held as an excerpt. 2025-10-25 — the state signed the United Nations Convention against Cybercrime, told to a G20 ministerial by the justice minister. No ratification step has followed. 2026-05-22 — consultation on a revised National Cybersecurity Strategy is substantially complete with adoption expected in the following quarter. No adopted text is on file, so the strategy is an expectation stated in a budget vote. Signature, a statute and a strategy in consultation is a fuller legislative position than most countries in this base hold, and none of the three is a report of enforcement: no prosecution count under the Act appears anywhere on this ledger.	MOVEMENT
South Sudan	A Cyber Crimes and Computer Abuse Act was signed in February 2026, criminalising false information, online impersonation and hate speech alongside hacking, and the text is withheld. The bill passed in November 2025 and was signed on 18 February 2026, with the ministry setting out its operation the following day (signature, passage, operation, effect). The speech offences and the withheld text are the objections on record. The country has no data-protection statute, no privacy commission and no incident response team, so the first computer-crime statute is also the first digital statute of any kind. Its text cannot be read because there is no operating gazette, which is recorded separately.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sudan	A draft Cybersecurity Law is in redrafting, and its relationship to the cybercrime provisions the country described to a regional experts' meeting is not established. The draft is the second of the three-instrument package and was reported in redrafting in August 2026 (draft, redrafting). Its relationship to the cybercrime provisions the country separately described to an Arab experts' meeting in July 2026 is not established (meeting). That matters because the cybercrime statute in force is being used against speech, and whether the new draft replaces, amends or sits alongside it is exactly what no source says.	MOVEMENT
Tanzania	Critical infrastructure registration opened in June 2026, eleven years after the statute that provides for it. The cybercrimes statute, in force since September 2015 and consolidated in 2023, criminalises illegal access, interception, data interference and computer-related fraud and forgery, and provides for the protection of critical information infrastructure. The ministry opened a six-month registration window from 19 June to 19 December 2026 activating that regime across finance, health, water, energy, mining, transport, agriculture, industry, education and defence, with mandatory 24-hour incident reporting and penalties of at least 100 million shillings, three times the loss caused, or five years' imprisonment. Central bank guidelines of August 2025 add encryption, multi-factor authentication, vulnerability remediation, access controls, audit rights and incident provisions for regulated financial-sector cloud arrangements.	MOVEMENT
Togo	The framework statute of 7 December 2018, as amended in June 2022, is in force and both texts are now held. The 2018 statute sets the national cybersecurity regime, defines the cybercrime offences and procedure, creates the national cybersecurity agency at article 6, provides for a digital sovereignty fund and refers implementing decrees to article 48. It was amended by loi n 2022-009 of 24 June 2022, held as a scan whose first page only is transcribed; the number and date are corroborated independently in the visas of a September 2022 decree. None of the implementing decrees article 48 provides for is held, and no enforcement or prosecution record under the statute appears in the base.	NO CHANGE
Tunisia	The 2023 decree-law creates the national cybersecurity agency and the cloud hosting label regime; no implementing text is held. Decree-law 2023-17, gazetted 11 March 2023, creates the national cybersecurity agency as successor to the information security agency established in 2004, and establishes the G-Cloud and N-Cloud provider labelling regime for hosting; the rename took effect six months after publication. No implementing text, label register or list of labelled providers is held, so the hosting regime the decree-law creates cannot be checked against anything. The public-sector security baseline that reaches the administration in 2026 arrives by head-of-government circular rather than under this instrument. 2025-10-22 - the parliamentary record of the amending bill is now held: it was before the general legislation committee on 22 October 2025, still under review and unpassed. It dates the revision the committee had named its top priority in January 2026 to a process already a year old and still open.	NO CHANGE
Uganda	The Constitutional Court nullified five sections of the Computer Misuse Act on quorum and vagueness grounds, and government declared telecom-infrastructure attacks economic sabotage. The nullification covered sections 11, 23 and 26 to 29. The movement stem records an instrument neutralised; the rights reading is the opposite (nullification). Vandalism against telecommunications infrastructure is now treated as economic sabotage, with a subscriber-card conviction obtained under the 2024 interception regulations rather than the Act (sabotage, crackdown). Which statute an offence is charged under is worth recording when the principal computer-crime Act has just lost five sections.	MIXED five Computer Misuse Act sections nullified for vagueness while vandalism enforcement was stepped up as economic sabotage

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Zambia	The Cyber Security Act No. 3 of 2025 and the Cyber Crimes Act No. 4 of 2025 are both in force, and the investigatory and interception powers in them are court-gated. The gazetted text of the security Act was acquired from the National Assembly's own directory; it commenced on 12 May 2025 by statutory instrument (Act, signature). Enforcement of the crimes Act was declared fully operational in July 2026. The gazetted texts of both Acts are now held, and the investigatory powers in the crimes Act and the interception power in the security Act are both court-gated; the claim that the 2025 Acts authorise interception without prior judicial review is not borne out, while the presidential-control half of that claim is (enforcement, warning, compliance, freedom). The Law Association was reported set to mount a challenge in April 2025; the single held source is a lede-only capture and the absence of any subsequent record is itself the finding (challenge).	MIXED two 2025 Acts in force with their investigatory powers court-gated while a threatened legal challenge has produced no record
Zimbabwe	The Cyber and Data Protection Act is unamended, cybercrime offences sit in the Criminal Law Code, and a national cybersecurity strategy was completed in October 2025. The Act of 2021 remains the principal statute, designating the telecommunications regulator as data protection authority and providing for a cyber security centre; it is unamended and administrative sanctions are still not provided for (Act). The regulator's director-general stated on 24 January 2026 that Zimbabwe has no standalone cybercrime Act, and that hacking, unlawful acquisition of data and related offences sit in Part VIII of the Criminal Law (Codification and Reform) Act as amended in 2021, hacking carrying a fine or up to ten years' imprisonment (clarification). The ICT ministry announced on 15 October 2025 that the National Cybersecurity Strategy had been completed, a day after Cabinet approved the artificial-intelligence strategy (strategy). The same minister described a 2026-2030 strategy as still being finalised in July 2026, and no text is held at either date (July 2026).	MOVEMENT

Legislation covering digital id

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	A digital-identity and trust-services law has been before the Assembly since 2 November 2025; no promulgation is held. The law did not exist at the window's opening. It was approved by the Council of Ministers on 2 November 2025 and is before the National Assembly, reported in the biometrics press, in the state daily and as a digital-trust and electronic-transactions measure. No promulgation or gazette reference is held as at 2026-08-03. Meanwhile a unified national digital identity is already issued and in use as a single credential across the government services portal, so the credential is running nine months ahead of the statute that would govern it.	MOVEMENT
Angola	The Council of Ministers approved a civil and criminal identification bill in April 2026, which would set the country's first dedicated identity-data regime. 2026-04-29 — the Council of Ministers approved a bill making the identity card the only valid document for banking, telecoms, school enrolment, property registration and contracts, and establishing the country's first dedicated regime for processing identity data. Voter cards, driving licences and passports are currently accepted as substitutes. No parliamentary stage has been recorded since. Two other instruments touch the same ground and neither is this one: an electoral registration law replacing in-person enrolment with automatic enrolment from the civil identity database, which reaches the base only through a secondary account with no gazette reference, and the data protection law reported above, which is the general regime the identity-specific one would sit beside.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Benin	The 2017 identification law is the statutory base for the identifier and the agency, extended in June 2025 to foreigners and Afro-descendants. The 2017 law is the statutory base for the identification of natural persons, creating the identification agency and the unique personal identifier. It is held as the text layer of a scan, so quotation from it is unsafe. 2025-06-23 — law 2025-12 creates a residents file with distinct foreigner and Afro-descendant identifiers, for migration control and civic inclusion. Nothing of the kind existed before it, and it is the only amendment to the identity statute in the window. The instrument the estate still lacks is a rule on what may be asked of the register: the data protection authority's intervention on the electoral roll, reported under data protection, was a regulator settling by decision a question no statute answers. The framework statute's reach into the workplace was set out in September 2026: on a newspaper's reading of article 379 of the Code du numérique, a company phone, a company-issued number or a work messaging group does not by itself entitle an employer to read the messages on it. It is a reading, not a regulator decision or a judgment.	MOVEMENT
Botswana	Section 14 of the Digital Services Act provides for online unique identification, and the amending registration Act commenced in November 2025. 2025-10-17 — the Digital Services Act was assented, its section 14 providing for online unique identification. 2026-02-24 — the ministry confirmed the National Registration (Amendment) Act No. 7 of 2025 commenced in November 2025, and reported a digital-ID roadmap facilitated by the African Development Bank due at the end of March 2026. No commencement notice for the Digital Services Act itself is held, and no roadmap document.	MOVEMENT
Burundi	A ministerial ordinance made identity-card registration of every SIM compulsory from 25 June 2026, while the identification file itself still awaits instituting texts. 2026-06 — the regulator required every subscriber to regularise SIM identification against the national identity card, with non-compliant lines deactivated from 25 June 2026, under a ministerial ordinance of 13 January 2026. It is the first instrument on the ledger to make the national identity card a condition of holding a service. Underneath it the register is not yet constituted: the official procedure page for the Fichier National d'Identification states that further texts remain to be adopted to institute the file. An obligation to identify against a register precedes the instrument establishing the register.	MOVEMENT
Cameroon	Decret n. 2025/059 on identity titles and the 2024 civil-registration law are both in force and unamended. The decree was signed on 28 February 2025 governing five identity-title classes and is in force, unamended; its refugee and disability chapters are not captured in the base. The civil-registration law was enacted on 23 December 2024 in 130 sections, providing for electronic declaration, a national database, digital certificates and a unique personal identification number, and is also unamended. Its text is not held, so what the unique personal identification number obliges, and how it relates to the biometric card, is not checkable from anything on file.	NO CHANGE
Cape Verde	The identity card was created by Decreto-Lei 19/2014, which governs its issue, replacement, use and cancellation. The card is optional from birth and compulsory from age four, its civil identification number is generated through the national civil identification and authentication system, and the data printed and encoded on it, filiation included, is drawn from the birth registration act. That link between the registration act and the card is the operative connection between civil registration and the national digital identity. The card itself is now produced domestically and renewable online through the justice portal, on the same legal basis. No amendment to the 2014 decree is held.	NO CHANGE a standing position the base holds for the first time
Central African Republic	Government terms of reference scope legal reform covering civil status with digital identification; no such law is held. The terms of reference cover personal data, cybersecurity, electronic communications and civil status with digital identification. Two of the instruments they scope were made in early 2024 - the data protection law and the cybersecurity law - and nothing records the identification leg being drafted. What exists instead is an obligation without a statute behind it on the record: the unique identification number is recorded as made mandatory in a budget-support completion report, with no instrument named.	NO CHANGE a first stated position with no earlier account behind it

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Chad	The 2016 ordinance founds the identity agency, and a December 2025 decret makes it central to official document production. The agency's own site names Ordonnance n. 001/PR/2016 as its founding instrument and states that its integrated population and secure-documents system, after enrolment and deduplication, assigns every enrolled individual a unique national identification number across 29 centres (agency). Decret n. 3004 of 5 December 2025 replaced the 1997 regime for official passports: it abolishes the special passport, resets the beneficiary list, removes the automatic entitlement of spouses, adds explicit refusal grounds and a return obligation at end of function, and makes the agency the central actor for personalisation and physical production (decret). The statistics institute's bulletin sets the civil-registration frame the identity system sits on — the 2013 civil registration law, the 2016 ordinance and a 2017 decret (bulletin).	MOVEMENT
Comoros	The biometric identity card is instituted by loi n 14-023/AU, promulgated by decret n 14-137/PR. The justice ministry's legislation index carries the promulgating decree and a download link to the law instituting the digital, biometric Comorian identity card. This is the first record in the base of a statute behind the card, which until now stood on procurement and operational accounts alone. The index dates the decree to 28 August 2024 while numbering it in the 2014 series and dating the law it promulgates to 24 June 2014. The decree's own text is not held, so the discrepancy is reported here rather than settled. What the statute requires - enrolment duties, the data it may hold, who may read it - is not on file, so nothing here says what the card's legal basis actually obliges.	NO CHANGE a first record of the promulgating decree with the law's own text still not held
Congo	Revised statutes for the cross-border operations single window were issued by decree, on an identity framework the ledger already carries. 2026-01-01 — a decree issued revised statutes for the single window for cross-border operations. It is the identity layer's clearest legislative movement in the window. The standing instruments are the unique identification number and the computerised national identity card; no statute dedicated to digital identity as such is held.	MOVEMENT
Cote d'Ivoire	The only identification instrument on file is decret n 2017-193 on subscriber identification; no foundational digital-identity statute is held. The decree was made on 22 March 2017 and requires identification of subscribers to public telecommunications and information-technology services and of cybercafe users. Nothing in the window touched it. It is not a digital-identity law. The national biometric register, the identification number and the credentials issued against them run throughout this report, and the base holds no statute, ordinance or decree establishing any of them, setting who may query the register, or stating what a holder may refuse. That absence sits under every identity row here.	NO CHANGE
Djibouti	Identification is governed by a 2019 law creating the register of natural persons and the national identification number, unchanged in the period. The founding law makes the Registre National des Personnes Physiques the unique reference for identifying individuals and for producing every secure national document - identity card, passport, voter card, driving licence - with administrative management at the population directorate and technical and security management at the state information-systems agency. Its implementing decree defines the identification number as a digital instrument combining civil-status and personal data, and makes its use compulsory across public, parapublic and private administration for identification and third-party data exchange. Nothing amended either in the period; what moved is what runs on them.	NO CHANGE
DR Congo	A bill on the identification of natural persons was tabled at the National Assembly bureau on 12 June 2026. 2026-06-12 - the bill was tabled: it would set one legal frame for identification data and its collection, processing, retention and protection, impose security and interoperability requirements, and connect civil-registry, migration and health databases. No committee report or plenary date is held. It runs alongside rather than through the twenty-year identity concession already signed, and nothing on file connects the two. A statutory frame arriving after the platform it would govern is the sequence here, and no source states which would prevail on retention, access or foreign processing.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Egypt	Biometric identification is mandated by decree in non-bank finance; the identity layer itself still has no statute. One sectoral instrument is now on record. The financial regulator issued Decrees 139, 140 and 141 of 2023 on 11 July 2023 to enforce Law 5 of 2022 on financial technology in non-bank finance, Decree 140 requiring biometric verification including facial recognition and fingerprint matching in fintech dealings with non-bank financial entities. No decree text or supervisory action under them is held. Nothing of the kind was on record at the window's opening. A member's proposal for a national identity card for children carrying a photograph from age five, requiring amendment of the Child Law, was discussed at two workshops, with recommendations including a unified national child-data platform, a full biometric identification system for children, and linkage between health, education and other government databases. Participants also recommended a strict legal framework for protecting the resulting data. No bill has been tabled, and biometric identity processing is mandated by decree in one sector while unregulated as a national system: the digital identity app, the financial identity platform, the interior ministry's biometric verification platform and facial verification at mobile-line enrolment all operate with no statute of their own.	MOVEMENT
Equatorial Guinea	Identity rests on a 1957 registry law and a regional passport regulation, with reform under review. The statistical questionnaire records the position exactly: civil registration still runs on a registry law inherited from 1957. The biometric credential above it is regional, governed by the regulation applying the CEMAC biometric passport decree. Reform is under consideration rather than enacted: an interministerial council reviewed reform of the 1957 law in November 2025, and a draft decree would recode the tax identification number for individuals as well as companies.	NO CHANGE
Eritrea	No digital-identity statute exists; the closest instrument is the 1992 nationality proclamation (proclamation). No dedicated digital-identity statute was located. The closest identifiable legal instrument is the Nationality Proclamation 21/1992, still in force, which provides the legal basis for nationality certification through the Department of Internal Affairs and contains no digital-identity, electronic-identity, biometric or electronic-transactions framework (proclamation). Identity cards are nonetheless required by other systems: anti-money-laundering law obliges financial institutions to identify every customer (proclamation), and a national identity card is required before a passport is issued (country guidance). So the card carries statutory weight without a statute defining it, and nothing regulates what data it holds or who may read it.	NO CHANGE
Eswatini	Identity rests on the Identification Order of 1998; no digital identity Act exists, and three conventions went to senators for ratification in July 2026. The King's Order in Council of 1998 establishes the population register and the personal identity number, and is the founding legal instrument behind national identity; no dedicated digital-identity Act is held (Order). The ICT minister presented the African Union Malabo Convention on cyber security and personal data protection, the Budapest Convention on cybercrime and the Tampere Convention to senators for ratification on 10 July 2026 (workshop). SADC ICT ministers had urged member states to consider ratifying Malabo in September 2019 (ministerial). Seven years later it is at the presentation stage. The digital identity itself remains planned under the Digital Eswatini project, with no legal basis on file for it.	MOVEMENT on treaty ratification rather than on any identity statute

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Ethiopia	The 2023 identification proclamation became a binding operational requirement across banking, with migration to the new verification service mandated (decision). The central bank and the national identity programme began harmonising all bank customer account numbers with the national digital identity, mandating migration from the first to the second verification service for all new and existing accounts with a deadline of 30 March 2026 (decision). The government stated in December 2025 that 30 million citizens had been registered and that the identity had been carried into Digital Ethiopia 2030 with integration planned down to the lowest administrative levels (statement). The statute itself was not amended in the window; what moved is the weight placed on it (Digital Identification Proclamation 1284/2023). The base holds no statutory limit on state access to identity data and no redress route for a registrant, which is carried separately as a not-held position.	MOVEMENT
Gabon	The identity framework rests on two named texts, a law on the personal identification number and one on the civil registry centre, neither with a date. Both texts are named as the legal basis of the national digital identity system, with no adoption, promulgation or gazette date for either (framework). They were named again in the stocktake of legal identity projects, which lists three separate systems resting on them (legal identity stocktake). Neither text has a number, date or gazette reference on file, so the identity card, the biometric register and the digital identity system all operate on a basis the base cannot read.	NO CHANGE
Gambia	The digital identity strategy for 2023 to 2028 is in force and now carries a delivered system, with no statute governing it. The strategy was validated at a supported workshop in May 2024 and provided for a system that has since been built (validation, strategy). What the base does not hold is the legal basis for issuing identity cards outside the country, which the opposition alleged was unlawful in August 2025 for issuance in Mauritania, Congo and Togo; no official response, regulation or registry statement has followed (allegation).	NO CHANGE
Ghana	Amendment regulations in force from June 2026 make biometric-only verification law and bar visual inspection and photocopying of the card. The regulations were signed on 2 March 2026, gazetted on 27 March and came into force on 9 June, with penalties running to 2,000 penalty units for an organisation (regulations); the gazetted artefact is an image scan with no text layer, so the regulation is not machine-readable (regulations, agency statement). A fee schedule made under separate 2025 regulations took effect on 2 February 2026: first registration free below 25 and GH¢30 at 25 and over, replacement GH¢200 and record updates free, across 276 district offices, the agency stating it was approved by Parliament rather than introduced by the agency (fees).	MOVEMENT
Guinea	Three decrees of 14 April 2025 create an 18-character personal identification number and constitute the national register of natural persons; a further decree of 22 June 2026 provides for a subscriber identity certification platform. 2025-04-14 - the first decree creates an 18-character personal identification number, permanent, univocal and for life, assigned to every citizen on issue of the birth record and to foreigners on entry in the register, expressly not proof of nationality, composed of 13 digits, three letters and a two-digit check key over sex, birth year and month, place of birth and a random block. The second constitutes the national register of natural persons as the biographic and biometric database fed by the civil status register, requires the number to be presented when requesting any public or private service, and lists the data captured including digitally captured fingerprints and the parents' numbers. The third sets security, integrity and data-protection conditions for civil-status data. The statutes above them are the two civil-status and identification laws of 25 October 2023, being popularised by the identity office. 2026-06-22 - a decree provides for deployment and operation of a national platform certifying the identity of subscriber-card holders and users of telecommunications services; the regulator publishes its title and date only, not its articles.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Guinea-Bissau	No identity statute is held; enrolment runs on a contracted production network and the regional card scheme. The base holds no Guinean law governing the identity register or the biometric card. What it holds is delivery: an eighteenth identity card production centre opened in June 2026 and a third regional enrolment centre in February. The governing frame is regional rather than national: a consultation opened in February 2026 on a roadmap from national identification systems to the regional biometric card.	NO CHANGE
Kenya	The High Court recognised a registered phone number as a personal digital identifier and gave the Attorney-General six months to legislate. The judgment also bars recycling of dormant numbers without consent; the window was still open as at 12 August 2026 with nothing tabled and closes about September (judgment). Analysis of it argues the judgment should produce a coordinated number-recycling policy binding banks, savings societies and platforms that keep relying on numbers after reassignment (analysis). It is the only instrument in the base that defines a digital identifier in law, and it arrived through litigation rather than through Parliament.	MOVEMENT
Lesotho	The National Identity Cards Act 2011 is the founding statute; an electoral Bill now ties voter registration to the identity number. 2011-03-21 — Act 9 of 2011 establishes the National Identity Register and the identity-card regime, commenced in 2013. 2026-06-04 — the Senate adopted its legislation committee's report on the electoral amendment Bill, which ties voter registration and verification to the national identity number. 2026-06-29 — the home affairs ministry opened a workshop on a systems architecture and modernisation framework, setting out the legal and institutional implications of the reforms proposed. No amendment to the 2011 Act is before Parliament.	MOVEMENT
Liberia	The 2011 Act is the enacting statute for the biometric register and remains unamended. The National Identification Registry Act, approved 1 August 2011, repeals the earlier decree, creates the autonomous registry, and makes the National Biometric Identification System, the biometric card and the Social Security Number the primary government identity number. What has moved since is executive rather than legislative: Executive Order 147 of April 2025 compels enrolment and verification, with data handling bound back to Part IX of the same Act. No amending statute is on the record.	NO CHANGE
Libya	Law 8 of 2014 creates the twelve-digit national number, mandatory from birth for every state service. The law is the statutory basis for everything built since: a twelve-digit number assigned from birth and required to obtain any state service. The institution beneath it is older — the civil registry authority created by decree in 1998 — and the competences were redistributed by a 2018 presidential council decision that gave the information authority the national database. No amending statute has been passed.	NO CHANGE
Madagascar	Two identification laws cleared constitutional review inside the window: the founding 2025 law and a 2026 special birth-registration law. The Constitutional Court declared the law on identification of natural persons constitutional in August 2025, after adoption by the National Assembly on 3 July and the Senate on 4 July (decision). A second law, for derogatory registration of adults without birth certificates, was adopted on 21 April 2026 (adoption) and cleared for promulgation on 13 May 2026 (decision). Enrolment under the framework opened in January 2026 (launch). Neither promulgated text is held; the base carries the Court's decisions on them.	MOVEMENT
Malawi	The National Registration Act is under review and registration service fees were raised by regulations gazetted in July 2026. A consultative meeting under the acceleration project reviewed the registration Act and the marriage and family relations statute, the bureau stating the aim is a modern and secure civil registration and identification system; no bill, draft or timetable is on record (review). Amendment regulations gazetted on 31 July 2026 raised fees for identity card replacement, electronic know-your-customer verification, civil registration and marriage services; the individual levels and their previous values are not carried in the record held, so the size of the increase is not established, and the electronic verification charge is a charge on third parties for using the identity system (fees).	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mali	The national identification number was instituted by law 06-040 of 2006, with decree 06-442 fixing how it applies. Both founding texts are now held (law, decree). They are twenty years old and the base holds no amendment and no enrolment, coverage or issuance figure against them, so the identifier's legal footing is settled and its reach is not. The agency for securing civil status documents was created by ordinance in February 2025 (agency).	NO CHANGE
Mauritania	The civil status code of 2011 created the national population register, and law 2025-011 replaced certain of its provisions in February 2025. The 2011 law repealed and replaced the 1996 code and is the instrument behind the national population register (code); law n. 2025-011 of 24 February 2025 repeals and replaces certain of its provisions (amendment). Both texts are held in Arabic and the base does not hold a consolidated version, so which provisions the 2025 law changed is not established from the record.	MOVEMENT
Mauritius	The 1985 identity card Act carries the digital card through 2024 regulations, and a Road Traffic (Amendment) Bill would give the digital driving licence legal recognition. The Act has been in force since April 1986 and is the statutory basis for the card (Act); the regulations of February 2024 set the terms on which the card and the mobile identity are issued and read (regulations). The Road Traffic (Amendment) Bill would make the digital driving licence an official electronic version equivalent to the traditional one and let holders settle fixed penalties online, across more than 800,000 licence holders; the Bill text is not held and no enactment date is stated. The Finance Act 2026, assented in August, carries the statutory changes behind the budget's identity and registry measures (Act). The Electronic Transactions (Amendment) Act 2026 was enacted in May (Act). A forty-year-old card statute is doing the work, extended by regulation rather than replaced.	MOVEMENT
Morocco	Law 72-18 creates the population and social registries, the civil and social digital identifier and the register agency, deferring force to implementing texts. The statute was promulgated by dahir in August 2020 and creates the national population register, the unified social register, the civil and social digital identifier and the national register agency (law). Articles 19 and 22 carve out defence and security processing, and article 45 defers force to implementing texts. The base holds no implementing decree, so the identifier's legal operation cannot be established from the statute alone.	MOVEMENT
Mozambique	The digital certification framework is unamended; the ICT institute signed a memorandum with Brazil on digital certification on 13 February 2026 covering the root certification authority behind it. 2026-02-13 — the national ICT institute signed a memorandum with Brazil's information technology institute to cooperate on digital certification, digital-identity technologies and the root certification authority underpinning the national digital certification system. The law behind it did not move: that system rests on a 2019 decree under a 2017 statute, and neither was amended in the window. A memorandum is a cooperation instrument, not a legal one, and no term, budget or deliverable is published for it.	NO CHANGE the 2017 and 2019 instruments stand and the movement was cooperation rather than law
Namibia	The Civil Registration and Identification Act 13 of 2024 is the statutory basis for a single civil register and a unique identity number, and a gazette notice withdrawing older documents has not issued. The Act was assented in December 2024 as the basis for a single civil register, a unique identity number and identity-data confidentiality, and was read by officials in July 2026 as permitting institutions to accept either the physical card or its digital version, with disclosure conditional on the holder's consent; the commencement date is not established in this base (Act, reading). The notice that will end the validity of pre-independence cards, older documents and current machine-readable cards has not issued, so until it does the September 2026 card is additive rather than replacing anything (notice). 2026-09-07 - the instrument under which the trust chain is accredited is now held: General Notice 953 of 2025 under the Electronic Transactions Act, in force from 15 June 2026, sets the regulator's accreditation regime for security products and services and for the certification service providers that supply them. No accreditation register, fee schedule or list of accredited products is published alongside it.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Niger	An ordonnance of April 2026 with its application decree replaced the civil-status regime, and a National Nationality Register was instituted under the justice ministry. The ordonnance of 22 April 2026 and its application decree of 18 May are in force, and no gazetted text is held (ordonnance). The same ordonnance institutes a national nationality register under the justice ministry (register). Between them the civil, nationality and population registers are set up by one instrument, which is a cleaner legal basis than most units in this base have and is not yet matched by an operating system.	MOVEMENT
Nigeria	The NIMC Act 2026 makes the identity number the foundational credential, and a legal reading puts mandatory use across passports, banking, telecommunications and land dealings. The Act replaces the 2007 statute, recognises the identity number as the foundational credential under a one-person-one-identity policy, incorporates the data-protection regime and lets the commission prosecute identity fraud; the gazetted text was still not publicly available about six weeks after assent, so neither the expansion reading nor the counter-reading can be checked against it (Act, transformation, analysis). On a law firm's reading the commission becomes the root certification authority for a national public key infrastructure and the national biometric-data repository, use of the number is made mandatory across four named sectors, the Act states that proof of identity is not proof of eligibility or citizenship, and unauthorised database access carries penalties of at least NGN10m or five years for an individual (reading).	MOVEMENT
Rwanda	A single digital identification law writes a June 2027 sunset of all legacy documents into statute, and the law's number and enactment date are not held. The sunset is written into the law rather than set by administrative decision, which is what makes the enrolment count a legal deadline rather than a target (deadline, enrolment). The law's number and enactment date are not held, so the base cannot say what it provides on correction, appeal or exclusion for anyone unenrolled when legacy documents cease to be valid.	MOVEMENT
Sao Tome and Principe	An aggregated identification document law was flagged as urgent by a lender mission in 2025, its absence stated as a potential constraint on data collection, and no later source confirms passage. The mission flagged review, public consultation, finalisation and approval as urgent (law). A year later nothing records movement. The foundational digital identity it would govern has live prototypes and a system integrator engaged, so the build is running ahead of the statute — the same order this frame finds in most units.	NO CHANGE
Senegal	A bill on computerising civil-status management remains listed among outstanding steps, validated but not enacted, and the register-reconstitution decree is likewise unsigned. The bill appears among outstanding steps in the agency's own August 2025 presentation and again in the June 2026 programme closing report (bill, closure). Validated is not enacted. The digitisation programme it would govern has meanwhile closed its external financing, deployed software across most centres and loaded millions of records, so the legal basis trails the system by a wide margin.	NO CHANGE
Seychelles	The identity-card statute was amended in 2023 on identity numbers and disclosure; no statute names or governs the SeyID credential itself. Part 13 of the 2023 omnibus Act amends the National Identity Cards Act on the national identity number requirement, cards for non-resident citizens and the rules on disclosing information, and does not create the digital credential (Act). The December 2025 cybercrimes amendment defines subscriber information — identity, address and billing or service details — for evidential purposes, the strongest in-window legal movement touching identity data (amendment). So the physical card has a statute and the digital credential has none: SeyID rests on administrative practice, which is a different kind of guarantee.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sierra Leone	The National Civil Registration Act 2016 is the governing statute, with a replacement Bill validated in November 2025. The 2016 Act establishes the National Civil Registration Authority as an independent body with its own board and a confidentiality duty (Act); a draft Civil Registration and Identification Bill completed final national validation on 19 November 2025 and is not yet before Parliament (Bill). The subscriber regulations phase-out of unregistered cards was announced on 30 July 2026, linking registration to the national identification number, and the instrument's own text is not held (regulations). Government conceded on 4 August 2026 that the linkage is incomplete (linkage). That concession matters because the fraud response recorded elsewhere rests on registration and identity verification as its principal control, and the control is admitted to be partial.	MOVEMENT
Somalia	The 2023 identity law gained its implementing regulation in June 2024, and a civil status law followed in April 2026. Law No. 009 of March 2023 is the founding statute for the identity authority and the national digital identity system (law). Its implementing regulation was made by the Prime Minister on 8 June 2024 and gazetted that October (regulation). Law No. 46, published 5 April 2026, adds the civil-registration and vital-statistics layer beside the identity infrastructure (law). The base now holds all three primary texts. What it does not hold is any provision setting out how the identity system and the civil register are to be joined.	MOVEMENT
South Africa	Draft identification regulations were gazetted on 4 May 2026 and consulted to 6 June, while the National Identification and Registration Bill is still before Parliament. 2026-05-04 — draft amendments to the Identification Regulations were gazetted, with a 33-day comment period closing on 6 June 2026. They would create voluntary digital-ID credentials with legal parity to the physical document, grant accredited trusted entities API access to the population register under data-sharing agreements, and set three assurance levels, seven-year audit logs and private-sector enrolment points, with finalisation dated September 2026. The primary legislation has not kept pace. The National Identification and Registration Bill remains before Parliament, named as the statutory foundation the regulations should rest on, and the record does not say whether its passage is now a precondition. A submission on the closing day asked the department to suspend the regulations pending that Bill, a published digital identity policy and demonstrated compliance with the data protection Act, on the ground that a biometric enrolment and real-time verification system is being built with no formal role for the Information Regulator. That submission is held as a supplied document with no published address, so it cannot be linked here.	MOVEMENT the regulations moved ahead of the Bill they are said to rest on
South Sudan	The Nationality Act 2011, Civil Registry Act 2018 and 2024 identity regulations are the framework, and the World Bank finds implementation extremely limited. The Nationality Act 2011 establishes the Directorate of Nationality, Passports and Immigration and requires it to maintain a Register of South Sudanese Nationals, the nationality certificate being the credential it creates (Act). With the Civil Registry Act 2018 it forms the general foundation, and the Civil Registration and National Identification Regulations 2024, drafted under sections 33 and 39 of that Act, supply the detail: procedures, data requirements and operational arrangements for the civil registry, and interoperability and mutual recognition across the national identity card, the residence permit card and the refugee identity card. Together they provide for interoperable credentials keyed to an issued Personal Identification Number (diagnostic). The gap is implementation rather than text: the same diagnostic finds it extremely limited, with weak governance, low capacity and no resources behind it, and nothing is held on a Personal Identification Number having been issued to anyone.	NO CHANGE
Sudan	The Electronic Transactions Act 2007 and the Civil Registry Act 2011 carry the digital identity; two later instruments it cites are not held. The 2007 Act covers digital signatures, electronic authentication and certification, and establishes an electronic licensing committee (Act). The 2011 Act founds the civil registry and its unique national number, and requires the registry to supply data to competent state organs (Act). The national digital identity's terms, published 21 May 2026, cite both, plus a digital identity regulation of 2025 and a cybersecurity act of 2025 (terms). Neither 2025 instrument could be located as an independently accessible text, so the legal basis a reader can check stops at 2011.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Tanzania	A 1986 statute is still the law under which digital identity is issued, reported on to parliament in August 2026. The founding 1986 statute establishes registration of persons and identity-card issuance and is still in force as the 2023 consolidated edition. The home affairs minister presented the identity authority's and immigration department's implementation report to parliament's foreign affairs, defence and security committee on 19 August 2026. A statute written three decades before the digital identity built on it, with no amendment covering that layer, is the whole of the legal basis on this record. The bill that would extend it to registration from birth has not been enacted.	NO CHANGE
Togo	A review of the 2009 civil registration law held its scoping meeting, with proposals due before the end of 2026. The scoping meeting was held in August 2026 (review). It is the statute under which the birth-registration catch-up campaigns and the online certificate pilot operate, and the review is the first movement on it the base holds. No draft or proposal is on record.	MOVEMENT
Tunisia	Organic laws on biometric identity were adopted in March 2024, and civil society records that committee deliberations lacked public consultation. The laws were adopted by parliament on 6 March 2024, with use of the biometric card and passport targeted for the first half of 2025 (laws, usage, rollout). The consultation criticism is an attributed position rather than a finding of this report. Two and a half years on, whether issuance has begun is recorded separately as not established — so the enabling statutes are in force and their effect is unmeasured.	NO CHANGE
Uganda	The 2015 Registration of Persons Act is unchanged, but two of its provisions were operationalised: 13.3 million renewals and first cards for resident foreign nationals. The statute has not moved: the Registration of Persons Act, Chapter 332 has stood since March 2015, establishing the registration authority and the National Identification Register, and the base holds no amendment to it. 2025-12 - the registration authority reported that more than 13.3 million national identity cards had been renewed and extended the mass renewal and registration exercise to February 2026, to reach those missed in earlier phases. 2026-08 - the alien-registration provisions were operationalised for the first time, the authority beginning to issue identification cards to legally resident foreign nationals at its Kampala offices. So the movement here is administrative rather than legislative, and the base holds no count of foreign nationals registered or cards issued to them.	MOVEMENT
Zambia	A statutory instrument amended the citizenship regulations while the registration department began computerising document issuance. 2025-12-31 — Statutory Instrument No. 98 of 2025 amended the citizenship regulations, the clearest in-window regulatory movement touching national identity documents. 2025-08 — the home affairs permanent secretary announced that the registration department has begun computerising national registration card, passport and citizenship-document issuance with the state technology institute, targeting online applications including from the diaspora. The instruments governing identity are being amended at the edges while the system beneath them is rebuilt; no consolidated digital identity statute is held, and the new register's legal basis remains the National Registration Act.	MOVEMENT
Zimbabwe	No digital-identity Act is held. Identity rests on the National Registration Act, and a 2026 constitutional amendment moved the voters' roll to the registrar-general. The National Registration Act, commenced in 1976 and consolidated to 31 December 2016, is the statute under which the register of residents and the issue of identity documents sit (Act). Constitution of Zimbabwe Amendment (No. 3) Act, Act No. 6 of 2026, amends the Constitution to assign the registrar-general responsibility for voter registration and custody of the voters' roll, consolidating electoral identity under the national identity authority (amendment). The commissioning of the Mutare provincial registry office for biometric passport and identity services was described by the registrar-general as foundational to a digital identity system (registry office). There is no electronic-identity or digital-identity Act, and no legal basis on file for the national digital identity that remains announced and unlaunched.	MOVEMENT on a constitutional amendment rather than on any digital-identity statute

Digital payments legislation

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	A first regulation dedicated to payment service providers was followed by one bringing them inside the anti-money-laundering regime. The umbrella statute is the monetary and banking law of June 2023, whose article 166 repealed the prior ordinance. 2025-04-14 - the first Algerian regulatory instrument specifically dedicated to payment service providers was adopted by the central bank. 2025-09-24 - a second regulation explicitly brings payment service providers inside the anti-money-laundering regime, and in November the banking commission issued guidelines on virtual assets. No licence granted under the provider regime is recorded. 2025-08-17 - the operating rules followed the authorisation conditions: an instruction establishing three tiers of payment account by permitted balance at DZD 100,000, DZD 500,000 and DZD 1,000,000, allowing remote account opening by a secured technological process at all three, requiring providers to verify an agent's commercial registration, standing, experience and resources, and confining payment services to Algerian dinars inside the national territory. It also governs admission to the payment systems, reporting duties and the central bank's supervisory powers. No provider has been authorised on the record.	MOVEMENT
Angola	A non-bank acquirer and sub-acquirer regime arrived in January 2026, on top of electronic money accounts and the 2022 payment services rules. Angola legislates payments by central bank notice, and three arrived in sequence. The 2022 notice on the provision of payment services sets the authorisation regime; an August 2025 notice governs electronic money accounts; and a January 2026 notice creates the non-bank acquirer and sub-acquirer, opening merchant acquiring beyond the banks. Underneath them sits the structural instrument: the 2017 notice classifying the settlement and clearing subsystems, which names what each rail is and who operates it. Value limits are set separately by instructive.	MOVEMENT
Benin	The 2024 banking statute subjects payment and electronic-money institutions to licensing, permitted operations and supervision; the regional instant-payment instruction applies alongside it. The statute enacted on 2 September 2024 is the national-law baseline: it expressly subjects payment institutions and electronic-money institutions operating in Benin to licensing, permitted-operations and supervision rules. 2025-09-30 — the regional instant-payment platform launched under the central bank's own directly applicable instruction, which is the other half of the legal basis and is not Beninese law. The national statute and the regional instruction together are the position; neither moved after September 2025.	MOVEMENT
Botswana	Electronic payment regulations were amended in April 2026, extending scope to value transfer services and reaching beneficial owners, with unlicensed operation punishable by P1,000,000 and five years. 2026-04-02 — amended regulations came into effect extending scope to money or value transfer services, taking fit-and-proper tests down to beneficial owners and 10% shareholders, and making unlicensed operation punishable by P1,000,000 and five years, with the central bank's implementation release in July. Float interest is ring-fenced and directed by the central bank, and financial-inclusion promotion was dropped from the permitted uses without being replaced by any customer entitlement — which is the change a wallet holder would notice if anyone told them. The virtual-asset regime is unchanged and still criticised: the Act is in force with crypto not legal tender, and a regional follow-up assessment in February 2026 still records provider-oversight shortcomings.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Burkina Faso	A new banking regulation law was adopted unanimously on 26 June 2026, transposing the union's uniform banking law and extending its scope to financial technology companies and to payment and electronic-money operations. 2026-06-26 - the legislature adopted the law unanimously, transposing the monetary union's 2023 uniform banking law and expressly extending its scope to financial technology companies and new payment and electronic-money operations. It moves the domestic payments framework beyond the central bank's instruction and onto a domestic statute. It was not promulgated at the date of the account, and no implementing text is held. What operates underneath it is already regulated in fact: the regional instant-payment rail is live with nine domestic institutions authorised by February 2026, and the country holds 9.53 per cent of the union's 248 million electronic-money accounts.	MOVEMENT
Burundi	The 2018 payment-systems statute is the framework law; the central bank has since published an oversight framework and launched a national instant payment system. Loi n 1/07 du 11 mai 2018 portant systeme national de paiement is the framework statute, and the law the central bank cites for its power to regulate the issue and use of payment instruments; its articles 22 to 24 carry the move of payment instruments off paper and the admissibility of electronic and optical evidence. Every official copy located is an image-only scan. The central bank has published an oversight framework covering the real-time gross settlement system, the clearing house, the central securities depository, the national switch, instant payment systems and electronic money platforms, with a licensing, monitoring, inspection and sanction regime for payment service providers, and in April 2026 launched the national instant payment system under a regulation of its own.	MOVEMENT
Cape Verde	Two diplomas gazetted in one 2018 bulletin carry the whole regime: Decreto-Legislativo 7/2018 for the payment system and 8/2018 for payment services and electronic money. The first enacts the Cabo Verdean payment system and confers on the central bank its governance role: policy-setting for payment-system modernisation, superintendencia over the safety and efficiency of payment systems and instruments, power to issue general rules, to inspect participants and operators, to designate systems and operators, and to provide infrastructure and settlement. The second is the codified regime for the provision of payment services and the issue, distribution and reimbursement of electronic money. The exterior leg sits in a separate 2018 diploma, which consolidates the exchange legislation and makes the contracting and settlement of transfers to and from abroad generally free. No amendment to either is held.	NO CHANGE a standing position the base holds for the first time
Central African Republic	Payments are legislated regionally. Domestically the 2022 electronic transactions law is the only instrument reaching electronic dealing. No national payments statute appears on this base. The domestic instrument that touches electronic dealing is the electronic transactions law, alongside the cybersecurity and cybercrime law of 2024. The rules that actually govern payment come from the region: the interoperable code-payment standard adopted in July 2026 and the regional financial inclusion strategy. What operates domestically operates under those: mobile payment of the import declaration fee and electricity bills paid over mobile.	NO CHANGE
Chad	There is no national payments statute; the operative law is the regional regulation of December 2016, with national practice set by convention. The central bank's own register names Reglement n. 03/CEMAC/UMAC/CM of 21 December 2016 on payment systems among the constitutive instruments in force, directly applicable to Chad as a member state (register). The national layer is contractual. The finance minister chaired a meeting on 17 February 2026 with the four payment establishments operating in Chad to build an operational framework for moving state financial flows onto mobile money and pressed for a framework convention (meeting), and on 18 February signed partnership conventions with all four allowing public revenue to be paid through their platforms (conventions). A statute a citizen could be pointed to does not exist.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Comoros	The 2026 finance law puts electronic filing and payment of taxes on a statutory footing, above a 2017 electronic-money regulation. The standing instrument is the central bank's regulation on electronic-money activity, setting the conditions and modalities for carrying it on, on the authority of the 2013 banking law, the 2012 anti-money-laundering law and the 2015 payment-systems decree. 2025-12 - the finance law inserted a new section into the fiscal-procedures code establishing teledeclaration and telepayment, with a phased obligation on large and medium taxpayers, the legal value of an electronic filing, authentication, archiving and penalties for not using it, implementation dates left to regulation. 2026-04 - the tax directorate opened a three-day workshop to validate that legal framework, which places the implementing texts still in draft four months after the statute.	MOVEMENT
Congo	An order of 22 May 2026 makes all public revenue payable exclusively through one national platform, with payment outside it void. The order was signed on 22 May 2026 and gazetted on 11 June with a 60-day conformity window: all public revenue is payable exclusively through one national platform, defined in the text as a national and sovereign payments switch, payment outside it is void and non-discharging, and administrations must suppress every parallel circuit. Derogations are limited to technical unavailability, absence of access to electronic means, or duly established exceptional circumstances. It is the most categorical digital-payments instrument on this ledger, and it obliges the state rather than the market.	MOVEMENT
Cote d'Ivoire	A banking regulation bill adopted in April 2026 would bring financial technology firms and electronic money into the national banking perimeter. 2026-04-29 - the Council of Ministers adopted a bill aligning national law with the monetary union's uniform banking law, bringing financial technology firms and new operations such as electronic money - which the communique states are not covered by current legislation - into the national banking perimeter; a second bill reforming microfinance regulation was adopted at the same sitting. Both are government-adopted bills. No parliamentary passage, promulgation or entry into force is held for either, and the communique states no date by which either is expected. The regional instruments the bill aligns to are already directly applicable, so what the bill adds is national enforcement rather than the rule itself.	MOVEMENT a bill adopted in council and not yet enacted
Djibouti	Payments are governed by a 2016 law placing every payment service under central-bank licensing and supervision, unchanged in the period. The law applies to every payment service and system operated in the country, empowers the central bank to license, regulate and supervise payment-system providers, and defines electronic money and electronic funds transfer. Beneath it the central bank acts by instruction rather than by statute: from 31 August 2025 all cheques had to meet new format, security and encoding standards, with non-conforming cheques refused by the settlement platform and legacy stock withdrawn, a measure that took effect a day before this period opened. No amendment, and no implementing text on electronic money issued in the period, is held.	NO CHANGE
DR Congo	The 2018 statute governs payment systems, payment instruments and electronic money and makes the central bank the supervisory authority; the bank legislates under it by instruction. The statute runs to 139 articles across eight titles; its third article defines electronic money and the electronic payment instrument, and it makes the central bank the supervisory and regulatory authority over payment systems and instrument issuers. The bank continues to add to it by instruction rather than by amendment: a pricing-schedule notice of 31 October 2025 applies to financial intermediaries including electronic money establishments, and the notice's own operative text is not held, the regulator's page exposing only its title, date and scope. What the statute has not produced is a modernisation programme: the bank instructed its technical services in September 2026 to draw up a roadmap for modernising the national payments system, eight years on.	NO CHANGE a standing position the base holds for the first time

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Egypt	The central bank approved regulations for a digital financial identity platform and the financial regulator admitted two projects to its sandbox. 2025-09 - the central bank issued regulations on governance, internal control and fit-and-proper criteria for key officials of payment system operators and payment service providers - the conduct rules beneath the payments market. 2026-08-23 - its board approved the regulations governing the digital financial identity platform for identifying bank customers and verifying their identities electronically, which is the rule that lets an account be opened without a counter. 2026-09-01 - the financial regulator granted preliminary approval for two further technology projects to enter its regulatory sandbox. No licence issued under the payment-institution rules, and no count of customers identified through the platform, appears on this ledger.	MOVEMENT
Equatorial Guinea	A presidential order banned cash collection of taxes and fees, routing public revenue to bank accounts and electronic platforms. The order of September 2025 is the operative instrument: cash collection of taxes, fees and other administrative revenue is prohibited and payment must go to bank accounts or electronic platforms. It bites on benefits too — social benefits are now paid bank-only, and a 2025 census purged 2,282 untraceable pensioners. The regional layer moved separately: the deposit insurance ceiling rose to 8m CFA for individuals and 15m for firms from 10 December 2025.	MOVEMENT
Eritrea	A regional peer assessment records a state-owned financial system with no cash machines, cards or internet banking (evaluation). A regional anti-money-laundering peer assessment, adopted in July 2025 after an on-site visit in 2024, states that Eritrea's financial system is state-owned and offers simple and less sophisticated services, with no automatic teller machines, debit or credit cards, or internet banking (evaluation). There is therefore nothing for payments legislation to regulate, and the base holds no payment systems act, no e-money regulation and no licensing regime. The only draft text addressing digital finance is an unofficial consultation draft (drafts). The one instrument on the ledger is a central bank legal notice ordering cash deposits, which is currency management rather than payments law.	NO CHANGE
Eswatini	The National Payments System Act 2023 is in force, regulations to operationalise it were approved by Cabinet in July 2026, and the fast-payments platform completed onboarding in November 2025. The Act of 2023 provides for the regulation and supervision of payment systems, the safety and efficiency of the national payments system and the central bank's functions in relation to them (Act). Cabinet approved National Payment Systems Regulations of 2026 in the first quarter of 2026/27 to operationalise it; no gazette text, publication or commencement date is held (Cabinet). The central bank governor told a regional report launch on 13 November 2025 that the eighth and final participant would go live on the fast-payments platform two days later (remarks). The statute is the enablement and the switch is the delivery; the regulations between them are approved and unpublished.	MOVEMENT
Ethiopia	The central bank widened its virtual-asset prohibition to the whole category, and a court struck down a decree revoking licences without a court order. A central-bank public notice of 23 July 2026 widened the prohibition by clarification rather than by new rule, covering use, purchase, sale, exchange, transfer, trading, settlement and facilitation absent express authorisation, with no new regulation and no enforcement mechanism announced (public notice). The Federal High Court of Lideta struck down a December 2025 lottery-administration decree that had cut banking services to betting platforms and gateways, holding revocation of a licence without a court order unconstitutional (the ruling). No payments proclamation or electronic transactions statute is held, so the operative law reaches the base as directives, notices and one judgment.	MIXED the central bank widened a prohibition by notice while a court struck down a decree

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Gabon	An ordinance of 29 January 2026 fixes the rules for digital payments, characterised by the government as filling a legal vacuum, and the 2026 finance law makes electronic payment compulsory for large and medium taxpayers. The ordinance fixes the rules applicable to digital payments across the country, characterised by the government as filling a legal vacuum with a protective framework, with a ratification bill before the National Assembly. 2025-12-30 - the finance law carries the obligations: taxpayers of the large and medium enterprise directorates must pay taxes and duties exclusively by electronic means or through the online tax platform, standardised electronic invoices must be issued through systems approved by the tax directorate, and transactions at or above FCFA 500,000 must be settled by bank transfer or electronic wallet, with penalties attached. An annual finance law is where the payments duties actually sit, which means they are renewable and revisable each year rather than settled in a standing statute.	MOVEMENT
Gambia	The 2011 mobile money regulation remains the rulebook, carrying the interoperability duty the 2025 switch delivers on. The regulation made in October 2011 sets a GMD10m capital floor, a cash-merchant regime and a duty to interoperate. A separate pricing policy effective December 2013 sets cost-recovery tariffs for the settlement system, clearing house, securities settlement and the national switch. The interoperability duty took fourteen years to deliver: the instant payment switch launched in December 2025 links banks, mobile money and fintechs on a phased rollout.	NO CHANGE
Ghana	The Virtual Asset Service Providers Act 2025 passed in December 2025, and a digital banking framework is complete and awaiting consultation. Before it there was no statute, against more than 3 million virtual-asset users and over 100 service providers recorded in a July 2025 registration exercise, with regulated institutions directed not to facilitate virtual-asset activity at all. On the regulator's account the Act is risk-based and technology-neutral, splits supervision between the central bank and the securities regulator by activity, and attaches licensing to the service rather than to holding; the gazetted text is not held, so every characterisation is the central bank's own. 2026-09-03 - the coordinating committee is constituted and chaired by the central bank governor, joining the securities regulator, the finance ministry, the cyber security authority and the financial intelligence centre, working towards having the Act fully in force by 2027. 2026-09-04 - a second sandbox cohort of ten was admitted by the securities regulator with the central bank, one a stablecoin infrastructure provider testing payment, fiat settlement and wallet infrastructure under supervision. The cohort list and exit criteria are not held.	MOVEMENT
Guinea	There is no payments statute, and the national payment council that would sit under one is at terms-of-reference stage. Both the payments law and the council are at terms-of-reference stage under the donor programme, the law awaiting the lender's no-objection; the position comes from the central bank's own project register, which is undated and whose latest dated entry is January 2025 (project register). On virtual assets the central bank issued a warning rather than a regime: it states it has granted no licence or authorisation to any entity for crypto-asset trading or online financial placement, sets out seven warning signs of fraudulent offers, notes that registration with a foreign authority is not a domestic licence, and reserves the right to refer illegal fund collection, money laundering and fraud to the courts (communique). What stands instead of a statute is central bank regulation: instructions, conventions and rulebooks covering real-time gross settlement, cheque and bill clearing, Swift and the clearing house, among them Instruction No 74 of 9 October 2017 on the gross settlement system (regulatory framework). The page publishing them is an index, each instrument behind its own link.	NO CHANGE
Guinea-Bissau	Payment law is regional: the central bank's register licenses six banks, one payment institution and one electronic money issuer. No domestic payments statute appears in the base. Authorisation runs through the monetary union: the first licensed payment institution in the country appeared on the register in September 2025, and the June 2026 register carries six banks, one payment institution and one electronic money issuer. Domestic instruments are administrative rather than legislative: the revenue directorate's order making the payment platform the sole channel for the tax identification number.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Kenya	Virtual asset regulations were gazetted in July 2026 with joint licensing across ten categories, and existing operators have until November to transition. The 2025 Act commenced on 4 November 2025, giving pre-existing operators a year to comply (the Act). The regulations set capital by licence class from KES 300m for stablecoin issuance to nil for advisers, with a seizure and freezing framework; the draft ownership cap was dropped between draft and gazette, and the Finance Bill replaces a proposed 3 per cent transfer tax with a 10 per cent excise duty on provider fees (regulations, compliance cost). Six named exchanges have said they intend to apply, and the regulators had not announced the application process as at 7 August 2026 (applicants). On mobile money the position is different in kind: the central bank's pricing principles operate through voluntary operator alignment, with no gazetted tariff rule or determination to cite, appeal or extend to a competitor, reversible at the operator's discretion (pricing principles).	MOVEMENT
Lesotho	The Payment System Bill reached second reading in May 2026, to replace the 2014 Act and license fintech providers. 2014-09-12 — the Payment Systems Act governs payment systems and instruments, electronic money and cards among them. 2025-11-17 — the financial sector strategy sets strengthening the payments system and access to digital financial services as cross-cutting priorities. 2026-05-05 — the finance minister moved the Payment System Bill to second reading, to repeal and replace the 2014 Act and license fintech payment providers. No enactment date is on the record.	MOVEMENT
Liberia	The mobile money regulations are in force and unamended, and the interoperable fee schedule of 2026 was approved under them. They are the central bank's standing mobile-money framework (regulations). No payments statute, electronic transactions act or switch instrument sits above them, so a fee schedule for a national instant payment system rests on a regulation written before that system existed.	NO CHANGE
Libya	A prime-ministerial decree of 6 March 2026 obliges treasuries and collecting agencies to accept electronic payment, the first such instrument on file. The decree was issued on 6 March 2026 and is reported alongside a cut in the foreign-exchange levy, making electronic acceptance a duty of state collecting bodies rather than an option (decree). The base holds no implementing regulation, no compliance deadline and no penalty for a body that does not comply.	MOVEMENT
Madagascar	The 2016 electronic money law remains the governing instrument; nothing amended it in the window. The statute runs to 120 articles and licenses electronic money institutions under the banking supervisor (law); its constitutionality was confirmed in January 2017 (decision). The 2026 finance law, itself cleared by the Constitutional Court in December 2025, carries mobile transaction tax provisions (decision). The central bank's digital currency project has a published distribution model and a pilot framed for August 2026, with no legislative instrument behind it in the base (project).	NO CHANGE
Malawi	A financial crimes amendment removing all references to cheques passed Parliament in August 2026, one of four bills effecting the cheque phase-out. The bill was passed alongside amendments to the payment systems and deposit insurance statutes, following a bills of exchange amendment that effects the phase-out (bills). Assent, gazette date and commencement are not published, and the safeguarding regulations the finance minister promised are not drafted. A member warned that rural users risk being left behind by the switch away from cheques (warning), and the base holds no primary for the discontinuation itself and no date for it.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mali	The 2016 electronic transactions law is the governing statute; payment rules come from the regional central bank rather than from Bamako. The domestic statute is the 2016 law on electronic transactions, exchanges and services, and nothing in the window amends it. Payments themselves are regulated regionally. The regional central bank runs the instant payment platform Mali's banks connect to and extended the participation deadline in June 2026, having published the participant list in April. Consumer protection sits in the 2015 consumer protection law rather than in a payments instrument. No national payment systems act appears on the base.	NO CHANGE
Mauritania	Law 2021-014 on electronic payment services and means has been in force since July 2021 and is the statute the central bank's payment instructions are issued under. The Official Gazette text of 30 July 2021 covers definitions, electronic payment services and means, payment cards and the contestation of a card payment (law, text). The held capture is an excerpt cut off partway through Titre III, so the later articles the central bank's own instruction cites are not on file, and no implementing decree, licensing decision or amendment to the statute is held.	NO CHANGE a statute in force since 2021 that the base has only now acquired
Mauritius	The 2018 payment systems Act is the governing statute; a payment aggregator guideline was issued under it in July 2026. The Act was assented in November 2018 and is now at its seventh consolidated version (Act, consolidation). The central bank issued a guideline for payment aggregators in July 2026, bringing them under a stated supervisory expectation for the first time (guideline). The financial-crime statute book was amended in April 2026 (Act). No enforcement action, licence refusal or sanction under the payments Act is held.	MOVEMENT
Morocco	Law 103-12 defines electronic money, payment accounts and non-bank payment institutions under central bank approval. The banking law of 2014 is the statutory basis for Moroccan payment institutions, and no amending statute appears in the base. What governs conduct is made under it rather than beside it: the interchange cap cut to 0.50 per cent from 1 October 2026 by the central bank and the competition authority, and the consolidated forex rulebook in force from 1 January 2026.	NO CHANGE
Mozambique	The central bank made connection to the single national payments network mandatory with 60-minute incident reporting and set an annual ceiling on card payments abroad. 2026-06-02 — a central-bank notice made connection to the single national network mandatory for electronic payment services and imposed 60-minute incident-reporting, continuity and disaster-recovery duties on financial institutions. The gazette text was not locatable, and the base holds the fullest available account instead. 2026-07-28 — a further notice set an annual limit of 3,000,000 meticais on external payments made with bank cards, revoking the December 2025 notice it replaces, this one the primary gazette text. Two instruments moved in two months, in opposite directions: one compels participation in a domestic rail, the other caps what can leave through a foreign one.	MOVEMENT
Namibia	The Payment System Management Act commenced in August 2023, its licensing determination took effect in January 2026, and government-to-person payments went live in June. The Act commenced on 8 August 2023, and the central bank's PSD-1 determination brought licensing and authorisation of payment service providers into operation on 6 January 2026 (commencement, determination). Under the Act the payments association moved from a management council to a management board during 2025, and a fees and charges determination came into force in December 2025. The first live government-to-person grant payments ran over the national instant payment network on 17 June 2026 through one certified bank (disbursements). An operational and cybersecurity standard for the payment system followed in July 2026. The statute is doing what statutes are for: each determination under it lands as a dated rule.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Niger	The regional instant-payment platform set a June 2026 connection deadline for all supervised institutions after its September 2025 launch. The platform launched on 30 September 2025 as the union-wide instant payment infrastructure that Nigerien institutions connect to under the central bank's 2024 instruction. By 2 April 2026 80 participants were live across the union — 59 banks, nine electronic-money institutions, 11 microfinance institutions and one payment institution — with 42 more in production testing and a deadline of 30 June 2026 for all supervised banks, electronic-money, payment and microfinance institutions to complete connection. The regime is regional. No Nigerien domestic statute or regulation on digital payments is on file, and no national implementing text transposing the instruction has been located.	MOVEMENT
Nigeria	Crypto sits inside the securities perimeter, an executive order created a coordinating council, draft virtual-asset rules set capital thresholds and a stablecoin licensing regime is drafted. The Investments and Securities Act 2025 put crypto inside the securities perimeter (Act), and an executive order of July 2026 created a Virtual Asset Council and Office with its secretariat at the central bank, creating no new regulator and transferring no powers (order). Draft rules out for comment set N500m minimum capital for digital-asset platforms, N200m for service providers, a N30m registration fee, local incorporation and a resident chief executive (rules, data). A drafted issuer-licensing regime for fiat-collateralised stablecoins requires full reserves with licensed Nigerian banks, daily reconciliation and monthly audited publication; no instrument is issued (regime). The securities regulator has admitted further firms to an incubation programme with no graduation route published (incubation), and the central bank intends to run observer nodes on approved stablecoin blockchains (nodes). 2026-08-31 — the same draft also carries custody and incident duties: customer assets segregated from the firm's own with 80% held offline, N2bn minimum capital for exchanges and custodians, a fidelity bond of at least 25% of that minimum, incidents notified within 24 hours and reported within 48, and SEC approval before a foreign-issued stablecoin is listed. No commencement date or transition period is stated.	MOVEMENT
Rwanda	The lower house approved the rationale for a draft law on virtual assets in April 2026 with nothing reported since, above a central bank regulatory sandbox established in 2022. The chamber approved the rationale in April 2026 and nothing has been reported on the draft since (draft). The sandbox has run since 2022 on an analyst's account; its own regulation is not held, so its admission criteria, cohort and exit route are unstated (sandbox).	MOVEMENT
Sao Tome and Principe	The 2018 payment system law is in force, a new central bank organic law replaced the 1992 statute in 2025, and the 2026 budget law caps cash payments at 10,000 dobras. The payment system law applies to payment systems and providers operating in the country, makes the central bank regulator and overseer, and carries a chapter on electronic funds transfers between individuals, commercial entities and financial institutions (law). The 2025 organic law sets the bank's attributions to regulate and oversee payment systems and to license and supervise financial institutions (organic law). Article 9 of the 2026 budget law prohibits taxpayers with organised accounting from making or receiving cash payments of 10,000 dobras or more and requires a means identifying the payee, with cash spending above the limit not tax-deductible (budget law). That is the first instrument in this base compelling electronic settlement rather than enabling it.	MOVEMENT
Seychelles	The National Payment System Act 2014 is the statute, and December 2025 regulations made interoperable IT systems a licence condition. Act 14 of 2014 commenced on 18 August 2014 and has been amended by the 2022 electronic money regulations and a 2023 amendment Act (Act). The amendment to the licensing and authorisation regulations, made on 15 December 2025, requires safe and reliable IT systems and adequate interfaces to ensure straight-through processing as a condition of licence for payment, clearing and settlement operators (regulations). Cabinet approved amendments to the Foreign Exchange Act in July 2026 adding credit unions and payment service providers to the class of authorised dealers (Cabinet); that approval is not yet an enacted instrument.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sierra Leone	The National Payment Systems Act 2022 is the governing statute, with a Public Financial Management Act 2026 in consultation above it. The payment systems Act is Act 8 of 2022, gazetted on 23 June 2022, with subsidiary legislation made under it (Act). A draft Public Financial Management Act was consulted on in Freetown in August 2026 covering digital payments; no text, parliamentary stage or commencement date is published (draft). The communications Act was tested against the mobile-money fraud wave in a published legal analysis in July 2026 (Act). Between them and the cybercrime Act the country has statutes that reach the conduct. What it does not have, recorded separately, is a rule allocating the loss.	MOVEMENT
Somalia	The National Payment System Bill cleared both chambers by January 2026, replacing a regime that rested on 2020 mobile money regulations. The lower house passed the bill 154 to 2 on 8 November 2025 (vote) and the upper house carried its third reading 28 to nil in January 2026 (vote). It empowers the central bank to license and supervise payment systems and digital-money platforms. Until it is signed, the operative instrument remains the Mobile Money Regulations amended in 2020, covering licensing, conduct of business, safeguarding of consumer funds, supervision and winding-up (regulations). No record of presidential signature was found.	MOVEMENT
South Africa	A National Payment System Bill will go out for public comment, moving payment regulation from entity-based to activity-based (announcement). The Reserve Bank governor said on 1 September 2026 that the National Payment System Bill will soon go out for public comment, moving payment regulation from an entity-based model to an activity-based one (announcement). An activity-based model is what would open payment licensing to non-banks, which the base currently carries as a not-held position. Nothing is enacted: the base holds a governor's statement of intent, no published bill text, no comment period dates and no commencement provision.	MOVEMENT
South Sudan	A National Payment System Bill went to a five-day validation workshop in August 2026, with no text, introduction date or parliamentary timetable held. The workshop opened on 10 August 2026 (workshop, transition, bill). The separately recorded national instant payment system has been planned since early 2025 and has not moved, so the statute and the rail are both at the stage of intention.	MOVEMENT
Sudan	Four central bank instruments cover digital payments: mobile payment licensing, banking agency, USSD controls and anti-money-laundering controls. The 2020 regulation sets licensing conditions, capital and insurance requirements, e-money and trust-account rules and agent rules for mobile payment institutions (regulation). Three instruments were made inside the window. The banking agency regulation of 1 March 2026 lets banks deliver services through licensed agents outside branches (regulation). Circular 7/2026 sets binding consumer-protection requirements for USSD services (circular). Circular 8/2026 extends anti-money-laundering supervision to mobile and phone payment channels (circular). All four are central bank instruments made under the Banking Business Organisation Act 2004. No primary payments statute is held.	MOVEMENT
Tanzania	New complaint-handling guidelines replaced the 2015 set in November 2025, under the 2015 payment systems statute. The founding payment-systems statute of 2015 regulates payment-system licensing, electronic payment instruments and electronic money and assigns licensing and supervision to the central bank. Guidelines issued in November 2025 replaced the 2015 set, mandating standardised, no-fee, multi-channel complaint handling with digital channels required of providers operating digital platforms, statutory resolution timelines and a central-bank appeal and determination process. Regulations gazetted in December 2025 bring non-interest banking windows into a prudential and governance framework, including a mandatory core banking system able to process compliant transactions. No complaint volume or resolution-time series is published against the guidelines.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Togo	An anti-money-laundering law was adopted in the December 2025 budget session, with no promulgation date, number or gazette reference held. The source gives only the budget session, so the vote date is not established (law). It is the only payments-adjacent statute in this ledger, and its text cannot be read. Against six institutions live on the regional instant payment platform and a treasury prepaid card announced, the governing law is present as a headline.	MOVEMENT
Tunisia	The 2016 banking law carries the payment-institution regime, under which a national mobile-payment label was created in May 2026. Law 2016-48 brings electronic money within means of payment, covers remote and electronic payment services, and creates the payment-institution licensing regime, payment accounts, segregation of client funds and the central bank's rule-making power, under which its mobile-payment circulars are made. A central bank note of 5 May 2026 creates TUNPAY, a single national label for mobile payment, agreed with the national card and mobile-payment operator as switch operator, and directs banks, the postal service and payment institutions to adopt it across their networks and acceptance points. A licensing decision of 29 January 2026 granted definitive authorisation to a Qatari-owned fintech subsidiary, the sixteenth licensed payment institution, with six months to begin operating.	MOVEMENT
Uganda	Digital lending platform regulation was stated as intended at a finance ministry and parliamentary retreat, with no bill, instrument or timetable held. The intention was stated in August 2026 (intention). It is the only payments-specific legislative movement in this ledger, against a payments record that includes a stablecoin corridor, a tokenised-asset exchange, a currency-settlement service and a credit-scoring memorandum with nothing published about its consent or legal basis.	MOVEMENT
Zambia	The mobile money levy rate doubled during 2025, dated only to the year, and the source is an industry body arguing against such levies. The doubling is dated only to the year, so it cannot be placed inside or outside the window (levy). Naming the source's interest matters here: an industry body arguing against mobile money levies is the only account of this one, and no government or regulator statement of the rate or its yield is held.	NO CHANGE
Zimbabwe	The National Payment Systems Act of 2001 is the standing statute, and Statutory Instrument 65 of 2026 opened a licensed fintech sandbox at the Victoria Falls financial centre. The Act of 2001, commenced on 16 November 2001 and consolidated to 31 December 2016, provides for the recognition, operation, regulation and supervision of payment, clearing and settlement systems, electronic payment instructions included (Act). Statutory Instrument 65 of 2026, made under section 81 of the Banking Act, establishes a technology department and a financial technology lab at the Victoria Falls International Financial Services Centre, with application, licensing, variation, suspension, monitoring and interim and final reporting for tested activities (regulations). The instrument is held as a capture truncated near section 9, so the licensing conditions themselves are not on file.	MOVEMENT

Legislation enabling data interoperability

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	A national data-governance system was launched in February 2026 under a presidential decree of December 2025. 2026-02-09 - the prime minister launched the national data-governance system established by a presidential decree of 30 December 2025. The trust-services law of February 2026 is the other enabling instrument: it establishes the national trust-service and electronic-identification framework across 116 articles and requires trust-service-provider data to be hosted nationally. Neither is accompanied by an operating rule, a participating body, a dataset exchanged or a service built on it, so what is established is the legal frame and not its use.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Angola	The 2015 civil registration simplification law is the earliest statutory basis: electronic communication of registration data to social security, health and tax. The enabling law predates the platforms by a decade. The 2015 law simplifying birth and civil registration provides for electronic communication of civil-registration data to the social-assistance, social-security, health and tax services, and requires a unified civil-registry database interconnected with civil identification, with data-protection oversight of the sharing protocols. Above it, interoperability is governed by decree rather than statute: the 2018 decree on public administration interoperability. Nothing in the window adds a statutory exchange duty, and the digital government bill went to public consultation in May 2026 without one being reported.	NO CHANGE
Benin	The exchange's founding decree of March 2020 is in force and now on file, acquired as a signed scan rather than a gazette copy. The decree instituting the national exchange was signed on 18 March 2020 and remains in force. What moved in the window is custody rather than law: the base acquired the signed decree in August 2026 from the operator's own media host. It is not a gazette copy, and the file is a page-image scan with no text layer, so its articles cannot be quoted. No amendment, implementing decree or successor statute appears. The instruments that have moved are administrative — the access conditions and the architecture referentials reported elsewhere — which is how a six-year-old decree comes to govern an exchange carrying 32.7m requests a month.	NO CHANGE
Botswana	The Digital Services Act supplies the enabling law for data interoperability, at sections 12 and 22. 2025-10-17 — the Act requires a standardised framework for secure exchange of information and an information gateway, the first statutory basis for cross-government data exchange the base holds. No regulations have been made under either section, and the base carries nothing on the gateway being built.	MOVEMENT
Burkina Faso	A Prime Ministerial order of 23 May 2018 adopted the Referentiel general d'interoperabilite. The Referentiel general d'interoperabilite was adopted by Prime Ministerial arrete of 23 May 2018, fixing the rules ensuring compatibility between public administrations' information systems; a training seminar on it was held in October 2019. This is a secondary account: the framework's own text could not be fetched from the ministry's server. Nothing states which administrations comply with it, or whether any system has been certified against it.	NO CHANGE a standing instrument the base holds for the first time
Burundi	A 2018 presidential decree is the closest instrument to legislation enabling data sharing between public bodies; nothing moved on it. Decret n 100/085 du 25 juillet 2018 establishes the national framework for the collection, dissemination, access, archiving and security of data and micro-data. It defines administrative data as data collected by public institutions in the exercise of their functions, brings administrative data into the dissemination regime, and provides for making data available by electronic means, with institutional public users and rules on access. It is an enabling instrument rather than a mandate: it does not require any two public bodies to connect, and the base holds no implementing text, no data-sharing agreement made under it and no platform operating on its authority.	NO CHANGE
Cameroon	Two draft bills were technically validated at a national workshop of 3 to 14 November 2025, with interoperability, digital identification and data-protection recommendations integrated. Neither is enacted. The workshop validated a bill on electronic government and access to public information and a second on electronic commerce and electronic transactions, integrating interoperability, digital identification and data-protection recommendations, with the drafts left pending ministerial and institutional finalisation. The first was officially validated after that workshop, establishing proactive publication of public information and remains unenacted. Meanwhile the exchange layer is being assigned by instruction rather than statute: the telecommunications ministry tasked the state operator with carrying national data and infrastructure interoperability, with no design, timetable or budget published.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cape Verde	The interoperability standards diploma announced for 2024 is unadopted while interoperability is asserted as working. The diploma was announced for drafting in 2024 under the state-modernisation strategy, with no adoption on record. There is no evidence it was adopted two years past its stated year, while interoperability is asserted as a working property of the government portal and of the company registry. The gap between an asserted interoperability layer and an unadopted standards instrument is the finding: what public systems must do to connect, and who decides, is set by nothing published.	STALLED
Central African Republic	A national platform became operationally effective at one ministry in February 2026; no interoperability statute is held. 2026-02 - a national platform became operationally effective at the planning ministry, with data migrated, staff use made mandatory and a launch ceremony held, launched publicly in late February. It is the first working government data platform the base holds. The architecture it would sit in is commissioned rather than built: the digital governance project's procurement plan carries a US$300,000 technical-assistance contract for interoperability architecture. No statute, decree or standard obliging interoperability appears anywhere on this ledger, so what enables exchange here is a platform and a contract, not a law.	MOVEMENT
Chad	A digital code has no adopted text: a forty-five-day drafting deadline set in April 2026 expired in June with nothing on record. The code was described as finalised in December 2025 and a committee was then given forty-five days from 27 April 2026 to draft the framework; that deadline expired about 11 June with no text on record (code, finalisation, agency). The committee itself was inaugurated with thirty-four members and mandated to build on prior regulator contributions, and no output is on record (committee). A ministry system prohibition and an interoperability programme are both recorded separately as depending on a framework that does not exist.	STALLED
Congo	A public-revenue payment order put receipts on a single platform, and the single window was restated by decree. 2026-01-01 — revised statutes for the cross-border single window were issued. 2026-06-11 — an order set the payment of public revenues onto a single platform. The baseline diagnosis describes the fragmentation these are working against. Both instruments enable exchange for one function each; no general interoperability statute is held.	MOVEMENT
Cote d'Ivoire	A 2017 ordinance requires an interoperability reference framework, a platform every authority must join, and a bar on asking users for data the state already holds. The statute is the enabling law and it is unchanged in the window. It requires a general interoperability reference framework fixing the technical rules, data repositories, norms and standards administrative authorities must use; requires the State to put in place an e-services interoperability platform every administrative authority is bound to connect to, giving existing systems two years to conform; and forbids an authority requiring a user to supply information already produced to any authority whose system respects that framework. 2026-01-16 - the identification office and the post office launched an application giving every holder of the national identification number a digital post box, and the office placed the national register of natural persons at the centre of it, stating that embedding a certified identity is what guarantees transaction reliability, data protection and traceability - the once-only principle working in one service rather than across the administration. The two-year conformity deadline the ordinance set fell in 2019. Nothing on the ledger records it being met, enforced or extended.	NO CHANGE the 2017 statute stands unamended and its two-year conformity deadline is eight years past
Djibouti	A 2022 law gives the digital economy ministry a statutory mandate over the interoperability of state information systems, unchanged in the period. The law establishing the ministry charges it with ensuring the coherence and interoperability of information systems by design, breaking down ministerial application silos and enabling data sharing between administrations through a dedicated platform, in force since 27 July 2022. It is a mandate on a ministry rather than a duty on data holders: no law compels an administration to expose its data, and no implementing decree under this article is held. The interoperability framework the state information-systems agency maintains is a technical document with no enacting instrument on file.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
DR Congo	The Digital Code defines interoperability among its terms; the platform it would govern is specified on paper only. The code's definitions include interoperability alongside cybercrime, cybersecurity, electronic commerce and cryptology. A definition is not a duty: nothing in the base shows the code compelling any administration to expose data or to consume another's. What would run under it does not exist. The data-sharing platform and government payment gateway are specified on paper only, with no architecture, pilot, operator or date, and the interoperability framework is itself a consultant deliverable. The one place a conformance duty is actually imposed is sectoral: hospital information systems must demonstrate conformity to named health data-exchange, imaging and interface standards and to the national health identifier and enterprise architecture.	NO CHANGE a standing position the base holds for the first time
Egypt	The data centre and cloud licensing framework is the operative rule; no interoperability statute is held. The regulator's licensing and registration framework for establishing and operating data centres and providing hosting and cloud computing services is the operative rule beneath the estate, issued under the telecommunications law. The one law that obliges an exchange is sectoral: the 2025 real estate identifier law establishes a unified non-repeating national identifier database built on a unified base map, which is a shared key by statute. No general statute requiring public bodies to exchange data, and no once-only rule, appears anywhere on this ledger.	NO CHANGE a first stated position with no earlier account behind it
Equatorial Guinea	A bill creating an electronic public procurement information system went to single-reading study in November 2025. No statute enables data exchange across Equatoguinean agencies. The electronic laws of 2015-2017 address protection, retention and signature, not exchange. The nearest thing to an enabling instrument is sectoral: the public sector contracts bill creating an electronic procurement information system, opened for single-reading study in November 2025. The business single window remains the only decree that folds several registers into one process.	MOVEMENT
Eritrea	No law enables data exchange between government systems; a 2022 assessment records no service bus and no cross-system exchange (dataset). A structured government-technology dataset for 2022 records no government interoperability framework and no system that exchanges data across financial management, human resources, payroll, customs, tax or social-insurance systems (dataset). A regional ministerial assessment places Eritrea's data-protection policy area at a nascent stage without legislation or regulatory oversight (policy matrix), so there is also no legal basis on which systems could lawfully share personal data. The one system that did move is closed rather than connected: the customs platform runs on an intranet architecture independent of continuous internet access (account).	NO CHANGE
Eswatini	No Act enables data interoperability. The Electronic Communications and Transactions Act is the nearest instrument, and it does not create a duty to share. The Act of 2022 is the operative electronic-transactions statute and the closest legal basis for exchange between public bodies; nothing in the base creates an interoperability obligation (Act). The obligations that do exist run the other way. The data protection authority requires every controller to document its data flows, storage and sharing, which constrains exchange rather than mandating it (directive). Where systems are being joined it is by project rather than statute: the 2026 budget speech reports the first release of an integrated financial management information system (budget speech). More than half of ministries still lack meaningful system interoperability.	NO CHANGE no interoperability statute and the duties that exist are protective
Ethiopia	No instrument compels agencies to integrate with the unified service platform, on its own regional executives' account. Regional executives of the unified public-service platform say no legal framework obliges agencies to join it, so integration rests on agreement between them (platform review). The base holds no interoperability proclamation, no data-sharing regulation and no mandate under the e-government interoperability framework, which has itself been in development since 2024.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Gabon	An ordinance of September 2025 makes interconnection between administrations compulsory and mandates digitisation of administrative services. The ordinance on digitalisation and electronic government was signed by the President and published in the gazette of 7 September 2025, carrying compulsory interconnection between administrations and a national-preference clause in digital public procurement (the ordinance). Its number comes from the minister's own commentary rather than from the instrument (ministerial commentary), and the base holds no article text or gazette reference. It names no platform and no standard, so the obligation to interconnect exists without anything to interconnect through.	MOVEMENT
Gambia	The 2019 Act gives the ICT agency the powers an exchange would need; none has been exercised in a published instrument. The agency's own statement of its functions under the 2019 Act covers a government data bank, technical standards, electronic signatures and cloud services. What is missing is any instrument made under them. The Data Protection and Privacy Bill 2024 reached assented stage on the Assembly's own tracker in July 2026, which supplies the safeguard side; the exchange side remains a proposal in the e-government strategy.	NO CHANGE
Ghana	A data harmonisation bill was consulted on in November 2025 and a separate data exchange Act was named in July 2026; neither has been laid. The harmonisation bill went to public consultation from 19 to 27 November 2025 and would make the information technology agency both regulator and technical enforcer of the standards; it was renamed an Act in the July 2026 artificial-intelligence plan and has not been laid before Parliament (bill). The ministry names a data exchange Act as a statute distinct from harmonisation, carrying interoperability and inter-agency sharing, with no draft or timetable (exchange Act). Two instruments have been named for the same problem and neither exists as a text the base can read.	MOVEMENT
Guinea	A 2023 decree charges the state digitalisation agency with unified tools of communication, collaboration and exchange within and between administrations — the clearest enacted basis for inter-administration exchange. The decree amends the 2022 act creating the agency and charges it with harmonising the choice of norms, standards and equipment across state services and with the establishment and management of unified tools of communication, collaboration and exchange within and between administrations, services, institutions and other state bodies at central, deconcentrated and decentralised level. That is a mandate on an agency, not a duty on data holders: nothing compels a ministry to expose its data, sets a legal basis for a particular exchange, or gives a citizen a right against being asked twice. The scan's own decree-number and date fields are blank and the text extraction stops mid-article. What runs under it is an interoperability platform let public information systems communicate so a user need not supply the same information twice, described as in service and shown to the head of government.	NO CHANGE a standing position the base holds for the first time
Guinea-Bissau	A national interoperability regulation for public and private digital systems was approved by the government in August 2026, with no decree number or in-force date named. 2026-08-08 — the WARDIP programme announced government approval of a national interoperability framework regulating how public and private digital systems and platforms connect, presented as Guinea-Bissau's contribution to the regional programme. It is the one instrument of the three draft decrees the Council of Ministers approved on 10 July 2025 that has moved since. What the record does not carry is the instrument itself: no decree number, no gazettal and no entry-into-force date, and the approval is reported by the World Bank-backed programme that supports the work rather than by an official journal. No data exchange platform appears on this ledger for the regulation to govern.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Kenya	Interoperability duties are arriving sector by sector: the Digital Health Act in 2023, an agricultural information bill in 2026. The Digital Health Act of November 2023 is the clearest statutory basis for data exchange in a sector, carrying its own data exchange regulations (act). A Digital Agricultural Information Bill published in March 2026 would establish a centre for digital agricultural information with statutory functions (bill). A national data governance policy remains in validation (validation). What the base does not hold is any general statute establishing a duty to share data across government; each instrument enables one sector.	MOVEMENT
Lesotho	No dedicated interoperability statute exists; the VAT e-invoicing regulations are the binding data-exchange rule the base holds. 2012-02-22 — the Data Protection Act is the closest enacted instrument bearing on lawful sharing of personal government data. 2026-03-27 — Legal Notice 25 of 2026 requires system-to-system electronic transmission of VAT transaction data, a binding interoperability rule confined to one revenue stream. 2025-08-26 — a workshop opened to develop a digital public infrastructure framework. No statute enabling data exchange across government generally is held.	MOVEMENT on a tax regulation rather than a general statute
Liberia	Executive Order 147 compels inter-agency verification against the identity register; no statute enables data exchange generally. Executive Order 147 requires all public and private institutions to use the registry database, the Identity Query Portal and the e-Verification platform, which is the only operative instrument compelling data sharing across Liberian agencies. It is an executive order resting on the 2011 Act, not a data-exchange statute. Executive Order 163 of April 2026 mandates a Government Interoperability Framework but is likewise executive.	NO CHANGE
Libya	A 2018 decision hands the information authority the national database and the mandate to interconnect state bodies. The decision is the operative instrument: it redistributes the national number project's competences and gives the authority both the database and the linkage mandate. The service it produced is running — electronic linkage connecting national bodies to the central database, with no civil registry link named — while the framework that would standardise it is still only proposed.	NO CHANGE
Madagascar	A draft electronic-signature and interoperability decree was validated at a ministry workshop in September 2025 and has not been adopted. The 2015 electronic-signature law has had no implementing decree; the draft validated in September 2025 would supply one and provides for a national interoperability committee (draft). The minister named the recasting as a contribution to a future digital code, which is not held. A year on, no adoption, gazette reference or committee appointment is recorded.	MOVEMENT
Malawi	A proposed government data sharing regulation would route all data requests through the national data centre and require binding sharing agreements, and it is not made. Ministries and agencies had been sharing citizen data by email, USB drive and paper, and the platform operated without binding rules (regulation). The proposal would require encryption in transit and at rest, set a common digital standard for system-to-system exchange, and require binding data sharing agreements with usage limits and audit trails. No draft text is held, and the minister described a binding regulation as the missing piece in an account given during a vendor meeting abroad.	MOVEMENT
Mali	A 2025 ordinance created the identification agency and the national population register; a general data-management law is still recommended, not drafted. The one enacted step is register-specific. A 2025 ordinance created the national agency for the security of identity documents and civil status together with the national population register, which is the instrument under which registers could be joined. The general duty does not exist. The 2016 electronic transactions law gives electronic exchange legal effect without requiring public bodies to share, and the national digital week's call for a data-management law is a recommendation rather than a bill. Where exchange happens it happens by project, as with the customs interconnection pilot.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mauritania	Decree 2022-009 governs electronic exchanges between users and administrations and between administrations, under the electronic transactions law of 2018. The decree was made on the digital ministry's report under law n. 2018-022 of 12 June 2018 on electronic transactions, and is the legal footing the service portals rest on (decree). No implementing arrangement, register of compliant administrations or evaluation is held,; the national data management system it would serve is still in development, and the base holds no register of administrations exchanging under it.	NO CHANGE
Mauritius	An omnibus bill of 119 pages amending fifty-eight Acts carries the fintech committee, the artificial-intelligence city scheme, a threat-sharing platform and a digital travel authorisation. The bill was introduced on 24 July 2026 with staged commencement from 1 September and several provisions deemed retrospective (bill). A secondary account put the figure at some sixty laws; the enacting text gives fifty-eight amended and one repealed (account). It is the single largest legislative vehicle in the country's digital record, and it was introduced and not enacted.	MOVEMENT
Morocco	A Digital X.0 framework bill sits with the government's general secretariat on three pillars, one of them interoperability on traceable consent. The bill was under review by the general secretariat in November 2025, on pillars of data governance, sectoral digital identity, and interoperability resting on traceable consent (bill, account). The ministry frames it as sitting under the 2009 data-protection law rather than replacing it. No text, article count or tabling date is on record, and nothing has been published about it since.	MOVEMENT
Mozambique	The interoperability regulation's revision reached final consultation on 11 June 2026, nine years after the 2017 decree that enacted it. Mozambique legislated interoperability early and is now rewriting it. Decree 67/2017 established the electronic government interoperability framework, its principles, the information technology institute's regulatory role and the state administration agency's platform-implementation role, under the 2017 electronic transactions law. The revision is nearly done: a two-day national workshop on 11 June 2026 held the final consultation on the revised regulation before approval, and acknowledged persisting fragmentation, data duplication and absent common integration standards — the regulator's own account of why a nine-year-old framework needed rewriting. Above it, the data governance policy was validated in December 2025.	MOVEMENT
Namibia	The Electronic Transactions Act of 2019 is the enabling statute, and its electronic-signature and accreditation provisions were brought into force in June 2026. The Act of 2019 is the standing statute for electronic transactions and remains the interim instrument law enforcement relies on for cybercrime (Act). Electronic signature regulations were gazetted in December 2025 and the regulator separately gazetted regulations for accrediting security products, services and their providers; the Act's section 20 and its accreditation chapter were brought into force in June 2026 (signatures, accreditation, commencement). The regulator states it is the national root certification authority, and legally recognised electronic signatures still had no launch on record in July 2026. Trust infrastructure is now legislated. What is not legislated is a duty on public bodies to make their systems talk to each other.	MOVEMENT
Niger	A May 2026 decree makes interoperability between the civil and population registers a legal requirement, with a national unique identifier for every resident. The legal work came in two Council of Ministers sittings. On 22 April 2026 the government adopted the ordonnance on the civil-status regime, amending the 2019 law to clarify the constitution and use of the national civil and population registers, add biometric parameters and a unique identifier, and enable electronic issuance and signature of civil-status acts, together with the decrees creating the registration and identification agency to remedy the registers' dispersion and want of interoperability. On 18 May the implementing decree followed, defining management of the national civil register and expressly providing interoperability mechanisms between it, the population register and other functional systems, plus a national unique identifier for every Nigerien and long and short-term foreign resident. That is the first legal duty to interoperate on this base.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Nigeria	A National Digital Economy and E-Governance Bill before the assembly would elevate the technology agency to a super regulator, with overlap flagged by stakeholders. The bill offers a unified legal framework with broad supervisory and enforcement powers, and also carries the risk-based artificial-intelligence regime (bill). Its electronic-signature provisions overlap with the root certification authority the identity statute already created, and which instrument governs digital signatures is unresolved on the record.	MOVEMENT
Rwanda	The 2023 single digital identity law requires relying-party integration and synchronisation with civil registration; the strategy above it followed in March 2026. The law enacted in June 2023 governs population registration in the single digital identity system, defines authentication, obliges relying parties to integrate, and requires synchronisation with civil registration (law). That is the clearest statutory obligation to interoperate the base holds for any Rwandan system. The digital public infrastructure strategy launched in March 2026 sets the architecture around it (launch), and the shared data hub that would carry general exchange is still at pre-procurement (minutes).	MOVEMENT
Sao Tome and Principe	A National Framework for Interoperability was enacted as Law 1/2024 for public-sector data sharing, and only a secondary legal survey describes it. The law is held through the same 2024 legal-survey chapter as the data-protection law, not through its own text (law). It is the stated legal basis for the civil-registry to electoral-database linkage recorded separately, and the base now also holds a civil-registry exchange interface (interface), a health platform (health) and a social protection system integrated with the social registry (social protection). Each was built to its own design. The framework the law would be applied through is a draft from 2021 (framework), so the statute has evidenced uses and no published specification behind them.	NO CHANGE
Senegal	The interoperability decree was still being presented as a draft in May 2026; the nearest enacted duty is a five-day request transfer. On 4 May 2026 the ministry convened public-sector actors, stating that the state still runs information systems built in isolation with different architectures and fragmented data, and announced that the following day would cover presentation of the draft decree framing the interoperability platform, the national interoperability framework, data-exchange architectures, technical norms and security requirements. As at May 2026 the framework decree was a draft, not an adopted and published act. The operative published instrument is narrower: a 2024 decree charging the digital minister with establishing transversal governance of state information systems and putting in place a data-hosting status. It vests a competence; it does not oblige administrations to share data. The nearest enacted transfer duty sits in the access law: article 15 obliges a body that does not hold the requested information to transfer the request to the body likely to hold it within five days.	NO CHANGE the framework decree remained a draft through the window
Seychelles	The payment licensing regulations make straight-through processing a licence condition; a National Addressing System Bill was Cabinet-approved in April 2026. The December 2025 regulations require payment, clearing and settlement operators to hold safe and reliable IT systems and adequate interfaces for straight-through processing, the clearest statutory interoperability duty the base holds (regulations). Cabinet approved the National Addressing System Bill in April 2026, creating a National Addressing Department and Database Unit as a shared reference-data layer described as improving cross-agency access to data (Bill). Both are sectoral. No general statute obliges public bodies to share or expose data to one another, and the addressing Bill is approved rather than enacted.	MOVEMENT
Sierra Leone	No general data-sharing statute. The civil registration and identification bill was validated in November 2025, and the 2019 electronic transactions act is still being made operational. The base carries an explicit finding that no legal basis for data sharing between government registers has been located, and nothing in the window supplies one. What moved is adjacent legislation. The civil registration and identification bill was validated by the registration authority in November 2025, and the electronic transactions act of 2019 was the subject of implementation work in July 2026 with external support on the legal framework — an act on the books since 2019 and recorded as not operational. The data-protection half is also pending: a data protection and right to access information bill was finalised and is not yet law.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Somalia	Law 46 of 2026 puts civil registration on a statutory footing beside the identity system; nothing yet compels one public body to share data with another. The Population Registration and Civil Status Statistics Law, gazetted 5 April 2026, establishes the civil-registration and vital-statistics layer alongside the national identity infrastructure (law). The Data Protection Act supplies the conditions under which personal data may move, including outside the country (Act) — permission, not obligation. What carries interoperability in practice is administrative: a cross-institutional working group launched in June 2026 to integrate the national identity and its verification platform across public and private services (working group).	MOVEMENT
South Africa	Draft data-exchange legislation is a stated deliverable of the exchange pilot, over a 2014 statute that already provides for administration-wide norms and standards. The standing instrument is not a data law. The Public Administration Management Act has been in force since 2014 as the frame for administration-wide arrangements across national, provincial and municipal spheres, including the transfer and secondment of employees and the establishment of common norms and standards — which is the authority under which service standards are set, and it says nothing about data. Draft data-exchange legislation is one of three named deliverables of the one-year exchange pilot, alongside four task teams and interoperability standards. So the country is running a federated data exchange in pilot with no statute behind it, and the statute is scheduled to be drafted by the pilot itself. Nothing on this ledger states who would introduce it or when.	MOVEMENT
South Sudan	An ICT Authority is being established while awaiting legislation, and a May 2026 account states the President already signed its legal framework; the two are unreconciled. Both accounts trace to one speaker. In May 2026 the minister said the law is out already and signed by the President; in August 2026 he was reported standing the body up while parliamentary legislation is awaited (establishment, framework). No bill, act, presidential order or gazette entry can be found. The justice ministry's law collection stops at 2017 and omits the cybercrime Act too, the Office of the President publishes no decrees, and the Assembly's bills register stops in 2023 — so the registers are not current enough for their silence to settle anything. The division of competence with the existing communications regulator is unstated. The qualified status is the resting state.	MIXED an ICT Authority reported both as legally established and as awaiting legislation, from the same speaker
Sudan	A draft Digital Transformation Law of 2026 is in redrafting with the ministry, the third of a three-instrument package. It went to the Council of Ministers alongside the cybersecurity and data drafts and was reported in redrafting in August 2026 (draft, ministry). None of the three texts is published. The platforms the law would presumably govern — the national services platform, the identity credential, the civil-service records system — are already live, so the statute follows the systems rather than authorising them.	MOVEMENT
Tanzania	The 2019 e-government statute mandates interoperability, and two technical standards were approved under it in February 2026. The 2019 e-government statute mandates integration and interoperability of government systems, establishes the authority's data-sharing and exchange platform mandate, and provides the basis for its technical data standards. A board-approved application standard of February 2026 requires secure development-lifecycle controls, vulnerability testing, audit logs and privacy by design, and mandates open interoperable design with government-controlled source-code hosting. A companion data-centre standard of the same date sets site, power, cooling and utility requirements for approved government hosting environments. The public data centre rules gazetted alongside them could not be captured and are not held.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Togo	A maritime single window created by decree in September 2025 is the period's regulatory movement on data exchange between administrations. The decree of 18 September 2025, gazetted 30 September, creates a national electronic platform centralising receipt, processing and transmission of port and maritime formalities, expressly tasked with facilitating information exchange between the competent authorities — port, customs, immigration, health, maritime safety and environment — on single submission and reuse of data. The standing instrument is the ministerial order of 10 September 2024 on access to social-registry data, which converts a decree principle into procedure: a convention with the identity agency in every case, data-protection clearance for personal data, and quarterly reporting of requests. The 2022 amendment to the identity statute is the enabling text, charging the agency with interconnecting the registry with administrations' databases.	MOVEMENT
Tunisia	The Development Plan 2026-2030 was promulgated as a law in July 2026, and every volume of the annex held is marked draft. It was promulgated on 20 July 2026 after adoption by both chambers (law, annex). Whether the promulgated annex differs from the version tabled and voted is not established, and no as-enacted printing has been published. That is a live problem rather than a formality: the annex is where the digital programme's project lines sit, so the legally binding content of the country's digital plan cannot be read.	MOVEMENT
Uganda	Interoperability rests on the 2009 IT authority statute and subsidiary frameworks; no dedicated data-sharing law exists, and the movement is in sectoral agreements. The enabling law is the National Information Technology Authority, Uganda Act 2009, gazetted in July 2009, under which the exchange platform, the interoperability framework and the security framework are all issued. No dedicated data-sharing or interoperability statute exists and no amendment is on the record. 2025-12 - a five-year US$2.3 billion bilateral health cooperation memorandum was signed with the United States, committing to a resilient health system; a data sharing agreement under it is on the ledger as planned. 2026-03 - parliament passed the National Drug and Health Products Authority Bill at third reading, replacing the 1993 framework and carrying a listing system for health products; no commencement date or system is named. What the base does not hold is any legal instrument compelling agencies to share data with one another, which is why the exchange platform's coverage is reported as a target rather than an obligation.	NO CHANGE the enabling statute is unamended and the movement is in agreements under it
Zambia	A Cabinet directive on open-source technology was issued to ministries, reported only in an excerpt of a trade-press article with no government publication held. It was issued alongside the spatial data infrastructure launch in June 2026 (directive). No government publication of it is held. Officials elsewhere in this ledger name fragmented, vendor-locked systems as a governance and legal problem rather than a technical one, which is the case the directive would answer — and the directive itself cannot be read.	MOVEMENT
Zimbabwe	No Act enabling data interoperability is held. The Cyber and Data Protection Act governs lawful sharing, and the standards work is technical rather than statutory. The Act's transborder-flow and processing provisions are the strongest enacted instrument bearing on lawful data linking and sharing, and they constrain rather than mandate exchange (Act). Where interoperability is being enabled, it is by technical standard rather than legislation: a national health information exchange is in development to connect laboratory, logistics and facility systems (exchange). Nothing on the base creates a duty on public bodies to make their systems interoperable, or a legal basis for once-only data sharing across ministries.	NO CHANGE the sharing rules sit in data-protection law and no interoperability statute exists

AI legislation / regulations

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	An ethical-artificial-intelligence law is reported in preparation, with no draft text, sponsor or timetable held. Nothing existed at the window's opening. The law is described as in preparation, with no draft text, sponsor or timetable held as at 2026-08-03. That is nine months of a stated preparation with nothing published, against a national strategy whose deployment roadmap was agreed in the same period and a university assistant announced to steer module allocation and mark student answers from the 2026-2027 academic year. No rule, appeal route or disclosure duty governs any of it.	MOVEMENT
Angola	An 86-article artificial-intelligence bill went to public consultation in September 2025, with no tabling, committee stage or vote since. The draft runs to 86 articles in nine chapters and departs from the tiered risk pyramid used elsewhere: a single critical-AI category carries registration, security-risk assessment and emergency-response duties, with extraterritorial reach over activity abroad affecting Angolan interests, a right to explanation and to refuse decisions made by artificial intelligence, and both criminal and strict civil liability. It repeals no existing legislation, defers military applications to a separate instrument and excludes scientific research and purely personal use. Its financial assessment is not costed. No tabling, committee stage or vote is on record in the eleven months since consultation opened, and the policy the law would implement does not exist: the readiness assessment reported under strategy names its absence as the central gap.	MOVEMENT
Benin	A four-country comparative study found no artificial-intelligence-specific legislation in force or in draft; the 2023 to 2027 strategy carries the field. 2026-08-10 — a four-country comparative study of West African artificial-intelligence governance found no artificial-intelligence-specific instrument in force or in draft in Benin, and rates a neighbour's strategy the most advanced of the four on inclusion and data governance. That is a searched absence rather than an unexamined one. What carries the field instead is soft law: the national strategy, the data protection authority's artificial-intelligence policy and the generative-tool regime for public agents, all reported elsewhere in this report. Each binds a part of the state and none binds a private deployer, which is the gap a statute would close.	NO CHANGE
Botswana	No AI-specific Act or regulation exists; the Data Protection Act 2024 is the closest adjacent enacted instrument. 2025-12-22 — the country profile records no AI legislation and the national policy at an advanced stage. 2025-08-13 — a minister said the policy was in final drafting, the earliest in-window movement toward one. The absence was searched on 31 August 2026 and nothing was found: no Bill, no regulations under an existing statute, and no announced timetable for either.	NO CHANGE
Burkina Faso	No dedicated instrument: the justice minister told deputies the new data-protection law covers artificial intelligence, notably through the prohibition on transferring sensitive data abroad, while a roadmap to 2030 was adopted in June 2026. The country's own statement to an international dialogue confirms what exists: the national artificial-intelligence roadmap for 2026-2030 was adopted in June 2026, built on a six-part ethics framework and four operational pillars covering sovereign infrastructure, human capital, data and language groundwork, and proof of concept. A roadmap is not a regulation, and the roadmap's own text is not published. 2025-08-27 - the process opened with a situational-analysis workshop convening public institutions, the private sector, universities, research centres, civil society and financial partners into thematic sub-groups. 2026-08 - the justice minister told deputies that the new data-protection law covers artificial intelligence, which is the state's own account of why no dedicated instrument is being prepared.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Burundi	No binding artificial-intelligence instrument was located in any national legal source; a non-binding strategy was validated in April 2026. No Burundian loi, decret, ordonnance ministerielle or regulator reglement governing artificial intelligence was located across the official legal database, the official gazette, the presidency, both chambers, the communications regulator and the state technology secretariat, on a search dated to the national readiness assessment held in Bujumbura on 25-27 November 2025. 2026-04-21 — a national validation session for the artificial-intelligence strategy was opened by the ministry responsible for the digital economy with a development agency. What moved is the validation of a non-binding strategy, not any instrument: the absence the indicator asks about is unchanged and is now dated.	NO CHANGE
Cape Verde	There is no artificial-intelligence statute; the binding rule that reaches algorithmic use is the 2021 amendment of the general data-protection regime, and the regulator's own position is that legislation is needed. The amendment defines profiling, prohibits discriminatory profiles, limits decisions taken solely by automated processing where they produce legal effects or significantly affect the data subject, requires transparency about the decision logic, and requires impact assessments for high-risk technologies. It is a data-protection instrument that happens to reach algorithms, not a rule written for them. 2025-10 - the data-protection commission set out at an African governance workshop the provisions that bear on artificial intelligence and stated the regulator's position that the country needs legislation to regulate it. 2025-12-12 - a national readiness assessment was launched with the United Nations offices, the telecommunications and digital economy directorate framing it as producing a diagnosis across three pillars — artificial intelligence in the country, artificial intelligence in government, and regulation and ethics — and as the first step toward the regulatory framework the country does not have. No diagnosis has been published since.	NO CHANGE a standing position the base holds for the first time
Central African Republic	No instrument names artificial intelligence. A strategy is being drafted and the broadcasting regulator has asked for tighter identification against deepfakes. Nothing enacted here reaches artificial intelligence. The national policy or strategy is in development and no draft text is held. The nearest regulatory action is a request rather than a rule: the broadcasting regulator asked for tighter identification in response to deepfakes and artificial-intelligence disinformation in June 2026. What law exists is general — the cybersecurity and cybercrime law and the 2024 data protection law, the latter without an authority to enforce it.	NO CHANGE
Chad	No liability regime for artificial intelligence exists, and the only statutory mention is the reformed security agency's widened remit. UNESCO's country profile, drawn from Chad's own readiness assessment, finds that Chad regulates cyberspace, that some provisions are obsolete, and that at this stage no liability regime for artificial intelligence exists (profile). The March 2026 reform of the computer-security and electronic-certification agency names artificial-intelligence systems within its widened remit (reform) — the only statutory mention held. Chad's declaration to the Geneva dialogue records adherence to the 2021 international recommendation and a readiness diagnostic under way, with no adopted national instrument (declaration).	NO CHANGE
Comoros	An obligation to label artificial-intelligence content entered law at article 231 of the new communication code; no dedicated statute exists. 2026-02 - the communication code was modified and completed by loi n 25-021/AU, promulgated on 2 February 2026; its article 231 requires explicit labelling of content generated or heavily modified by artificial intelligence, backed by graduated administrative sanctions to one million Comorian francs and a public campaign. The full text is now on file, running to two hundred and seventy-four articles. 2026-03 - the Council of Ministers took a six-month evaluation of institutional, technical and regulatory readiness, adding the interior ministry to the committee on national-security and data-governance grounds. Its stated June conclusion has passed with nothing published. The country now regulates one use of the technology inside a media statute, and nothing else.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Congo	Statutes for an African AI research centre were approved by decree in August 2025, and drafting of a national AI strategy opened in May 2026. 2025-08-28 — a decree approved the statutes of the African centre for artificial intelligence research. 2026-05-20 — a Brazzaville workshop opened the drafting of the national AI strategy, with a recommendation for a national ethics committee. What exists is an institute and a strategy in drafting. No AI legislation or regulation is enacted.	MOVEMENT
Cote d'Ivoire	No Ivorian artificial-intelligence statute is published; governance runs entirely through non-binding strategy instruments. The position at both ends of the window is that no bill, act or implementing decree on artificial intelligence has been published, and that is a cited absence rather than an unexamined one. What moved instead is policy. The draft 2026-2030 cybersecurity strategy extends state scope to artificial intelligence, emerging technologies and cloud, and is the only binding-track vehicle doing so. A published bill, act or implementing decree would settle the indicator; nothing on file suggests one is drafted.	NO CHANGE
Djibouti	No artificial-intelligence law, decree or procurement rule is held; the strategy in preparation is not an instrument. The position is unchanged at both ends of the window: no law, decree or procurement rule governing artificial-intelligence systems in public use is held, and the strategy under preparation is not an instrument. It matters more here than the absence alone suggests, because systems are already in public use: a weather early-warning system in service and a memorandum for a compute zone signed. Nothing published states what a public body must do before deploying such a system, who may audit it, or what a person subject to one may contest.	NO CHANGE
DR Congo	There is no artificial-intelligence instrument: the national strategy was validated on 4 August 2026 and not adopted, and officials say the bodies acting on it have roles not yet articulated in a common steering architecture. The strategy was validated together with the sectoral digital economy policy at a ceremony on 4 August 2026, developed with support from the United Nations education and culture agency including a readiness-assessment report, with a mixed commission established by ministerial order in October 2025. Validated is not adopted, and a strategy is not a regulation. Its own draft rests on four pillars — governance, ethics, trust and regulation; data, digital and energy infrastructure; human capital, research and innovation; industrialisation and value creation. 2026-07-23 - officials put on the record that bodies already acting across digital, research, data, cybersecurity and regulation have roles not yet sufficiently articulated in a common steering architecture — the state's own account of why no instrument has issued. The Digital Code, the only statute in the field, does not reach artificial intelligence in its scoping article.	NO CHANGE a standing position the base holds for the first time
Egypt	The minister told Cabinet a regulator unit already detects and acts on artificial-intelligence-manipulated content, and legislative amendment is needed. 2026-07-29 - the minister told Cabinet that a unit had been formed inside the telecommunications regulator which already detects and acts on manipulated video and imagery, but that legislative amendment is needed to address the practices at root. The unit's formation date, legal basis, staffing, method, appeal route and contest procedure are not stated: the detection capability operates ahead of the instrument that would authorise it. At the same meeting the Cabinet agreed a review of the governing social-media statutes, heavier financial penalties and public awareness campaigns, with a comparative study of other states' approaches being prepared and no bill, text or timetable stated; the Prime Minister credited a press and media campaign with prompting the response.	MOVEMENT
Equatorial Guinea	A draft artificial intelligence law is being written, setting six guiding principles and proposing an autonomous national authority for the technology and for data. A drafting session in August 2025 addressed splitting the proposed authority's functions, and two national institutions are named as prospective training and certification centres under the draft; no enactment, text or adoption date is published (draft law). The proposed authority would supervise both artificial intelligence and data, in a country whose existing data-protection statute has had no supervisory body for a decade.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Eritrea	A review dated June 2026 records no dedicated artificial-intelligence law and no national strategy (review). A legal-status review dated 8 June 2026 states that Eritrea has no dedicated artificial-intelligence law, no national artificial-intelligence strategy, no data-protection statute and no data-protection authority, and that the nearest legal anchor is the privacy article of the 1997 constitution, which has never entered into force (review). The 2025 government artificial-intelligence readiness index, in its January 2026 edition, scores Eritrea zero on policy capacity and ranks it 193rd overall on a score of 13.69 (index). The absence is total rather than partial: no instrument, no draft and no institution with a mandate.	NO CHANGE
Eswatini	No AI Act or regulation exists. The regulator's spectrum guidelines are the only binding instrument touching AI devices, and a national AI strategy is not held. The 2024 licence-exempt spectrum guidelines are the base's only binding instrument expressly touching artificial-intelligence and internet-of-things devices (guidelines). A reviewed science, technology and innovation policy and a combined fourth and fifth industrial revolution strategy went to stakeholder validation in February 2026, framing artificial intelligence, automation and data governance inside a human-centred approach; neither document is held (validation). The Prime Minister told a global governance dialogue in July 2026, speaking for the King, that artificial-intelligence governance frameworks should protect children and uphold human dignity (Geneva). The regulator has issued guidance on artificial intelligence and deepfakes in broadcasting, which is guidance and not an instrument with force. A national AI strategy was probed and not found.	NO CHANGE no artificial-intelligence instrument and a strategy that is Not held
Ethiopia	An implementing directive gave the security agency power to designate new and emerging technology products for clearance (directive). Directive 1135/2026, made under the Information Technology Products Security Clearance and Control Proclamation, creates security clearance, permit and monitoring procedures for restricted and prohibited information technology products and provides for the designation of new or emerging products — a power wide enough to reach advanced artificial-intelligence systems (directive). The only instrument addressed to artificial intelligence as such remains the National Artificial Intelligence Policy adopted by the Council of Ministers in June 2024, a policy rather than a binding statute (policy). The base holds no AI act, no draft bill and no regulator with an artificial-intelligence mandate, so what governs AI here is import control and general policy.	MOVEMENT on a security-clearance directive rather than on any statute addressed to artificial intelligence
Gabon	There is no artificial-intelligence legislation. What is dated is supervisory capacity: an information session on the global network of supervisory authorities was held in the capital on 31 March 2026. The session brought together regulators, ministries, researchers and civil-society actors on governance and international cooperation. The record does not show accession to the network. Nothing legislates. The strategy that would frame a rule has not been adopted, and the directorate general that would hold the policy is at draft decree. The country's placing inside a continental governance ranking's top thirteen rests on stated commitments, the account itself putting a wide gap between those and what exists — which is the same finding read from the other end.	NO CHANGE a standing position the base holds for the first time
Gambia	No artificial-intelligence instrument exists and the policy is still in drafting as at April 2026. The ministry's statement to the United Nations science and technology commission puts the national policy in development. No bill, regulation or regulator guideline addressing artificial intelligence has been laid. Where the state has acted on synthetic content it has done so institutionally rather than legally: a misinformation response centre runs a fact-check hotline with a public audit trail, staffed by human analysts.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Ghana	An emerging technologies bill is the chosen vehicle instead of a standalone artificial-intelligence Act, and the oversight body it needs does not exist. The draft would create an emerging-technologies agency for cross-functional compliance across artificial intelligence, blockchain, connected devices, cloud and quantum, with voluntary startup registration, and was to be laid before Parliament in 2026; no text is held (bill). A responsible artificial-intelligence body was proposed at a national consultation in April 2025 and provided for in the launched strategy within its first year, and sixteen months after first proposal it has no establishing instrument, budget or staff (oversight body). Sources differ on whether it is one body or an authority plus a ministry office (consultation, approval). A third draft would overhaul the 2008 law governing the information technology agency, licensing every technology business, certifying professionals, regulating artificial intelligence and blockchain, levying 1 per cent on services and splitting the agency's regulatory and commercial arms (agency bill); the minister's answer to critics is that detail comes in a later legislative instrument (agency bill, critics, response).	MOVEMENT
Guinea	No instrument: the summit hosted in Conakry named a favourable regulatory environment for ethical and responsible artificial intelligence as one of three priorities, and a national roadmap was validated in December 2025 but is not published. 2025-11-12 - the seventh continental technology summit opened in Conakry under an artificial-intelligence theme, co-chaired by the head of state and a neighbouring president, and named the creation of a regulatory environment favourable to ethical and responsible artificial intelligence among its three stated priorities. A political commitment hosted by the country, not a normative instrument: no law, decree or regulator follows from it. The roadmap it points at was validated in three phases — institutional, regulatory and technical foundations, then progressive integration into public services, then regional positioning on responsible use and its text is not published. The one binding rule that exists is sectoral and prohibitive: the broadcasting regulator has prohibited media outlets from carrying artificial-intelligence-generated content. A six-country francophone governance framework was adopted in July 2026 and is non-binding.	MOVEMENT
Guinea-Bissau	No artificial intelligence instrument exists; the nearest is the law against false online information of May 2026. The law passed with amendments in May 2026 addresses false information on social networks and names no technology. It was passed by a transitional council seated after a takeover whose leaders had ordered radio shutdowns and blocked four major platforms nationwide in November 2025, which is the context any reading of it has to carry.	NO CHANGE
Kenya	Two tracks run in parallel: a governance act under debate and an artificial intelligence bill before the Senate transplanting the European statute. The Senate bill is a self-declared transplant with a presidentially appointed commissioner and fines capped at KES 5m, on a separate legislative track from the ministry's draft policy; the bill text is not held (Senate bill, copyright and AI). A human-rights organisation argued on 24 August 2026 that the governance act carries no child-specific protections and no consultation mechanism, setting it against the country's membership of a children's protection coalition and against a global drive to age assurance that the analysis argues adds data trails and surveillance risk rather than closing the harms it names; the act's text, sponsor and date remain unestablished (critique). A four-country legal review published in 2026 reports that neither the constitution, the labour code nor the data-protection act names automated hiring decisions in Kenya or in the three states it compares. Whether the general data-protection statute's automated-decision provisions reach recruitment is left open.	MOVEMENT
Lesotho	The government names the AI Policy of 2025 as its governance foundation; no AI Act or regulation exists. 2026-02-20 — the ministry's ICT director reported the national AI policy successfully approved. 2026-07-07 — the Deputy Prime Minister told the UN global dialogue that the policy is the country's AI governance foundation. 2026-07-20 — Lesotho signed the founding agreement of a world AI cooperation organisation in Shanghai, an international commitment ahead of any domestic law. The absence was searched on 31 August 2026. No Bill, no regulations, and no announced timetable for either.	NO CHANGE a policy with no statute behind it

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Liberia	No artificial-intelligence instrument: a court reached alleged AI-generated audio through ordinary disclosure rules. At Criminal Court A on 19 December 2025 the defence played an alleged AI-generated recording to argue that social-media audio is inadmissible without forensic corroboration; the judge sustained the objection on disclosure grounds, applying no AI-specific rule because none exists in the reported reasoning. The executive's own response to synthetic media is an appeal rather than a rule: in July 2026 the presidential press secretary warned of fabricated and AI-generated documents attributed to government and asked citizens to authenticate through official channels.	NO CHANGE
Libya	The adopted AI strategy names the legislative vacuum and sets a four-stage law roadmap to 2030. The strategy adopted in June 2026 is unusually direct about its own starting point: it names a legislative vacuum and sets a four-stage roadmap to legislation by 2030. No artificial intelligence statute is in force. The instrument that arrived first is soft: the regulator reopened the draft national artificial intelligence charter for public comment in April 2026, five weeks before adoption, and the information authority convened a meeting in April to move the strategy from drafting to implementation.	MOVEMENT
Madagascar	No artificial-intelligence law, bill or regulator exists; the data-protection commission is the nearest body with oversight bearing on it. The only binding provision located is in the 2014 data-protection law, whose article 3 prohibits decisions taken solely on automated profiling (law). The commission that enforces it published its first annual report in 2026, confirming its effective establishment (report). A courtesy visit to the National Assembly in August 2025 drew a statement of support for laws adapted to technological questions, the closest dated statement of legislative intent on file (visit). No bill has been tabled.	NO CHANGE
Malawi	An AI Bill is targeted to reach parliament before December 2026, and the copyright body will not register wholly AI-generated works. The bill is announced as the statutory backing for the strategy, to establish a framework promoting innovation while safeguarding citizen privacy and ensuring operational accountability; the minister put the target at before December 2026, no draft text is stated, and the strategy it would ground is itself pre-adoption (bill, drafting, scope). The statutory copyright body will not register works created entirely by artificial intelligence or distribute royalties on them; the rule is known only as reported, with no test stated for how much assistance is admissible, and the body's own statement is not held (rule).	MOVEMENT
Mali	Francophone West African artificial-intelligence governance guidelines were adopted with five other states in July 2026, led by an advocacy organisation. The guidelines were adopted on 9 July 2026 and announced at a global dialogue on artificial-intelligence governance (guidelines). They are the country's only artificial-intelligence governance instrument in force, they are regional rather than national, and they were led by an advocacy organisation rather than by a state. No domestic statute, decree or regulator on the subject is held.	MOVEMENT
Mauritania	No statute or regulation addressed to artificial intelligence. What exists is a strategy and a sector framework for schools. Mauritania governs artificial intelligence by policy rather than by law. The national strategy for 2024 to 2029 is the governing document, and the one sectoral instrument beneath it is the national framework for artificial intelligence in the republican school, adopted in January 2026. Nothing on the base is a statute, a decree or a regulator's binding rule reaching artificial intelligence. Where synthetic content is addressed it is addressed by training: a programme with the audiovisual regulator on deepfakes and synthetic media for journalists in July 2026. The general data-protection statute is the only law that would reach automated processing.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mauritius	The higher education AI regulations of April 2026 are the country's only binding artificial-intelligence instrument. Government Notice 39 of 2026 makes regulations on the use of artificial intelligence in higher education (regulations). The national strategy and its fairness, accountability, inclusiveness and responsibility guidelines are non-binding (strategy, guidelines). The higher education regulator issued amended guidelines of its own in May 2026 (guidelines). What the base does not hold is any general artificial-intelligence statute, bill or regulator: the one binding rule reaches universities only.	MOVEMENT
Morocco	The electoral organic law carries the only enacted artificial-intelligence offences, while a private members bill on regulating the technology has not moved. Organic law 53.25 enumerates artificial-intelligence tools as a means of commission on four electoral offences and creates a new article punishing the fabrication of election disinformation with two to five years and a fine of MAD 50,000 to 100,000, upheld against a press-freedom challenge (offences). The constitutional court found nothing unconstitutional in December 2025 (decision, tabling). A seventeen-article private member's bill setting fines of MAD 50,000 to 500,000 has been before the chamber's bureau since January 2025 with no committee report (bill, roundup).	MOVEMENT
Mozambique	There is no dedicated artificial-intelligence legislation; an online copyright act is in drafting and an intellectual property strategy mandates a patentability study. The ICT institute's board chairman stated in August 2026 that the country still lacks dedicated artificial-intelligence legislation (absence). An Online Copyright Protection Act is in drafting for introduction next year, its chairman naming authorship of artificial-intelligence output and liability for artificial-intelligence training as open questions the country has no law on; no draft text or introduction date is held (drafting). An intellectual property policy and strategy to 2035, approved by resolution in June 2026, mandates a study of the patentability of inventions made by artificial intelligence and of the inventive-step and disclosure standards that should apply (strategy, account).	MOVEMENT
Namibia	Artificial-intelligence legislation is announced as following the strategy, and the research council's own authors recorded no governance framework in place. The minister sequenced legislation behind the strategy, and nothing has been drafted or tabled (sequencing, framework). The research council's own authors recorded no artificial-intelligence governance framework in place as at February 2026. A strategy that is itself unpublished cannot yet ground a statute, so both halves of the governance question are pending on the same document.	NO CHANGE announced as following the strategy with nothing drafted or tabled
Niger	The data protection authority was abolished in June 2026, removing the body that held the declaration duty for artificial-intelligence operators. The government abolished the data protection authority by decree and transferred its prerogatives to the ministries of justice and of the interior as part of a wider administrative reorganisation; no primary decree text was located. The provisions themselves stand. The consolidated text of the 2022 data protection law defines artificial intelligence at article 57, requires developers, manufacturers and service providers operating from Niger to declare to the authority, and restricts fully automated decisions and profiling at article 52. What has gone is the body those duties were owed to. No transitional arrangement naming which ministry now receives a declaration is on file, and the law names neither deepfakes nor algorithmic disinformation.	REGRESSED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Nigeria	A risk-based regime sits in an unpassed bill, competition law was turned on AI training over Nigerian journalism, and judicial officers called for authentication standards. High-risk systems in finance, public administration, surveillance and automated decision-making would face annual impact assessments with fines up to ₦10m or 2 per cent of Nigerian revenue (bill); an external reading finds the bill envisages risk assessment without categorising risk into levels, and a domestic critique warns it concentrates broad powers in agencies that lack proven capacity (bill, control, governance). A presidential directive of July 2026 covers alleged anti-competitive practices, unlawful exploitation of news content and other unfair conduct by major global technology and generative artificial-intelligence firms; it followed a press-organisation petition and no terms of reference or interim finding is published (directive, scope). Fifty-four judicial officers called for stricter authentication standards for AI-generated evidence and a review of the digital-evidence, cybercrime and privacy statutes; a communique carries no legal force and no legislative response is on record (communique). A university-system artificial-intelligence framework has been written and three tertiary regulators committed to harmonise (tertiary). A four-country legal review published in 2026 reports that neither the constitution, the labour code nor the data-protection act names automated hiring decisions in Nigeria or in the three states it compares. Whether the general data-protection statute's automated-decision provisions reach recruitment is left open.	MOVEMENT
Rwanda	No review framework for commercial artificial-intelligence partnerships is held, and a three-year vendor memorandum was signed in February 2026 without one. External commentary asks who is accountable when a frontier vendor becomes infrastructure for government health and education work, and records that the memorandum was signed with no review framework in place; the criticism is attributed, not adopted (commentary, memorandum). The country holds an artificial-intelligence policy and is standing up an agency, so the gap is specifically in the instrument that would govern a commercial partnership rather than in artificial-intelligence policy generally. A four-country legal review published in 2026 reports that neither the constitution, the labour code nor the data-protection act names automated hiring decisions in Rwanda or in the three states it compares. Whether the general data-protection statute's automated-decision provisions reach recruitment is left open.	NO CHANGE
Sao Tome and Principe	There are no AI-specific laws or regulations and no national AI ethics commission; the data protection law and its authority are the only governance anchors. The readiness assessment finds no specific legal provision on artificial intelligence and names the 2016 personal data protection law and the 2017 cybercrime law as the nearest anchors, the cybercrime law needing updating to cover artificial intelligence; there is consequently no national AI ethics commission or dedicated governance structure (assessment). The same assessment records that the data protection law makes it an administrative offence, punishable by fine, for a body notified by the authority to keep open network access available to controllers not complying with the law (assessment); the innovation institute can issue strategies and guidelines but these do not carry the force of law (profile). An AI justice platform is meanwhile being built with a chatbot trained on national legislation (platform): the first public-facing AI system arrives ahead of any rule governing one.	NO CHANGE
Senegal	A four-country comparative study found no artificial-intelligence-specific legislation in force or in draft, and the strategy stack and a planned ethics committee carry the field instead. The study searched in August 2026 and found no artificial-intelligence-specific instrument on record; it rates a neighbour's strategy the most advanced of the four on inclusion and data governance (study). What the country holds instead is a 2023 strategy, an instruction for a development plan, a planned ethics committee and a non-binding regional guideline set — four policy artefacts and no binding rule.	NO CHANGE
Seychelles	The Broadcasting Corporation Act 2026 requires an AI-use policy for content and broadcast operations — the only statutory AI duty held. The Act, assented on 9 July and gazetted on 13 July 2026, repeals the 2011 statute and requires the Corporation to develop and periodically review a policy on the use of artificial intelligence in content creation, curation and broadcast operations (Act). It is sector-specific and applies to one state broadcaster. No general artificial-intelligence statute, regulation or code applies across the economy, and the policy the Act requires is not itself held.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sierra Leone	No statute or regulation reaches artificial intelligence. A first national strategy is being drafted and the data-protection bill is not yet law. Nothing on this base is a law, decree or binding rule addressed to artificial intelligence. The instrument closest to one is still being written: the communications ministry is developing the country's first national artificial intelligence strategy with a financier, alongside a draft readiness diagnostic, and convened media, civil society, government and the private sector on it in May 2026. A strategy is not a regulation, and this one is recorded as under development rather than adopted. Where harm is addressed it is addressed by campaign: a deepfake and digital misinformation awareness campaign in July 2026. The general data-protection statute that would reach automated processing is still a bill.	NO CHANGE
Somalia	No artificial-intelligence instrument is in force or in draft. A readiness assessment was still recruiting its lead expert in October 2025. Recruitment opened in October 2025 for a national expert to lead a readiness assessment and produce a policy-oriented report to inform a national governance framework, working under a government-side steering committee (call). Somalia was listed at inception stage. The national artificial intelligence centre names advising on ethical policy formulation among its objectives (centre), which places the drafting capacity somewhere but produces no instrument. The Data Protection Act is the only statute reaching automated processing at all, and it is not AI-specific (Act).	NO CHANGE
South Africa	No rules govern state automated decision-making. What moved instead was litigation over an algorithmic grant eligibility screen and a copyright Bill silent on AI. The position is unchanged and stated as such: the base holds no instrument governing automated decision-making by the state. What the window produced is a court case rather than a rule. The state is appealing a January 2025 judgment that struck down regulations governing the Social Relief of Distress grant, a scheme administered online only and screened by an algorithmic verification system that excluded applicants it read as earning above R624.00; the court found the automation unfairly excluded otherwise eligible applicants, an AI governance organisation was admitted as a friend of the court, and the appeal was set down for 25 August 2026. The one Bill in the window that touches machine learning does so silently. The Copyright Amendment Bill would replace fair dealing with a broader fair use exception, and the Constitutional Court's judgment of 26 June 2026 is now held in full: fair use in section 12A survived and only sections 12D(1) to (5) fell, as an arbitrary deprivation of property, so the educational-copying subsections return to Parliament. The Bill still says nothing about generative AI or text and data mining, which imports another country's judicial answer to those questions along with the doctrine.	NO CHANGE
South Sudan	No artificial intelligence statute: the Cybercrimes and Computer Misuse Act 2026 is the closest instrument, enacted citing AI-enabled abuse. The legislature passed the bill on 25 November 2025, with the ICT minister giving artificial intelligence being used to discredit and abuse people as a reason for it (passage), and the President signed it into law on 18 February 2026 (Act). The Act is technology-neutral - hacking, identity theft, cyberstalking, cyberbullying, false or misleading information - with no artificial-intelligence or deepfake provision of its own (explainer). A general cybercrime law invoked against a specific harm is not regulation of that harm.	MOVEMENT
Sudan	No artificial-intelligence statute is in force. The cybercrime amendment of 2020 is the instrument reached for, and it is not AI-specific. The Cyber Crime Prevention (Amendment) Act, 2020 was signed on 22 April 2020 and gazetted on 13 July, sharply increasing penalties across articles 5 to 39 of the 2018 Cyber Crime Law (gazette). It carries no deepfake or generative-AI provision, and no dedicated instrument was found. A draft data and artificial intelligence law was reported in redrafting in August 2026. When a manipulated image of the prime minister circulated in June 2026, the information ministry reserved the right to act without naming a provision (statement).	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Tanzania	Tanzania told the UN it has a strategy framework and no artificial-intelligence liability or oversight rules. Tanzania's own statement to the United Nations global dialogue on artificial-intelligence governance describes an implemented national strategy framework of 2026 and positions responsible use, human oversight, transparency and data governance as national priorities, while acknowledging the legislative gap and that artificial-intelligence-specific liability and oversight rules were still being developed. What is in force instead is a content rule: a 2025 amendment adds unethical, fabricated and artificial-intelligence-generated material to the prohibited online content list and requires service providers and platforms to filter and remove it. Prohibiting output is not regulating a system, and nothing on the record reaches an automated decision taken about a person.	NO CHANGE the gap is acknowledged by the government itself
Togo	No general artificial-intelligence statute exists; a sectoral use policy for vocational training entered drafting in September 2025. The technical training ministry launched drafting on 23 September 2025 of a national policy on the use of artificial intelligence in vocational training, framed around ethical and responsible use and aligned with international and regional orientations. It is at situational-analysis stage and sectoral, not a general law. What stands in the meantime is technology-neutral: the 2019 data-protection statute bars decisions with legal effect taken solely on automated profiling, supervised by the authority whose organisation decree gives it control, inspection and reference-framework powers. No artificial-intelligence-specific Togolese instrument, in force or in draft, was located.	MOVEMENT
Tunisia	The ministry has begun drafting frameworks for responsible artificial-intelligence use; no law, decree or gazetted instrument exists. The communication technologies minister told a professional conference in May 2026 that his ministry had begun drafting legal and regulatory frameworks for responsible artificial-intelligence use, covering data protection, privacy and digital sovereignty, as the governance pillar of the still-unpublished national strategy. What exists is a statement of intent at a conference. No draft text, timetable or consultation is held, and no artificial-intelligence law, decree or gazetted instrument exists — which leaves the 2004 data-protection law and its replacement bill as the only instruments that would reach an automated decision at all.	NO CHANGE drafting begun and no text published
Uganda	The government's own assessment with the ITU finds no legal or regulatory framework for artificial intelligence, and the strategy meant to precede one is still drafting. The ICT ministry's national landscape assessment, prepared with the International Telecommunication Union, records that no legal or regulatory framework for artificial intelligence exists. That is the position at both ends of the window. 2026-03 - the ministry ran nationwide stakeholder consultations on a National AI and Emerging Technologies Strategy. 2026-06 - a readiness assessment was validated with UNESCO at a workshop in Kampala, feeding the same strategy. 2026-08 - the strategy was still drafting sixteen months after being called final, with a completion date of the end of the financial year. A strategy is not a law, and nothing in the base names a bill, a regulation or a regulator for artificial intelligence. A four-country legal review published in 2026 reports that neither the constitution, the labour code nor the data-protection act names automated hiring decisions in Uganda or in the three states it compares. Whether the general data-protection statute's automated-decision provisions reach recruitment is left open.	NO CHANGE an assessed absence with the strategy still in draft
Zambia	No binding instrument; a readiness assessment methodology was piloted ahead of the national strategy's review before its end-2026 expiry. 2026-06-22 to 23 — a Lusaka consultation piloted an international readiness assessment methodology, ahead of the National AI Strategy's review before its end-2026 expiry. That is the whole of the movement, and the expiry is the part worth recording: the country's only artificial-intelligence instrument is a strategy that runs out at the end of this year, with no statute, statutory instrument or regulator rule behind it and no successor drafted. A readiness assessment is a diagnostic, not a rule.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Zimbabwe	A national artificial-intelligence act is proposed by the strategy with no draft on record, and an ethics framework is committed for tabling by the first quarter of 2027. The act is a strategy proposal with no draft on record (act, privacy). The minister's own caveat on the ethics framework was that policy without implementation is mere poetry (framework). A regulatory sandbox is named in the strategy and a supervising council was announced in August 2026 (sandbox), and technical standards are likewise a strategy proposal (standards). Four artificial-intelligence instruments, all proposed by one strategy that has no legal force.	MOVEMENT

E-commerce legislation

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	Law 18-05 is in force while most online selling runs through social-media pages outside its obligations, cash on delivery dominant. The law is in force, and the great majority of online selling runs through social-media pages outside its obligations, with cash on delivery dominant. The assessment is named-analyst opinion from a consumer organisation rather than a state position; the law's own date and text are not held, and no enforcement action or compliance figure is on file. A statute whose scope most of the activity it governs sits outside, with no published enforcement, is the position - and the payment side matches it, with fewer than a tenth of merchants operating a card terminal.	NO CHANGE
Angola	No dedicated electronic commerce statute. Parliament authorised an electronic signature regime in July 2026, the missing half of one. The framework is assembled from adjacent instruments rather than an electronic commerce act. The 2011 regulation on information society technologies and services is the oldest of them, and the general electronic communications regulation of December 2025 the most recent. What was missing was legal effect for signatures, and that moved in the window: parliament authorised the electronic signature and certification regime in July 2026, with the public key infrastructure and timestamp service already under construction. A startups law passed in March 2026 governs the companies rather than the transactions.	MOVEMENT
Benin	Loi 2017-20, the Code du numerique, has been in force since 20 April 2018 as the sector's framework statute. The Code du numerique was adopted by the National Assembly on 13 June 2017, brought into conformity with the Constitution after two Constitutional Court decisions, and promulgated on 20 April 2018; it has since been amended by Loi 2020-35. The earlier Code de l'information et de la communication, Loi 2015-07 of 20 March 2015, remains alongside it. The code is the authority every subsequent instrument on this ledger cites: the state information systems security policy, the non-terrestrial networks regime and the interoperability framework are all made under it. What the base does not hold is any account of its enforcement.	NO CHANGE a standing statute the base holds for the first time
Botswana	The Electronic Communications and Transactions Act 2014 is the principal e-commerce statute; the movement this year was in taxing digital supply. 2014-05-14 — the Act gives legal recognition to electronic communications and transactions and is unamended on the record. 2026-05-29 — regulations set the registration and compliance machinery for foreign suppliers of remote services. 2026-07-01 — the Value Added Tax Act 2026 was gazetted, taxing remote services and electronic marketplaces supplied into Botswana. The capture of the 2014 Act is a truncated scan and does not carry its commencement date.	MOVEMENT on the tax side
Burkina Faso	Loi 045-2009, adopted 10 November 2009, is the principal electronic-transactions statute. Loi 045-2009 was adopted on 10 November 2009 and promulgated on 4 December by Decret 2009-824, covering information-society services, electronic signatures, electronic commerce and distance-contract consumer protection. No implementing decree, enforcement record or case under it is held.	NO CHANGE a standing statute the base holds for the first time

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Burundi	There is no free-standing e-commerce statute; coverage sits in the 2024 communications code, under which the regulator made a conformity declaration compulsory in June 2026. There is no Burundian law on electronic commerce, electronic transactions or electronic signature; coverage is carried inside the 2024 code des communications electroniques et postales, whose article 1 applies to all transactions by electronic means, and the regulator treats that code as the legal basis for electronic commerce. 2026-05-29 — the regulator published guidelines for the national electronic-commerce sector setting technical, operational and organisational standards for interoperability, transparency, transaction security and online consumer protection. 2026-06-26 — it then made a prior conformity declaration compulsory for platforms and merchant sites operating in Burundi, which is the operative regulatory step. The guidelines themselves are an image-only scan, so what they require cannot be read from the base.	MOVEMENT
Cameroon	Loi 2010/021 on electronic commerce has been in force since December 2010, with its implementing decree from 2011. Loi 2010/021 on electronic commerce was enacted on 21 December 2010, Decret 2011-1521 fixed its modalities in June 2011, and Decret 2012-1318 constituted the electronic certification authority under it. The statutory chain is complete and nothing on the file reports enforcement, a certified provider count or a transaction volume under it.	NO CHANGE a standing statute the base holds for the first time
Cape Verde	Legal frameworks for digital services, e-commerce and digital banking are named among the 5G strategy's declared reach; no bill is held. The frameworks were declared as a component of the 5G strategy presented in September 2025 and are named among the declared reach of the strategy approved on 20 February 2026, alongside a regulatory and business framework to support investment. No bill, draft or diploma is held: it is a stated legislative programme covering three fields, not a named instrument. Against that, a dedicated startup law with tax benefits, a special technology economic zone, modern data-protection and digital-transactions laws, simplified business registration and a digital-nomad visa are all stated to be in place, with no instrument number, adoption date, text or take-up figure for the startup law or the visa. That position rests entirely on a minister's summary in trade press.	MOVEMENT
Central African Republic	Loi 22.002 of January 2022 is the operative electronic transactions law and the only instrument on the subject the base holds. The law adopted on 11 January 2022 governs electronic transactions and is the single instrument on the subject the base carries; the regulator's own law index carries the citation. The law's own held record has no resolvable address - the regulator's hosted file did not answer from two clients - so what a reader can follow is the index entry rather than the text. No implementing decree, no dispute under it and no electronic-commerce measure is held, and nothing in the window touched it.	NO CHANGE a first stated position with no earlier account behind it
Chad	Loi 008/PR/2015 on electronic transactions is the statute; the digital code that would replace it was still a draft in 2026. The regulator's register names Loi n. 008/PR/2015 on electronic transactions among the operative statutes (register). A second workshop on the digital code drafting mission opened on 17 February 2026 discussing the avant-projet written after a December 2025 workshop, the drafting funded through the state fibre project (workshop). The electronic-communications framework moved separately: a decret of 16 January 2026 promulgated the law ratifying an August 2025 ordinance amending it (promulgation), and the March 2026 agency reform brought electronic transactions expressly into its remit (reform).	MOVEMENT
Comoros	The e-commerce law is still to be drafted, and no electronic-signature instrument exists. The e-commerce law was recorded as still to be drafted in March 2021 and is unchanged, as is a revised public procurement code for procurement conducted electronically, drafted and not enacted, with no procurement platform on record. An electronic-signature instrument was named as a legal vacuum by the state's own 2018 strategy and none is on file at 2026-08-04 - the last of six gaps the state itself named in 2018 that the base cannot show closed. Without a signature instrument, none of the paperless procedures being procured elsewhere in this report has a legal basis for the act it would replace.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Congo	Certified electronic invoicing became compulsory for every economic agent from 1 July 2026, with four implementing orders gazetted. A voluntary pilot group ran at the window's opening. A decree signed 31 March 2026 and gazetted 9 July made invoicing mandatory from 1 July for every economic agent except the state, local authorities on public-service missions and diplomatic bodies, with terminals, software and enterprise modules homologated jointly by the tax directorate and the security agency, after a sensitisation campaign in June. Four orders gazetted 16 July set a four-stage homologation with a 30-day decision deadline, mandatory cryptographic certification, a penetration test under twelve months old, a sworn no-backdoor attestation, ten-year invoice retention and real-time tax-directorate data access, at FCFA 5,000,000 per terminal model and per software version. No phase-in by firm size and no assisted or offline route is stated.	MOVEMENT
Cote d'Ivoire	Loi n 2013-546 on electronic transactions remains in force with article 50 repealed, and its implementing decrees still stand. The law stands in force with article 50 repealed by ordinance and ratified in 2025, and its 2014 and 2016 implementing decrees on cryptology, electronic signature and digital archiving are the stated legal basis of the national public key infrastructure. Nothing in the window amended it. It is the only Ivorian digital statute the base can name implementing decrees for, which is why it carries the weight it does here: electronic signature across the administration, certificate issuance and digital archiving all rest on a 2013 text and its two decrees.	NO CHANGE
Djibouti	The Digital Code, eight volumes and about 800 articles adopted on 30 June 2025, is in force with no implementing decree held. The code was adopted by the National Assembly on 30 June 2025, three weeks before the window opened, and is in force across eight volumes and about 800 articles, explained at length in the state daily. No implementing decree is held for any of its volumes. It is the instrument on which the data-protection regime, the prior-authorisation regime and the supervisory commission all rest, and none of the three is evidenced in operation - so a code of eight hundred articles has produced no secondary instrument the base can show in the thirteen months since.	NO CHANGE
DR Congo	Electronic commerce is scoped and defined by the Digital Code of March 2023, with the authorisation regime for digital services set by order in March 2026. The code scopes itself to digital activities and services, electronic writings and trust-service providers and digital content, and defines electronic commerce among its terms. It is the whole of the primary law. 2026-03-17 - an order sets the authorisation regime for digital services and activities, and the regulator separately published procedures for authorisation and declaration of personal data processing in May 2026. The trust layer the code provides for is not built: the national electronic certification authority is named and not established, while a July 2026 interministerial order already prices qualified trust services at US$30,000 for foreign and US$10,000 for local providers — a fee schedule for a service no domestic body can yet supply.	NO CHANGE a standing position the base holds for the first time
Egypt	A 54-article party draft on the digital space would oblige platforms to appoint a legal representative and register influencers; it is not tabled. Nothing of the kind was on record at the window's opening. The draft was described by its sponsor on 10 August 2026 as fifty-four articles across seven chapters, requiring digital platforms to appoint a legal representative in the country and register influencers on a national platform, and regulating artificial intelligence, deepfakes, online extortion, gambling and child protection online. It is not tabled and no text is published; the article count and the preparation time are the sponsoring member's own account, and it is separate from the cabinet's own social-media legislative review. So the most comprehensive platform instrument on this ledger exists only as a member's description of it. The enabling statute behind electronic transactions is older and is held only at second hand: Law 15 of 2004 regulates electronic signatures and established the Information Technology Industry Development Agency, making electronic signature data, media and information submitted to a licensed certification authority confidential and requiring applicants for e-signature services to operate systems securing the secrecy and privacy of customer information to legal standards. The base knows it through practitioner guides rather than the instrument, and holds no licensing or enforcement record under it.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Equatorial Guinea	The 2015-2017 laws supply electronic signature and access rules; the state is instead building platforms. The legal base for electronic dealing is the signature and electronic access laws inside the 2015-2017 package. No electronic commerce act has followed. Activity has run ahead of the statute: national marketplace and e-commerce platforms sit on the ledger, and in April 2026 a foreign platform pitched an e-commerce hub while the Vice-President formed a task force on paying digital creators. Neither has a consumer-protection rule behind it.	MOVEMENT
Eritrea	No electronic transactions framework is in force; the only relevant texts are unofficial consultation drafts (drafts). A diaspora legal-reform initiative published around eighty consultation-draft acts, codes and regulations intended to reconstruct Eritrea's legal order, including a proposed commercial code and a payment systems and digital finance act addressing electronic transactions (drafts). These are unofficial and carry no legislative status. The standing assessment is that Eritrea lacks a comprehensive legal framework in the digital-trade area, with the only body holding sector-supervision power having little to no decision-making authority (profile). Nothing on the base records a government bill, a consultation or a stated intention to legislate on electronic transactions.	NO CHANGE
Eswatini	Online Media Publishing Guidelines 2026 are stated by the ministry as complete in development, and restrictions on children reaching harmful content were raised in the Senate with no instrument behind them. The ministry stated development of the guidelines is complete, and used the same account to state that implementation, enforcement and oversight of data protection are vested in the regulator rather than itself (guidelines). A senator asked during a Senate debate what prevents minors reaching harmful content; the answer was that two offices are working together on online-content regulation. No instrument, timetable, age-verification method or definition of harmful content is stated, and no draft is held (question). Guidelines complete but unpublished, and content regulation that exists only as an answer in debate, are the two forms this unit's regulation of platforms takes.	MOVEMENT
Ethiopia	A draft amendment would add service provider duties, site blocking and take-down notices to the 2004 copyright proclamation, the first platform-liability instrument held. The intellectual property authority reported in August 2026 that the amendment is being drafted after several consultation rounds, and would put duties on internet service providers, set procedures for blocking infringing sites and create a rights-holder take-down notice (the authority's account). Enforcement would stay rights-holder-initiated and by web address, because channel operators cannot be identified, against existing remedies of one-to-ten-year sentences and fines to 25,000 Birr (the same report). A draft proclamation ratifying accession to the Berne Convention is before the Council of Ministers, with no parliamentary date published (the report again).	MOVEMENT
Gabon	Loi 025/2021 governs electronic transactions and Loi 026/2018 the electronic communications sector. Loi 025/2021 on electronic transactions was gazetted on 28 December 2021, and Loi 026/2018 on electronic communications on 17 October 2019. Together with the 2023 cybersecurity and data-protection laws they are the statutory base the later ordinances build on. No implementing texts, enforcement record or case under either is held.	NO CHANGE standing statutes the base holds for the first time
Gambia	The Communications Bill 2025 passed second reading in March 2026 and covers electronic commerce, signatures and cybercrime in one instrument. It also covers electronic communications and broadcasting, and was referred to National Assembly committees after the second reading on 2 March 2026 (second reading). The press union is pressing for repeal of the restrictive media laws around it (committee stage). No enactment date is held, and until it passes the country has no electronic transactions or electronic signature statute at all.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Ghana	An electronic transactions bill dated October 2025 would mandate age verification, ban targeted advertising to children and impose duties on very large platforms. The draft is published on the ministry's site and would replace the 2008 Act, requiring risk assessments and semi-annual transparency reports from very large platforms (draft bill). The 2008 Act remains the standing baseline until it is enacted, and no parliamentary date is held.	MOVEMENT
Guinea	An electronic signature decree signed in August 2026 completes a frame that has rested since 2016 on a statute the base can only read in summary. The 2016 statute frames electronic signature, digital archiving, certification of information systems, consumer information duties in online commerce and the related fraud and forgery offences; the agency publishes it as a 14-page image-only scan with no text layer, so the provisions are its summary rather than the statute's words (the statute). The 2021 implementing decree gives the telecommunications regulator supervision of electronic transactions including mobile money, with security oversight, data collection, administrative police powers and the power to levy charges on payment traffic; providers must hold a domestic or generic domain, a dedicated site and a secured transaction facility, and price in local currency inclusive of taxes and delivery (decree). The August 2026 decree gives an electronic signature the same probative force as a paper writing where it is authentic, unfalsifiable, non-reusable, unalterable and irrevocable, extends it to administrative, private-sector and person-to-person acts, and imposes duties on certification services; no certification authority is yet accredited on the record (signature decree). The regulator's mandate was widened again in May 2026, with powers of audit, control and certification over the information systems used in electronic transactions (widened mandate).	MOVEMENT
Guinea-Bissau	The electronic transactions bill remains in development; the regional layer moved instead, with a paperless customs directive presented at Bissau. The electronic transactions bill sits on the ledger as in development and no enacted commerce statute is held. The movement is regional and sectoral: a Bissau workshop in April 2026 presented the union's paperless customs directive and a planned trade-document exchange platform. Domestic electronic dealing is happening under tax administration rules rather than commerce law, through the platform-only value added tax declaration for customs clearance.	NO CHANGE
Kenya	A copyright bill and an intellectual property bill are both out for comment, alongside an adopted inter-agency piracy enforcement framework. The copyright bill would create a copyright authority and a disputes tribunal, and carries the 2001 computer-generated-work authorship rule forward unchanged; its comment window's closing date is not on file (copyright bill). The intellectual property bill would merge the industrial property institute, the copyright board and the anti-counterfeit authority into one regulator with a tribunal, replace the 2001 and 2008 statutes, and set rules distinguishing artificial-intelligence-assisted from artificial-intelligence-generated inventions (property bill). An inter-agency digital piracy enforcement framework was adopted on a steering committee's hundred-day report, with the ministry coordinating the copyright board, the regulator, the media council and the tribunal; a national policy on digital piracy is announced as the next step with no draft, drafter or date (framework, losses).	MOVEMENT
Lesotho	The Electronic Transactions and Electronic Communications Bill remains pending promulgation; the movement was in adjacent law. 2024-12-30 — the National Digital Policy records the 2022 Bill as still pending promulgation. 2026-03-27 — electronic invoicing was made mandatory for VAT transactions, a direct digital-commerce compliance rule made while the general statute waits. 2026-05-05 — the Payment System Bill reached second reading. Four years after it was drafted, Lesotho still has no statute recognising electronic transactions generally.	NO CHANGE the Bill still pending
Liberia	The 2002 Electronic Transactions Law is the only enacted e-commerce statute and predates platforms entirely. Chapter 13 of Title 14, approved 8 January 2002 and published 19 June 2002, facilitates the use of electronic transactions for commercial purposes. Nothing covering online consumer protection, platform obligations or intermediary liability has been enacted in the twenty-four years since. The base holds no e-commerce bill in drafting.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Libya	Law 6 of 2022 covers electronic signatures, contracts and fifteen disclosures to online buyers; no e-commerce act follows it. The law enacted in October 2022 is the operative instrument for electronic dealing: signature and contract rules, and fifteen matters a seller must disclose to an online buyer. It is not a full electronic commerce regime, and the national digital agenda of October 2025 records the electronic commerce law as still unenacted alongside the data protection law.	NO CHANGE
Madagascar	The 2014 electronic transactions law stands unamended; a separate cybercrime bill was adopted in Council of Ministers in July 2026. The law of December 2014 governs electronic transactions, contracts and payment across 35 articles (law); the base holds it from a mirror of the official legal database and only to its first part. A regional workshop in September 2025 put data governance and electronic commerce to delegates from the southern African bloc (workshop). A draft bill reforming the decade-old cybercrime statute was adopted in Council of Ministers in July 2026 (bill). It is a criminal-law instrument and does not amend the transactions law.	NO CHANGE
Malawi	Consumer-protection regulations were enacted in March 2026 above a 2016 e-commerce Part still unamended. The standing framework is Part V of the Electronic Transactions and Cyber Security Act, in force since 1 June 2017; the capture does not reach that Part, so what it obliges is not readable from the base. 2025-12 - the government's statutory fiscal policy statement committed to developing e-trade legislation, regulations, a policy and a strategy, with no draft, sponsor or date attached. 2026-04 - the Competition and Fair Trading Regulations 2026 were enacted as Government Notice 27 of 2026, assented 5 March, strengthening the consumer-protection framework that governs online trade. The regulation's own text failed to render at capture.	MOVEMENT
Mali	Law 2016-012 on electronic transactions, exchanges and services is the instrument, alongside a consumer protection law of 2015. The transactions law of 6 May 2016 is held from the official journal and is the footing an electronic signature service would rest on; no such service is in operation on the record (law). The consumer protection law of 16 July 2015 sits behind the regulator's decisions on telephone credit validity and internet bundle practices, and neither instrument cites the other on the record (consumer law, decision).	NO CHANGE
Mauritania	The transport regulator gave ride-hailing applications fifteen days to bring their authorisations into line in August 2026, warning of suspension. The communique warned that failure within the deadline could bring legal proceedings including suspension of the activity, with no further notice or warning required, and set the warning against growing use of digital platforms for transport services (communique). No operator is named and no count of non-compliant authorisations is given. It is the base's only record of platform activity being regulated in the country, and it reaches the platforms through transport law rather than through any digital statute.	MOVEMENT
Mauritius	A virtual-asset solicitation rule in the omnibus bill would presume any publicly accessible communication targets Mauritius, and electronic transactions amendments were referred to in July 2026. Unlicensed solicitation of investors would be prohibited by any medium, defined to reach targeted or algorithmic advertising, platforms, applications, social media, influencers, affiliates, referral codes, seminars and webinars, with any publicly accessible communication presumed to target the country; the presumption shifts the burden onto an offshore promoter to show it was not soliciting locally (rule). Amendments modernising the digital-commerce framework and consumer protection were referred to by the minister at a postal-sector workshop, with no text, timetable or introduction date published (amendments).	MOVEMENT
Morocco	The 2026 forex rulebook raises the electronic commerce allowance for accredited start-ups to MAD 2m. Electronic dealing rests on the trust services law of 2020, which governs signatures and certification providers and replaced parts of the earlier electronic exchange law. The constraint that actually binds cross-border sellers is exchange control, and it loosened: the 2026 general instruction raises the electronic commerce allowance for accredited start-ups to MAD 2m and the individual ceiling to MAD 20,000, inside a 256-article consolidated rulebook in force from 1 January.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mozambique	The electronic transactions licensing regime issued its first 19 licences in June 2026, against about 170 companies under evaluation. Nineteen licences were issued to digital operators in June 2026 of about 170 registered companies under evaluation (licences). The fee is one national minimum wage plus 1 per cent of revenue annually from the next fiscal year (regime, diagnostic). The regime had been in force with no licences issued a year earlier, so the movement here is the door opening rather than the rule changing.	MOVEMENT
Namibia	The Electronic Transactions Act 2019 has been in force since March 2021 and covers signatures, consumer protection and contracts but not personal data or cross-border flow. The Act is the interim instrument law enforcement relies on for cybercrime, with the communications statute and the penal code (Act). A regulatory profile records that it does not reach cross-border data flow, data localisation or personal data protection (profile). Company process under the corporate laws reform is routed through it, so it is doing more work than it was written for.	NO CHANGE
Niger	An arrêté placing commercial Wi-Fi zones under a declaration regime was published in May 2026, on an electronic transactions law from 2019. The arrêté places commercial Wi-Fi zone provision under a declaration regime with the regulator, caps each provider at five points of sale, bans signal amplifiers and masts, sets an annual fee schedule by geographic zone and gives three months to comply. The framing statute is the 2019 law on electronic transactions, which defines the rights and obligations governing electronic transactions in Niger; its full text is held only as an official landing page, the attachment having resisted capture. No consumer-protection rules specific to online sale, and no volume figures for electronic commerce, are on file.	MOVEMENT
Nigeria	A US$222m consumer-protection penalty is under appeal, enforcement of new platform rules was paused in July 2026, and a local-presence bill went to public consultation. The penalty was imposed in 2025 and is under appeal, distinct from the data-protection track (penalty). The minister paused enforcement of new internet-platform rules pending a unified national digital-economy policy framework, convening a joint technical committee of three regulators to resolve overlapping mandates (pause). An amendment requiring large platforms to maintain physical offices went to a Senate committee hearing and then to public consultation; a coalition backed passage on an investment case while a rights organisation calls for withdrawal over a power it reads as letting the commission prohibit a non-compliant platform's activities after thirty days without adequate judicial safeguards, and thresholds, deadlines, sanctions and appeal routes are still undefined (bill, hearing, legislation).	MIXED a US$222m platform penalty under appeal and a local-presence bill in consultation while enforcement of new platform rules was paused
Rwanda	A competition and consumer protection law enacted in February 2026 carries the first dedicated statutory e-commerce framework in its sixth chapter. The law enacted on 26 February 2026 repeals the 2012 competition law, and its articles 41 to 48 create enterprise and intermediary obligations, licensing requirements and online-consumer rights (law). Until this, e-commerce was governed only by general contract and consumer provisions; the base holds no earlier dedicated instrument. No implementing regulation or licensing register has been published since enactment.	MOVEMENT
Senegal	A bill on a media and social-network regulator was presented in January 2025 covering digital platforms and online media, and no source has moved it since. The draft was presented with the broadcasting regulator and its scope covers digital platforms, social networks and traditional and online media (bill). Nothing in the base has moved it since January 2025. A ministry legal adviser separately states on the record that the state has worked on social-media regulation since 2024, which is the first dating of the workstream the base holds and does not name the bill (workstream).	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Seychelles	The Electronic Transactions Act 2001 gives legal effect to electronic records and digital signatures; customs payment rules were digitised in 2026. The founding statute recognises electronic records, digital signatures and electronic dealings with public authorities; the consolidated text held is current to 29 March 2018 (Act), and a 2024 statutory instrument amending its exclusions schedule is not applied to it. In April 2026 Cabinet approved customs regulations requiring electronic or bank-transfer payment of dues of R50,000 and above and operationalising the ATA Carnet system (Cabinet). The statute is twenty-five years old and has not been revisited for platforms, marketplaces or consumer contracting online.	MOVEMENT
Sierra Leone	A public-private dialogue was convened to operationalise the Electronic Transactions Act 2019, seven years after enactment, and the Act as enacted and gazetted is not held. The dialogue ran over two days in July 2026 with donor support (dialogue, framework). The Act as enacted and gazetted is not held; every automated route to the text failed as at August 2026, and what the base has is a record of the instrument rather than its provisions (record). An Act that needs a dialogue to operationalise it seven years after passage is the clearest instance in this unit of the gap between enactment and effect.	MOVEMENT
Somalia	A national e-commerce strategy stands at its November 2022 baseline against an April 2028 target, with the lender recording that no strategy exists. It is a results indicator of the regional digital integration project, and the lender records that no strategy exists in this country, in a neighbour, or at the regional body (strategy). Three parties to the same project have none between them. That is a regional gap rather than a national one, and it is the only place this base can say so.	NO CHANGE
South Africa	The 2002 electronic transactions statute is the standing law, platform competition guidance was gazetted in February 2026, and a market inquiry imposed binding remedies on six platform companies. The Electronic Communications and Transactions Act has been in force since 2002 as the legal basis for electronic contracting and data messages, held as an excerpt, with no amendment or successor bill on file. 2025-11-13 — the competition authority's media and digital platforms market inquiry closed with binding remedial actions under section 43D(1) for Google, Meta, Microsoft, OpenAI, TikTok and X, on a finding that 77% of the population take social media as their main online source of news. Google's remedies commit up to ZAR 687,500,000 over their five-year term. 2026-02-06 — final guidance for leading online intermediation platforms was gazetted, naming price-parity clauses, interoperability restrictions, self-preferencing and misuse of competitively sensitive data as the competition risks the commission will act on. It is guidance rather than regulation and no enforcement action under it is on file. Beyond the inquiry's remedies, the enforcement on file is a municipal one: three online grocery platforms had premises closed in a health and licensing operation, reported under local government. A study reported on 9 September 2026 finds the crackdown on low-value imports significantly slowed cross-border e-commerce growth, pushing the two largest platforms towards local fulfilment (study).	MOVEMENT
South Sudan	A national e-commerce strategy is recorded as non-existent in the regional project's seventh implementation report. The lender records it as non-existent (strategy). The same report records the same absence for two other parties to the project, so three parties have none between them.	NO CHANGE
Sudan	A ministerial meeting resolved to review state-level border-trade protocols and replace them with a single national legal framework, with revenue protection the stated driver. The meeting was chaired by the finance minister and resolved to refer the state-to-neighbouring-country protocols to the Council of Ministers, to build one national framework in their place (meeting). It was paired with the adoption of the national platform as the sole channel for foreign-trade transactions, and the stated driver is revenue protection rather than service delivery. No draft, timetable or list of the protocols under review is published.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Tanzania	The Electronic Transactions Act was amended by the Finance Act 2026, and a review of more than 1,000 laws was announced with no list, sequencing, responsible body or timetable. Section 13 of the Act was amended on 30 June 2026; the land, building and motor-vehicle requirement is a substantive obligation in its own right and is not part of the scheduled transaction classes the separate order lists (amendment). The thousand-law review was announced in August 2026 with nothing stated about scope, sequencing, responsible body, timetable or consultation route (review). Distinguishing the Act amendment from the order made under it matters: secondary accounts treat the mandatory-payment regime as regulations, and it is neither.	MOVEMENT
Togo	Rules on mobile commercial offers entered into force in April 2026, recorded in one line of an operator parent's half-year financial report. No instrument number, title or text is held, and the sole account is a single line in a foreign-listed operator's financial filing (rules). A rule that changes what operators may offer consumers, evidenced only in the accounts of the company it binds, is worth recording as exactly that. The consumer-rights tour recorded separately is running in the same period with no reference to it on file.	MOVEMENT
Tunisia	The 2000 statute still governs electronic exchanges and commerce, with no repeal or replacement located. Law 2000-83 gives electronic documents and signatures the evidential standing of writing, creates the national electronic certification agency, licenses certification service providers, and sets pre-contractual disclosure duties, a ten-working-day withdrawal right and electronic-payment-instrument liability rules for online sales. A bill on marketing and promotion through websites and social networks was still in committee as at September 2026. A statute written before the platforms it now has to govern is the position here, and no enforcement action, complaint volume or certification-provider register is held against it.	NO CHANGE
Uganda	A Protection of Sovereignty Bill caps foreign funding at about UGX 400m a year above which ministerial approval is required, and the regulator opened nationwide enforcement against unlicensed public wireless access. The bill was assessed technically by the central bank to joint committees in April 2026; enactment is reported but unconfirmed (bill, editors). A cap on foreign funding with ministerial approval above it reaches every civil-society body in this ledger — the digital-rights submissions, the awareness campaigns and the climate-information project are all externally funded. Nationwide enforcement against unlicensed public wireless access opened on a public notice in July 2026 (enforcement).	MOVEMENT
Zambia	A Postal and Courier Services Bill 2026 went to public written submissions, replacing a 2009 Act that also underwrites postal banking and financial services. Submissions closed on 27 July 2026 (bill, submissions). The 2009 Act underwrites postal banking and financial services, so its replacement governs the postal service's agency-banking role — which makes a postal bill a payments instrument. Submissions closed one working day after the consultations ended, and it is the only open public call for written comment on a domestic instrument the base holds for the whole window (consultation).	MOVEMENT
Zimbabwe	Cabinet directed drafting of a statutory instrument on e-hailing services, reported to Parliament in August 2026 with no text, consultation or commencement date published. It is a drafting instruction (direction). It is the only platform-economy instrument in this ledger, and the revenue motive named in the reporting is what places it here rather than in transport.	MOVEMENT

Statistics legislation

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	Oversight of the statistics office was transferred by presidential decree in November 2025; the governing statute is still the 1994 legislative decree. The office's own presentation to an international quality workshop names the 1994 legislative decree as the governing statistics law, with its organisation set by a 1995 decree whose article 6 makes it responsible for the technical preparation, conduct, processing and analysis of population censuses. 2025-11-10 - a presidential decree transferred oversight of the office, and a Council of Ministers sitting the same autumn took its modernisation. The institution is being rearranged around a statute that is thirty-two years old, and no replacement bill is on the record.	MOVEMENT
Angola	The 2011 national statistical system law governs, with the statistics institute's organic statute renewed by decree in March 2026. The statute is settled: the law of the national statistical system, whose accessibility principle is what the institute cites when undertaking to release census results and microdata. No amendment to it has been located. What moved is the institution beneath it. The statistics institute received a new organic statute by presidential decree in March 2026, and a statistics development strategy for 2026 to 2032 was announced in June. Both sit under the 2011 law rather than replacing it, so the legislative position is unchanged while the machinery under it is not.	NO CHANGE
Benin	Loi 2022-07 of 27 June 2022 organises and regulates statistical activity. Loi 2022-07, adopted on 2 June 2022 and promulgated on 27 June, organises and regulates statistical activity in Benin, replacing the earlier regime under which the third national statistical development strategy was drawn up. No implementing decree, statistical council minute or compliance report under the new statute is held.	NO CHANGE a standing statute the base holds for the first time
Botswana	The Statistics Act commenced in December 2010 and is unamended; a second development strategy launched in its place. 2010-12-01 — the Act establishes Statistics Botswana and the national statistical system, including the ten-yearly census mandate. 2025-11-24 — the second strategy for the development of statistics was launched, after more than a year's preparation. No amendment to the Act is on the record and none is announced.	NO CHANGE with the movement in strategy rather than law
Burkina Faso	The 2021 organic statistics law is in force, requiring a ministerial statistical visa before any collection of individual data; its council was reorganised in August 2025 and a five-year master plan set for 2026-2030. The organic statistics law of December 2021 governs statistical activity and requires a statistical visa from the minister before any collection of individual data — a licensing rule over data collection that reaches well beyond official statistics. 2025-08-26 - the statistics council was reorganised by decree and tasked with proposing national statistical policy and diffusion priorities and coordinating the national statistical system. 2025-12 - the council issued its fifth five-year master plan for 2026-2030, evaluating its predecessor and setting the national statistical system's new strategic axes. No budget line or financing plan for it is held, and the statistics institute's own strategic plan for the same period runs alongside.	MOVEMENT
Burundi	Statistics legislation is a chain of three acts rather than a code, the 2021 recast being the most recent link with a machine-readable text. Loi n 1/08 du 20 mai 2021 recast the 2007 law organising the national statistical system, and is the substantive recast in a chain running from the 2007 statute through this one to a further modification of 24 July 2023 that the statistics institute cites as the governing law. No gazetted text of the 2023 modification was located, so the operative law can be named and its current wording cannot be read. Nothing moved on the statute in the window.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cameroon	Loi 2020/010 on statistical activity has been in force since July 2020, with its 2021 implementing decree. Loi 2020/010 on statistical activity was enacted on 20 July 2020 and Decret 2021-690 fixed its modalities in December 2021. The statistics institute has published guidelines for producing statistics from administrative sources under it. No compliance report or statistical council record under the statute is held.	NO CHANGE a standing statute the base holds for the first time
Cape Verde	The national statistical system rests on Lei 48/IX/2019, gazetted on 19 February 2019. Lei 48/IX/2019 was gazetted in Boletim Oficial n.o 18 on 19 February 2019 as the governing statute of the national statistical system. The base carries the statute and the statistical development strategy for 2022-2026, and nothing testing either against practice: no independent evaluation of the statistics institute is held, and the ledger carries that absence as a separate open row.	NO CHANGE a standing statute the base holds for the first time
Central African Republic	The 2001 statistics law is still the basis, and a modernised replacement was validated in April 2026. The founding law of 16 July 2001 established the national statistical system, the statistics institute and the national statistics council, and is still the institute's own cited legal basis. 2026-04-23 - a workshop with the presidency, the national assembly, ministries, the central bank and civil society validated a modernised draft law to replace it, carrying new institutional arrangements. No adoption or promulgation is recorded since, so a twenty-five-year-old statute still governs.	MOVEMENT
Chad	Loi 026/PR/2019 organises statistical activity, and two instruments were made under it for the third census. The statute makes the statistics institute the central body of the national statistical system with legal personality and the status of a public administrative establishment; four application decrees sit under it (statute). A joint arrete of 6 May 2026 set the composition, powers and operation of provincial, departmental and sub-prefectoral census commissions in every administrative circumscription (arrete), and a decret of 20 July 2026 extended the main enumeration to 6 August from an original window closing 21 July (decret). The statute is also what the restrictive microdata access policy is grounded in (policy).	MOVEMENT
Comoros	The 2011 statistics act is in force and unamended, constituting the national statistical system and its three components. The act, deliberated and adopted on 26 March 2011, constitutes the national statistical system as the Conseil national de la statistique, the statistics institute and the statistical services placed within ministries and public bodies. It gives those bodies scientific independence, subordinates any census or survey to a prior visa from the Council, and sets fines from 500,000 to 4,500,000 Comorian francs for running a survey without one. Nothing amends, replaces or implements it on file, and no implementing decree is held. The capture stops part-way through article 28, so the later articles are outside what the base can be read for.	NO CHANGE
Congo	Loi 36-2018, gazetted on 18 October 2018, governs official statistics. Loi 36-2018 on official statistics was gazetted on 18 October 2018, and the national statistical development strategy for 2022 to 2026 runs under it. No implementing decree, statistical council record or compliance assessment under the statute is held.	NO CHANGE a standing statute the base holds for the first time
Cote d'Ivoire	The statistics law's three implementing decrees were adopted in June 2025, covering the survey visa, pricing, and transfer of administrative files. 2025-06-18 - the Council of Ministers adopted three decrees implementing the 2020 statute that amended the 2013 law organising the national statistical system: on the award of the statistical visa for surveys and censuses, on the conditions and pricing of statistical products and services, and on communication of administrative files to the system's administrations for statistical exploitation. Their stated purpose is a coherent and transparent governance framework, protection of personal information in inter-agency data transfers, and a pricing grid keeping statistical data accessible. The statute's own text is not held - it could not be fetched - so this communique is the most authoritative dated statement of the framework on the base, and no decree text is held either.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Djibouti	Two decrees and an order in the period created a specialised statistical corps and approved the institute’s 2026 budget. 2026-02-25 - the institute's 2026 forecast budget of 485,686,344 FDJ was approved by order, following board adoption on 18 November 2025 and Council of Ministers review on 23 December. 2026-05-12 - a decree created a specialised civil-service corps of statisticians, engineers, senior administrators and technicians, charged with compiling, analysing and projecting socio-demographic, economic and environmental data. 2026-06-11 - a government reorganisation decree assigns the finance ministry responsibility for the national strategy on collecting, processing and disseminating official statistics. No founding statistics law is held; these are instruments made under a framework the base does not carry.	MOVEMENT
DR Congo	Draft ordonnances-lois organising statistical activity were adopted, the country's first legislation on the subject (adoption). The Council of Ministers adopted draft ordonnances-lois organising statistical activity on 28 August 2026, presented as the country's first legislation on the subject and as adapting the legal and institutional framework (adoption). The texts are drafts adopted by the executive; the base holds no promulgation and no published text.	MOVEMENT
Egypt	The governing statute is the 1960 statistics and census law; no replacement is on the record. The statistics agency publishes the 1960 statute under its own heading of the laws regulating statistical work; its article 1 vests censuses and statistics in a technical body constituted by presidential decree. It is sixty-six years old and the base holds no amendment or replacement. 2026-02-02 - the machinery under it moved: the prime minister chaired the high committee for the 2027 population, housing and establishments census, with the agency and six ministers. A national statistics strategy had been in preparation for nearly two years with 18 ministries and research bodies plus international partners and is not published.	NO CHANGE a first stated position with no earlier account behind it
Equatorial Guinea	The census legal basis was set by Decree 25/2025 and Resolution 006/2025; no general statistics act is held. The base holds no general statistics statute for Equatorial Guinea. What it holds is instrument-by-instrument authority: the fifth population census and first agricultural census rest on a 2025 decree and resolution, with a scientific committee starting work. The institute's own governance moved in July 2026, when its board adopted a revised staff statute and approved action plan spending above five million.	MOVEMENT
Eritrea	The statistics office has never operated under an enacted statistics law; a draft proclamation was recorded as pending (review). A mid-term review of statistical capacity support records that the statistical proclamation, the equivalent of a statistics act, had been submitted to government and that the formal issue was still pending (review). No later record of enactment was located at the probe date of 31 August 2026, so the national statistics office has operated for at least two decades without a statutory mandate. This matters for the surveys the base does hold: a population and health survey was carried out without a law defining who owns the data, who may access it or on what terms it is published.	NO CHANGE
Eswatini	The Statistics Act of 1967 is the operative statute, fifty-nine years old and unamended on the base, with no replacement Bill held. The Act constitutes the Central Statistical Office and carries its collection powers; no amendment, replacement Bill or commencement is held (Act). Under it, the ministry and the population fund launched the 2027 Population and Housing Census together with the 2025/2026 Economic Census in November 2025 (launch). The 2026 budget speech reports household mapping and listing begun and E130.5 million allocated (budget speech). The gap is the point: the largest statistical operation in a decade runs on a statute written before the internet, and nothing on the base sets a date for replacing it.	NO CHANGE a statute of 1967 unamended against a census it must now carry

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Ethiopia	A successor statistics proclamation was approved by the House on 30 June 2026, replacing the 2005 statute (approval). The Council of Ministers referred the draft Ethiopian Statistics Proclamation to the House of People's Representatives on 26 May 2026 (referral), and the House approved it on 30 June 2026, intended to strengthen the statistics service's independence and align the national statistical system with international statistical principles (approval). The statute it replaces is Proclamation 442/2005, which established the Central Statistics Authority as an autonomous federal agency with legal personality and defined the national statistical programme (Proclamation 442/2005). No gazette text or proclamation number for the new law had been located at the probe date of 28 August 2026, so what is held is the approval, not the enacted text.	MOVEMENT
Gabon	A bill amending the statistical system law went to the Council of Ministers on 22 May 2026. The planning minister presented a bill amending Loi 15/2014 of 7 January 2015 instituting and organising the Systeme Statistique National, as modified by Loi 016/2022 of 6 September 2022, to bring it into conformity with the Constitution of 19 December 2024 and make the system's organs fully operational. The statistics institute's own statutes were fixed by Decret 0314 of August 2024, and AFRISTAT ran a data-quality diagnostic mission in 2026. It was a bill in Council and not an enacted law at capture. The institutional record is held and no statistical output from the office is.	MOVEMENT
Gambia	The 2005 Act is unamended, with the African Union peer review urging a modernised law in November 2025. The Statistics Act 2005 is the constitutive statute of the statistics bureau, held here only as an image-only scan with no machine-readable text. Both reviews of the system call for its revision. The national statistical strategy found more than a third of officials unaware of the Act it says needs revising, and the African Union peer review of November 2025 urged mandate reform and a modernised statistics law. No amending bill has been laid.	NO CHANGE
Ghana	The 2019 statute is still the governing statistics law and a stakeholder engagement opened on a replacement bill in July 2026. The founding statute came into force on 27 September 2019, establishing the statistical service as the central statistics-producing and co-ordinating institution for the national statistical system and repealing the 1985 law; the service's own page carries it as the currently governing framework. 2026-07-26 - the service opened a stakeholder engagement with ministries, development partners, civil society and academia on a proposed replacement bill. It is a consultation: no bill is shown as introduced, read or passed, and no draft text is held. The held capture of the Act itself stops at section 19 of a longer statute, so its offences and miscellaneous provisions are not on the base.	MOVEMENT
Guinea	The 2014 statistics law and its 2015 implementing decrees and orders are in force, including the duty on administrations to transmit data to the national statistical system. The statistics institute's own compendium reproduces the 2014 law organising and regulating statistical activity together with the 2015 decrees on the national statistics council and on financing of the national statistical programme, and the orders on the council's specialised commissions, on the obligation of administrations and public bodies to transmit data to the national statistical system, and naming council members. The law invokes the principles of objectivity, confidentiality and efficiency. No amendment since 2015 is held. What the law is used for is visible: the head of state formally acted the preliminary census results by decree read on national television on 6 March 2026, which is what gives them their official character for the planning, implementation and monitoring of public policy.	NO CHANGE a standing position the base holds for the first time
Guinea-Bissau	The 2007 framework law still governs, and the census rests on it. The national statistical system framework law of 2007 is the governing statute and no amendment appears in the base. The system it governs is delivering: the fourth census launched field enumeration in June 2026, the country's first fully digital count since 2009, after the institute opened recruitment for about 5,000 census staff in September 2025.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Kenya	The Statistics Act of 2006 is under replacement by a 2026 bill establishing a statistics authority with stated professional independence. The Act of 2006 has governed official statistics for two decades (act). A bill published in April 2026 would replace it, establishing a Kenya Statistics Authority whose guiding principles include professional independence (bill). Sector statistical obligations continued to be made under other statutes: regulations of November 2025 require statistical returns from petroleum licensees (regulations). The bill is published and not enacted.	MOVEMENT
Lesotho	A fourth Statistics Bill is expected to be enacted before the end of 2026, replacing a statute from 2001. 2001 — Act 8 of 2001 establishes the Bureau of Statistics and the national statistical system. 2025-12-12 — a regional peer review recorded a fourth Statistics Bill in drafting and recommended modernising the 2001 Act. 2026-06-27 — bureau officials described the Bill's content and expected enactment before the end of 2026. The Bill text is not held.	MOVEMENT
Liberia	The 2004 Act stands unamended, and was tested in the House in June 2026. The National Statistics and Geo-Information Act, approved 22 July 2004, creates the statistics office as an autonomous agency, empowers it to demand information from any ministry, bureau or agency, and binds its staff to an oath of confidentiality. No amendment moved in the window. What did move is a test of the statutory role: in June 2026 the House summoned the director general and his statisticians to justify the population benchmarks behind a proposed expansion of the chamber from 73 to 87 seats.	NO CHANGE
Libya	Law 16 of 1963 still governs statistics and censuses, its penalty scale unchanged since enactment. The statute creates the central statistics committee and remains the governing law, with penalties still expressed in the currency unit of 1963. Nothing has replaced it. The statistics development strategy that ran to 2023 carried no adoption decree the base could locate and has not been renewed, so the sector runs on a sixty-three-year-old law and an expired plan.	NO CHANGE
Madagascar	The 2018 statistics law remains in force; activity in the window was implementation rather than amendment. The law of April 2018 repealed the 1967 statistics obligation and established the national statistical system, its council and the statistics office's statutory role (law). Alignment of public finance statistics to international standards continued under external technical assistance in March 2026 (alignment). A project document for the fourth general population and housing census was presented in May 2026 (document). The law itself is held to its first title only; its 78 articles are not fully captured.	NO CHANGE
Malawi	An amendment of April 2026 opened protected tax data to the statistics commissioner, above the 2013 Act. The operative law is now held: the National Statistics Act, chapter 27:01, commenced 19 July 2013 and establishes the National Statistical Office and the national statistical system. Nothing amends it. What changed came from outside it. 2026-04 - the Tax Administration (Amendment) Act 2026, Act 6 of 2026, assented 9 April, permits the revenue commissioner general to disclose protected tax data to the Commissioner of National Statistics. The Act's own text failed to render at capture, so what safeguards attach to that disclosure is not knowable from the base. 2026-04 - the statistics commissioner described the finalised strategic plan as expanding participation from 17 to 35 ministries and agencies.	MOVEMENT
Mali	Law 2016-005 of 24 February 2016 governs public statistics; the national statistics council and the master plan run under it. The text is held from the official journal (law). The national statistics council held an ordinary session in February 2026 (council), and the statistical master plan for 2020-2024 reached the seventeenth technical session of its annual review in August 2026 (review) — a plan whose own period expired two years ago and which has no successor on the record.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mauritania	No statistics statute is held. The system runs on the decadal statistics strategy for 2021 to 2030 and the continental charter. No statistics law, ordinance or decree constituting the statistical system appears on this base. What governs it is a strategy and a treaty commitment: the decadal national strategy for statistical development covering 2021 to 2030, and the country's position on the continental charter on statistics. The institution beneath them is being reorganised by decree rather than by statute: the Council of Ministers appointed the statistics agency's orientation council in March 2026 in the same sitting as the archives bill. The agency publishes to that mandate, including the preliminary poverty results of the 2025 household survey.	NO CHANGE
Mauritius	The Statistics Act 2000 is under revision, with the office's independence carried in the 2026-2027 budget annex. The Act has been in force since April 2001 and is held in its consolidated, amended form (Act). The 2026-2027 budget annex carries the independence of the statistics office (annex), and the Finance Act 2026 amends the statute book around it (Act). An observance of standards and codes data module assessed the statistical system in December 2025 (assessment). The independence provision is announced; no amending text is held.	MOVEMENT
Morocco	Law 046.26 creates a national statistical information council, replacing a governing decree of 1968. The system had been governed by a 1968 royal decree creating a statistics coordination committee, which remained the operative law for fifty-eight years. The replacement moved quickly: approved by the government council on 2 July 2026, adopted unanimously by the second chamber on 13 July with the companion law reforming the planning commission, and promulgated on 28 July as a 51-article statute splitting the statistical and evaluation functions.	MOVEMENT
Mozambique	Law 7/96 remains the operative statute creating the National Statistical System, unamended, while a personal-data bill bearing on statistical collection went to Parliament in March 2026. The founding instrument has not moved: Law 7/96 of 5 July creates the National Statistical System and the statistics institute's mandate and is still operative thirty years on. 2026-03-03 — the Council of Ministers approved a Personal Data Protection Bill for submission to Parliament, bearing on statistical collection, consent and cross-border transfer. It is an approved proposal, not an enacted law. 2025-08-18 — a ministerial diploma placed the production and publication of public-finance statistics inside the finance ministry's own internal regulation, an institutional mandate rather than a change to the statistical law.	NO CHANGE the founding statute stands while two adjacent instruments moved around it
Namibia	The Statistics Act of 2011 constitutes the agency and the national statistics system, and five standards were issued under it in September 2025. The Act provides for the statistics agency, the national statistics system and the spatial data infrastructure (Act). Five standards were published under its standards mandate in September 2025: statistical quality indicators, statistical metadata, leave no one behind, data and statistics presentation, and data and statistics dissemination (standards). The agency's own strategic plan runs to 2026/27, alongside a strategy for the development of statistics over the same period. The Act is fifteen years old and has not needed amending on this base — which distinguishes it from the data protection statute the same government has been drafting for six.	MOVEMENT
Niger	Draft texts instituting the national statistical system were adopted in Council of Ministers in January 2026, replacing a framework from 2004. The Council of Ministers of 23 January 2026 adopted draft texts instituting the fundamental principles of statistical activity and the national statistical system, creating a national statistical development fund, redefining the statistics council and updating the statistics institute's legal status. The institute's director had reported at a congress on 8 October 2025 that a committee had drafted the ordinance and submitted it to the government's secretariat general for adoption. The instrument in force meanwhile is the 2004 statistics law. No promulgated text of the new ordinance is on file.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Nigeria	The Statistics Bill 2025 passed third reading in December 2025 and went to public hearing in June 2026. The House of Representatives passed the bill at third reading on 10 December 2025, to repeal the 2007 Act and redefine the statistics bureau's powers and funding. Its committee held a public hearing on 8 June 2026, at which the speaker and the statistician-general described the bill as a complete overhaul of the 2007 Act rather than an amendment. The Statistics Act 2007 remains operative. No Senate stage and no assent is on record, so the bill is two chambers short of law.	MOVEMENT
Rwanda	The 2013 statistical activities law remains the governing statute, and a draft central bank law would add a publication obligation. The statute in force since June 2013 founds the national statistical system and assigns the statistics institute its coordinating role; it is still cited as primary on the institute's own legal page (law). A draft law reforming the central bank, whose relevance the Chamber of Deputies approved on 12 February 2026, would make publication of statistical and financial data and studies an express obligation under its article 69 (explanatory note). That is at draft stage. The data governance framework published in November 2025 sits below the statute rather than amending it (framework).	MOVEMENT
Sao Tome and Principe	The 1998 statistics law defines the national statistical system, creates the statistics institute and sets a regime of statistical secrecy and transgressions. The law names the national statistics council, the statistics institute, the central bank and the institute's delegated organs as the system's organs, creates the institute in Artigo 7 as the body producing and analysing official statistics, and sets fines in Artigos 11 to 15 (law). It was passed by the National Assembly on 12 August 1998 and promulgated on 31 August 1998 (law). Nothing amending or replacing it is held, so a statistical system now running a census, a household budget survey and an automatic electoral register rests on an instrument written before any of them.	NO CHANGE
Senegal	The 2004 statistics law as amended in 2012 remains the framework, with no revision adopted or tabled in the window. The regional inventory records the operative chain: loi 2012-03 of 3 January 2012 modifying and completing the 2004 law on the organisation of statistical activities, 2005 decrees on the national statistics council and on the statistics agency, orders on the council's thematic groups and its membership, and 2020 orders on the statistical visa. No later replacement statute appears in the inventory, and no adopted or tabled revision was found inside the window. Two limits carry: the base holds a regional inventory rather than the statute itself, and the national archive holds only a scan of the decree transmitting the 2012 bill to the National Assembly rather than the enacted text.	NO CHANGE
Seychelles	The National Bureau of Statistics Act 2010 is in force, and the African Union's 2025 peer review recommends replacing it. The Act was assented on 9 July 2010, founding the Bureau and the national statistical system and repealing the 2005 statute (Act). The peer review conducted in May 2025 and published in October records the Bureau's professional independence and recommends a new Statistics Bill (review); nothing held records one being drafted. The census the Bureau ran in 2022 was conducted under a separate Census Act, itself revised by the 2023 omnibus amendments (amendments).	NO CHANGE
Sierra Leone	The Statistics Act 2002 establishes Statistics Sierra Leone as a body corporate for official statistics, and is unamended in the base. The Act was gazetted on 7 November 2002 as an Act to establish Statistics Sierra Leone for the collection, compilation, analysis and dissemination of official and other statistics (Act). No amendment, review or replacement is on record, and the statistical strategies recorded separately run under it rather than change it. A census Act sits alongside it in the same published compilation.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Somalia	The National Statistics Law of 2020 remains the governing statute, having replaced a 1970 law; its own text is not held. Law No. 24, assented on 24 February 2020, established the national statistics bureau and repealed the Statistics Law No. 35 of 1970 (bureau). No direct link to the statute's own text was found; the bureau's institutional statement is the fullest account the base can reach, which is a real limit on what can be said about its provisions. Law No. 46 of 2026 adds a vital-statistics mandate alongside it without amending it (law).	NO CHANGE
South Africa	The Statistics Amendment Act has been proclaimed for implementation, with regulations and twenty memoranda of understanding under development to carry it. The Statistics Act of 1999 is the standing statute and the Amendment Act was assented in December 2024. 2026-03-11 — the Amendment Act had been proclaimed for implementation and implementation was reported as progressing; the proclamation date itself is not stated in the held account. 2026-06-23 — regulations and twenty memoranda of understanding are under development under the amended Act. Those memoranda are the mechanism by which the statistics office would obtain other departments' administrative data, which makes them the operative instrument rather than the Act. Nothing states which departments they cover or when they are expected.	MOVEMENT
South Sudan	The National Bureau of Statistics Act 2024 superseded the 2011 Act, though its text is not published. The bureau's own legal-framework page identifies the 2024 Act, assented in November 2024, as its principal legislation, superseding the 2011 Southern Sudan Centre for Census, Statistics and Evaluation Act (framework). The Director General briefed the Vice President's office in September 2025 with the Act as one of two documents discussed alongside a census development tool (briefing). The Act's full text is not reachable through the bureau's pages or the justice ministry's laws index, which still lists only the 2011 Act. A statute in force that a citizen cannot read is the standing condition of much of this base.	MOVEMENT
Sudan	The Statistics Act 2003 remains in force and was assessed in 2021 as not providing for recent advances in statistical production. A joint assessment of the national statistical system, with fieldwork between March and July 2021, states plainly that the Act is outdated, does not adequately provide for recent advances in statistical production and contains no gender-statistics provisions (assessment). That is the most current authoritative statement of the Act's standing the base holds. No full primary text of the Act itself was locatable, and no amendment or successor bill has been found.	NO CHANGE
Tanzania	The statistics statute establishes the bureau, its board and the national statistical system, unchanged across two revised editions. The Statistics Act, in its 2019 revised edition of the 2015 statute, establishes the statistics bureau as a continuing body, its governing board and the national statistical system, and is the principal statute for the production, coordination and dissemination of official statistics. A 2023 revised edition of the same statute is separately held, placing the initiation of official censuses and surveys under the Statistician General. No amendment bearing on data sharing, administrative-data access or statistical confidentiality in a digital system is held.	NO CHANGE
Togo	The 2011 statistics statute is in force; its text could not be obtained and is held only through the institute's own account. The statistics institute's own institutional page states that loi n 2011-014, voted and promulgated on 3 June 2011, defines the principles and institutional framework of the national statistical system for the production, securing and dissemination of public statistics, and lists the institute's fifteen statutory missions. The statute text itself was not obtained: the institute offers it as a download with no addressable link, and the one direct path located for the companion 2015 decree returns not found. The regional statistical body's member-state register independently catalogues both instruments. A prior-authorisation mechanism under that framework, the statistical visa, had its operational tools validated in July 2026.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Tunisia	The 1999 statute still governs the statistical system, with a replacement in drafting and no text published. Law 99-32 sets the principles of statistical activity, scientific independence, statistical secrecy including a sixty-year non-disclosure rule and the duty to respond, and constitutes the national statistical council and the statistics institute; the statistics institute still lists it as governing law. A replacement covering big data, administrative-data access and the governance roles of the council and the institute is being drafted alongside the 2026-2030 statistics strategy, after a finalisation promised for the end of 2025 passed. No amending or replacing statute has been located and no draft text is held.	NO CHANGE
Uganda	The 1998 statistics statute is unamended, and the bureau finalised a fourth strategic plan for 2025/26 to 2029/30 under it. The Uganda Bureau of Statistics Act, Chapter 310 has been in force since 1998, establishing the bureau and the National Statistical System and giving the bureau its coordination mandate. No amendment is held. 2026-01 - the bureau's own vote performance report records that the Fourth Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30 was finalised, on objectives covering production and dissemination of official statistics, coordination of the statistical system, and partnerships. 2026-08 - the finance minister called on the bureau to strengthen production and use of credible statistics for planning, budgeting, policy and monitoring at a board briefing. The plan document itself is not held, so its targets are not on the record; nor is any amendment bringing the 1998 Act into line with the administrative data now generated by the registries.	MOVEMENT
Zambia	The 2018 Act is operating on its own terms: a release calendar issued under section 27(1) and a Statistician-General appointed under section 11. Act No. 13 of 2018 establishes the statistics agency and the national statistical system and remains the operative framework. 2025-12 — a national statistical release calendar for 2026 was issued expressly under section 27(1) of the Act, operationalising its release-planning mandate. 2026-03-24 — a new Statistician-General was appointed, the statutory chief executive under section 11. Both are the statute working rather than changing, which is the more useful thing to record about a law eight years old: the offices it creates are filled and the duties it imposes are being discharged on schedule.	MOVEMENT
Zimbabwe	The Census and Statistics Act is in force as consolidated in 2020, and the statistics agency said in October 2025 that it is outdated. The Act, consolidated on 4 September 2020, constitutes the statistics agency and carries its census, survey and data-collection powers (Act). On World Statistics Day 2025 the agency said the Act is outdated and does not adequately support the efficient provision of official statistics, naming uneven connectivity in rural areas as its other operational constraint (statement). The agency adopted a board charter setting the statutory board's roles, authority and ethical standards, and naming the professional independence and credibility of official statistics among what it safeguards (charter). No amendment Bill, formal review or reform timetable is held: the agency's own account of the defect is the whole of the record.	NO CHANGE the controlling Act called outdated by the agency it constitutes

Access to information legislation

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Algeria	The media organic law requires public bodies to facilitate journalists' access to information; no general right-to-information statute is held. The organic law of 27 August 2023 governing media and information activity includes provisions requiring public bodies to facilitate journalists' access to information. That is a press-access provision inside a media statute, not a general right of access. No right-to-information law, no request procedure, no refusal ground and no appeal route open to a citizen appears anywhere on this ledger, and no request, refusal or appeal under the media law's provisions is recorded either.	NO CHANGE a first stated position with no earlier account behind it

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Angola	The 2002 access to administrative documents law stands. A 2026 inspection regulation adds access to inspection files, invoking habeas data. The general statute is old and unamended: the 2002 law on access to administrative documents, in force as enacted. The movement is subordinate and specific. The regulation of state inspection activity, adopted by presidential decree in April 2026, embeds the principles of digital administration, data protection and confidentiality in the inspectorate's procedure; article 25 imposes duties of information and cooperation on public bodies, and article 46 gives the administered access to inspection files and certificates, invoking habeas data. It is the most recent instrument on the base creating a right of access to a class of government record, and it reaches one class only.	MOVEMENT
Benin	The information and communication code stands; the broadcasting regulator made carriage of public-interest messages obligatory on 23 December 2025. The operative instrument is the information and communication code and nothing in the period amended it. 2025-12-23 — the broadcasting regulator published a decision obliging media to carry public-interest messages issued by government or on the regulator's order. That is an obligation to broadcast rather than a right to obtain, and it is the only movement the period records on this indicator.	NO CHANGE the code stands and a broadcasting obligation was added under it
Botswana	The Access to Information Act was passed, its passage confirmed from the podium in November 2025; no commencement notice is held. 2024-07-26 — the Act sets out the commission's functions, its audit power and the identity-card regime, with commencement on notice. 2025-11-11 — the President confirmed passage in the State of the Nation Address. 2025-10-17 — the Digital Services Act subordinates itself to this Act and ties enterprise data inventories to its disclosure obligations. No commencement notice is on the record.	MOVEMENT passed and not commenced
Burkina Faso	The access to public information law was reported dormant in February 2025, and its number, date and text are not held. A press-freedom body reported the access to public information law dormant, and no held source records any movement since. The law's number, date and text are not on the base, so what is recorded is an instrument known only by its inactivity. Nothing else supplies the function. There is no open data portal, no dataset catalogue and no publication licence, reported under open data, and the data-protection authority's own statutory annual report has not been published since 2020. Transparency in this record runs through budget documents and ministry review meetings rather than through any right to ask.	NO CHANGE
Burundi	An access to information bill was listed on the National Assembly's order paper for the session opened on 3 August 2026, with no text published. 2026-08-04 — the bill was listed for examination in the session opened on 3 August 2026. No text, tabling number, sponsoring ministry or timetable has been published, and none existed before this listing. The session runs about three months under the constitution, which is the outer bound for passage in this sitting. Nothing else on this ledger touches access to information: there is no open data portal, no open data policy and no published dataset, so the bill would arrive into an absence rather than onto a practice.	MOVEMENT
Cameroon	The e-government and access to information bill is still a preliminary draft; the 2018 transparency code stands. The bill is a preliminary draft on the right of access to and use of public information and the digital transformation of the administration, circulated in May 2023. Later reporting on its progress is in the base but is not citable, so the position stated here is older than the record. The transparency and good governance code promulgated on 11 July 2018 remains in force, requiring budget-information dissemination and civil-society involvement, and the finance ministry was still running first-contact sensitisation with civil society in April 2026 - eight years after promulgation.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cape Verde	Cabo Verde has a dedicated access-to-information statute: Lei 10/X/2022 regulates access to and re-use of administrative documents. Lei 10/X/2022, gazetted in Boletim Oficial n.o 47 on 16 May 2022, regulates access to and re-use of administrative documents and administrative information held by the bodies and entities listed in its article 2. The base holds the gazette's own summary of the law and not its text: the full-issue capture stops before the law begins, and no per-act text was reachable. Nothing on the file states how the right is exercised in practice, what the response times are, or whether any refusal has been appealed.	NO CHANGE a standing statute the base holds for the first time
Central African Republic	No access to information statute is held. The 2023 constitution carries a privacy right; legal reform for digital transformation remains at terms of reference. Nothing on this base is an access to information law. The constitutional layer addresses the opposite side of the question, protecting privacy, and the reform that might supply one has not started: terms of reference for a legal framework for digital transformation, dated March 2023. Where information does reach the public it reaches it by publication rather than by right: the statistics institute's open data portal and the unified public services portal. Neither creates a request procedure or an appeal route.	NO CHANGE
Chad	No freedom of information law has been adopted, and the media regulator suspended new online-newspaper applications in August 2026. UNESCO's periodic review filing states at paragraph 13 that no freedom of information law has been adopted in Chad and at paragraph 19 recommends one be introduced to international standards, against a constitutional guarantee at article 28 of the 2018 constitution (filing). On 3 August 2026 two communiques from the media regulator suspended, until further notice, the examination of applications to create online newspapers, under its 2026-2028 strategic plan, and stated that offences on digital platforms fall outside its remit for now (suspension). The one movement the other way is publication rather than access: the Journal Officiel platform launched in May 2026 gives free online access to legal texts back to 1958 (platform).	REGRESSED
Comoros	No access-to-information law has been adopted, and none is recorded as drafted. UNESCO's submission to the forty-sixth session of the universal periodic review states it plainly: no access to information laws have been adopted in the Comoros. That is a dated, sourced absence rather than a gap in the record. The constitution guarantees freedom of information, communication and the press only within conditions established by law, and the instrument that law turned out to be regulates journalism: the 2021 communication code created the press and audiovisual council and made a press card a condition of practising. Neither creates a citizen right to obtain a government record. Nothing on file records a draft, a commitment or a date.	NO CHANGE
Congo	Article 25 of the 2015 Constitution is the operative access-to-information provision; a 2026 decree required non-profit bodies to publish through an open portal. The Constitution promulgated on 6 November 2015 carries the operative access-to-information provision at article 25. It is a constitutional right without an implementing statute. 2026-02-26 — a decree set publication through an open portal for non-profit bodies, which is a disclosure obligation on one class of body rather than a general right of access.	MOVEMENT
Cote d'Ivoire	The 2013 access-to-information law's operational refresh was presented in July 2025 and nothing has been reported since. 2025-07-25 - a programme was presented at the Prime Minister's office as the operational refresh of the 2013 access-to-information law: a portal, a conformity audit tool, a helpline, a mobile application and a monitoring barometer. No later source is on file in the year since. No request volumes, audit results or barometer output have been published, so whether any of the five components exists in service is unestablished, and the law's own text is not held.	NO CHANGE

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Djibouti	No access-to-information law exists; the 1992 law on freedom of communication is the only instrument on the field. This is a searched absence rather than an unexamined one. A country panel dated April 2026 records that the media and information regime is still governed solely by the law of 15 September 1992 on freedom of communication, never substantially reformed in more than three decades, with no dedicated access-to-information instrument. The same panel names the communication regulator as the operative body and places the country 167th of 180 on the 2026 press-freedom index. The Digital Code's own title on access to administrative documents is the nearest statutory route, and it is a reuse provision rather than a right of access with a procedure.	NO CHANGE
DR Congo	A bill setting access as the norm was declared admissible on 27 March 2026; a classification regime was presented two weeks earlier. 2026-03-27 - the bill was declared admissible and referred to a joint commission with ten days to report: it sets access as the norm and limitation the exception, applies to public services and some private actors, and requires a simple, fast and free request procedure, proactive publication, reasoned refusals and a right of appeal. Four months past that ten-day deadline, no commission report, plenary date or adoption is held. 2026-03-13 - an information note to the Council of Ministers set out four levels of classification with access limited to cleared agents, traceability of transmissions, reinforced archiving and a ban on sending sensitive documents over private messaging, tied by its own account to the security situation in the east.	MIXED an access-to-information bill was declared admissible while a four-level classification regime was put to the Council of Ministers
Egypt	Two freedom of information bills were submitted to parliament in August 2026; nothing is enacted. 2026-07-05 - the minister of state for information told the prime minister that coordination was under way with ministries and authorities to issue the freedom of information law quickly. 2026-08-09 - a member's bill was submitted to the House with its text carried in the reporting. 2026-08-10 - a syndicate-backed bill was submitted after securing 60 lawmakers' signatures; it would create an authority for the protection of freedom of information. Two bills and a ministerial statement of intent, with no statute in force, is the position after a decade of the same commitment.	MOVEMENT
Equatorial Guinea	The Senate passed the country's first transparency and access-to-information bill unanimously in May 2026. The Prime Minister opened the debate before the Chamber of Deputies in February 2026 on transparency, access to information and public finance. The Senate passed the transparency and finance-access bill unanimously in May. Nothing yet records its promulgation, an implementing regulation, or a request procedure a citizen could use.	MOVEMENT
Eritrea	No freedom of information law has been adopted, a UN review body states plainly (review contribution). A formal contribution to Eritrea's universal periodic review states that no freedom of information law has been adopted, and that the constitutional guarantee of access to information sits in a 1997 constitution whose operative reality is the 1996 press proclamation (review contribution). The 2026 world press freedom index places Eritrea last of 180 countries and territories for the third consecutive year (index). The absence is legislative and practical at once: there is no statute, no request procedure and no appeal route, so nothing measures how much information is released.	NO CHANGE
Eswatini	No access to information law exists. The ICT ministry's own report to Parliament lists developing a Bill as a departmental action-plan item. The ministry's annual performance report for 2024/25 lists 'Develop Access to Information Bill' among its departmental action-plan items; the Bill is not tabled and no text or timetable is held (report). A regional media-freedom body met the ministry's principal secretary on 25 February 2026 and said it was on standby to support enactment; the ministry reaffirmed cooperation on media self-regulation and made no enactment commitment (communique). Where the ministry has legislated on information it has legislated on publishing rather than access: online media publishing guidelines are complete on its own account. Without an access right, the data governance policy's sharing between institutions has no counterpart obliging disclosure to a citizen.	NO CHANGE a Bill named as an action-plan item and not tabled

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Ethiopia	The state development bank adopted a policy classifying client credit information and four other categories as permanently non-disclosable. The policy, reported in August 2026, exempts client credit information, legal case files, strategy papers, security protocols and third-party contracts from declassification where disclosure could cause substantial harm to the bank, its stakeholders or the national interest, and lets the bank decline requests that would require it to create records it does not hold (disclosure policy). No instrument number, gazette reference or appeal mechanism is stated, and the base holds no general access-to-information statute against which to read it.	REGRESSED
Gabon	The constitution guarantees equal access to information and opens administrative documents to every citizen; the country has no access-to-information law. The constitution promulgated after referendum founds the common life on pluralist and participatory democracy and guarantees citizens equal access to information, with access to administrative documents open to every citizen. 2025-12 - the education and culture agency of the United Nations recorded in its universal periodic review contribution that the country has no access-to-information law, noted that article 20 of the 2016 communication code provides a narrower right of access, and recommended adoption of a law consistent with international standards. It is the finding against which the constitutional guarantee has to be read. 2026-02-26 - the communication code was amended by ordinance, gazetted 8 April 2026, without supplying one.	NO CHANGE a standing position the base holds for the first time
Gambia	The Act is in force but most public institutions have yet to appoint the information officers it requires, and requests go unanswered. Twenty-one-day statutory requests are going unanswered, on the press union's account of 7 August 2026 (union account). No government response, compliance count or enforcement action is on record, so a statute that exists is being reported as unimplemented by the constituency that uses it, and by nobody else.	NO CHANGE
Ghana	The information commission fined 254 public bodies GHS 20,000 each in August 2026, while institutions kept refusing releases. The fines were imposed under section 77(1) of the 2019 Act after reminders published in the Gazette, and the sanction count is the commission's own (fines). No collection figure, appeal outcome or compliance rate is published, so whether the fines were paid is not established, and the enforcement action itself is the only measure of the regime the base holds. 2026-09-03 - a newsroom's own tally counts 21 public institutions failing to release information on 24 separate requests between January 2025 and July 2026, the finance ministry, the attorney-general's office, the communications regulator and the highways authority among them, 17 months into an administration elected on a pledge to operationalise the Act. It measures what one requester asked for rather than a national refusal rate, and it is the only account of outcomes the base holds against the commission's account of sanctions.	MOVEMENT compliance contested
Guinea	The online legal gazette is free and carries more than 1,100 journals and 6,000 texts, and its index stops in April 2025. The gazette has been online and free to access since at least June 2025 (gazette). An acquisition attempt in August 2026 found the index carrying issues only to April 2025, so a publication channel that exists has stopped being current, and no access-to-information statute, request procedure or appeal route is held beside it.	NO CHANGE
Guinea-Bissau	The access to information bill remains in development, against platform blocking in November 2025. The bill sits on the ledger as in development and nothing in the window records it enacted. What did move went the other way: after the November 2025 takeover coup leaders ordered radio shutdowns and blocked Facebook, YouTube, TikTok and Instagram nationwide, and the transitional council passed a law against false online information six months later.	NO CHANGE
Kenya	An amendment bill would criminalise sharing classified information through personal messaging or email, on four classification tiers. No sponsor, stage or timetable is on file (bill). It is the only access-to-information instrument in the base, and it narrows rather than widens: the record holds no compliance figure, request statistic or enforcement action under the existing regime against which to read it.	REGRESSED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Lesotho	A 2021 capacity assessment found no access-to-information legislation in force, and nothing since records one being enacted. The assessment carried out for the Millennium Challenge Corporation and the Lesotho Millennium Development Agency found no access-to-information statute in force in September 2021 (assessment). No bill, draft or commitment to one has appeared in the base in the five years since, so the absence is a searched one at that date and an unexamined one after it.	NO CHANGE
Liberia	The telecommunications regulator continues to refuse to publish what the gateway monitoring system earns (report). The telecommunications regulator's board chairman again declined to say what the international gateway monitoring system has earned, and the dispute has acquired a legal edge (report). 2026-09-06 - the Act was enforced against agencies for the first time in the base's record: the information commission and a transparency organisation ran compliance visits from 11 August to 2 September 2026 covering the national identification registry, the statistics institute, the community empowerment agency and the water and sewer corporation, with three further agencies scheduled for 8 to 10 September. No findings, compliance scores or enforcement actions from the round are published, and it is a partnership exercise rather than a statutory inspection regime.	NO CHANGE
Libya	The cabinet's draft bill sets a request-and-appeal procedure and remains unenacted. The draft law on the national information system would give Libya a request-and-appeal route to public records. It has not been enacted. What publication happens is voluntary: the audit bureau published its 2024 annual report on 31 December 2025 after delay, with no right-to-information law compelling it. The constitutional declaration guarantees expression and privacy and creates no access right.	NO CHANGE
Madagascar	The access to information bill was left off the extraordinary session in August 2026, eight months after being presented to Parliament. A decree of 3 December 2025 presented an 88-article bill on access to public information to Parliament; its blank adoption, review and promulgation fields confirm it is not enacted (decree). The bill went to committee on 8 May 2026 with a plenary vote expected on 18 May (committee). An extraordinary session opened on 25 August 2026 with seven bills, the access bill again absent despite a committee undertaking to reinscribe it (session). No access to information law is in force.	REGRESSED
Malawi	The High Court ruled on 6 March 2026 that the Act reaches private companies performing government contracts. The statute's own text is now held: the Access to Information Act, Act 13 of 2017, assented 10 February 2017, commenced 30 September 2020 and is overseen by the Human Rights Commission. 2025-10 - the commission's own implementation report for 2024-2025 records 34 institutions trained and more than 36,000 requests processed, alongside a concept note proposing amendments for stronger enforcement. 2026-03 - the High Court held that the Act applies to private companies undertaking government contracts, which extends its reach past the public body it was drafted around. The ruling is reported rather than held as a judgment, and no appeal is on record.	MOVEMENT
Mali	The access-to-information law's implementation was evaluated in April 2026, against a 2003 decree governing relations between the administration and users. Two instruments bear on access. The older is the 2003 decree on relations between the administration and users, which sets the duty to answer. The access-to-information law itself was the subject of an evaluation of its implementation in April 2026 — an assessment of how the statute works in practice rather than an amendment to it. The publishing side moved in the same period: the statistics institute agreed an open data licence in August 2026 and ran a workshop on migrating its portal. Access to information and publication of data are advancing on separate tracks.	MOVEMENT
Mauritania	A bill on access to and use of public information is on the record from June 2026, presented as making good a presidential commitment. A press-freedom organisation welcomed the bill and asked for strengthened guarantees (bill). Nothing from the government or parliament on it is on file: no text, tabling date or parliamentary step. An advocacy organisation's welcome is the whole of what the base holds, which is the position this row records.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Mauritius	A Freedom of Information Bill was announced as in preparation in February 2026, and no draft, text or timetable has been published since. The bill was announced by the data-protection commissioner at the launch of the national data strategy (announcement). Six months on, nothing has followed. The country has a data-protection statute aligned to the European regulation and no statutory right of access to public information to sit beside it.	MOVEMENT
Morocco	Law 31-13 has been in force since 2018 and the commission it created publishes no annual reports, though its own article 22 requires them. The law was promulgated by dahir in February 2018 and created the access-to-information commission, with article 30 deferring entry into force by a year and proactive-publication duties by a further year (law). The commission publishes no annual reports despite the duty in article 22, so eight years on the base holds the statute, the institution and no measure of requests made, granted or refused under it.	NO CHANGE
Mozambique	Law 34/2014 remains the operative access-to-information statute, and the Constitutional Council struck down 18 provisions letting the regulator monitor traffic and suspend services. 2026-07-29 — the Constitutional Council declared unconstitutional 18 provisions of Decree 48/2025, which had let the telecommunications regulator monitor traffic, collect user data and suspend services without parliamentary authorisation. It removes the main legal basis for communications restrictions. 2026-05-27 — the President promulgated three laws, on social communication, broadcasting and a higher council for social communication, replacing the 1991 press framework and extending to internet-based publications. The statute itself is unmoved: Law 34/2014 on the right to information, implemented under Decree 35/2015, is still operative. No count of requests, refusals or appeals is published, so what the right delivers in practice cannot be stated.	MIXED the founding statute is untouched while a court struck down surveillance powers and a new media package replaced the 1991 framework
Namibia	The Access to Information Act 8 of 2022 is gazetted and not commenced, and no Information Commissioner has been appointed. Section 86 leaves commencement to a date determined by the minister, no commencement notice is held, and the Act runs to ten Parts and eighty-six sections whose compliance deadlines run from commencement (Act). Appointment machinery for the Commissioner and Deputy was itself gazetted in December 2024, setting five-year selection committee terms and a five-member quorum, made ahead of the Act's own commencement, so the annual report the Act requires cannot yet exist (regulations).	MOVEMENT still not commenced
Niger	The media regulator created in 2025 suspended nine foreign outlets in May 2026, while the 2011 access charter still has no implementing decree. The president signed the ordinance creating the national communication observatory on 1 September 2025, the transition-era media regulator provided for by article 71 of the founding charter and tasked with guaranteeing freedom of information and equitable access to public media. That body suspended nine French outlets on 8 May 2026 — including two international broadcasters, a news agency and two magazines — on grounds of public order, social cohesion, institutional stability and the morale of the defence and security forces. The statutory right is older and unimplemented: the 2011 charter of access to public information establishes a general right of access and an appeal route, but article 35 leaves its implementing decree to a later act that is not on record.	REGRESSED
Nigeria	Two Federal High Court judgments in the window held the Act binds an incorporated public company and overrides other disclosure laws. On 13 October 2025 the Federal High Court held the national oil company remains a public institution subject to the Act despite being a company limited by shares, and ordered disclosure of the terms of a $3 billion crude-for-cash loan. On 24 February 2026 the same court held the Act overrides other disclosure laws and regulations, ordering a public council to release data-protection policy records. The statute itself is untouched: the Act was assented on 28 May 2011 and remains in force. What moved is its reach, and by judgment rather than by amendment; no compliance report, request volume or refusal statistic is published.	MOVEMENT

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rwanda	The 2013 access law is in force and under revision, on the government's own statement to an international review in March 2026. The founding statute establishes the access right, information-officer duties and monitoring by the ombudsman (law). Rwanda confirmed at a pre-session ahead of its fourth periodic review that revision of the access law, alongside the media law, is ongoing (statement). No draft text, timetable or direction of revision is published, so what the revision would change cannot be stated from the base.	MOVEMENT
Sao Tome and Principe	There is no access-to-information statute; the constitution's three relevant articles are the whole of the national guarantee. Artigo 29 gives everyone the right freely to express and disseminate thought by word, image or any other means; Artigo 74 places on holders of political office the duty to keep citizens informed about public affairs; Artigo 76 provides that absence of publication renders laws legally ineffective (constitution). None of the three creates a request procedure, a deadline, an exemption regime, an appeal or an oversight body (constitution). Without those, a right to information is a principle rather than a route a citizen can take, and no route is held.	NO CHANGE
Senegal	Senegal's first access-to-information statute was promulgated in September 2025, its implementing decree adopted in Council in October. The law runs to five chapters and 32 articles: it vests the right in any resident natural person and any legal person established in Senegal, requires a registered written request with acknowledgement, creates a national access commission, sets criminal sanctions, leaves implementing modalities to a decree and abrogates three articles of the 2006 archives law. Article 17 requires an immediate answer and article 18 allows eight clear days where prior processing is needed. The Council of Ministers adopted the draft decree fixing the commission's organisation and functioning on 29 October 2025, alongside implementing decrees for three companion laws. That is adoption of a draft, not publication of the final decree nor installation of the commission, and the base holds no request volume or refusal statistic under the law.	MOVEMENT
Seychelles	An access-to-information reform whitepaper recommends a centralised access unit, alignment with the data-protection Act and open-reuse licensing, with drafting targeted for end-2025. The whitepaper was published in November 2025 with drafting by the attorney-general targeted for the end of that year (whitepaper). Nothing has entered the base since, so the drafting target has passed with no draft on record. The same body holds both the access and the protection mandates, which is why the whitepaper proposes aligning the two statutes rather than treating them separately.	MOVEMENT
Sierra Leone	The Right to Access Information Act 2013 is in force, and a Bill that would carry the access regime forward completed national validation in November 2025. The 2013 Act creates a right of access, a proactive publication duty with approved publication schemes, a schedule of exemptions and an oversight commission (Act). The Data Protection and Right to Access Information Bill went through nationwide consultations from September 2025 (consultations), a pre-legislative session in October (session) and final national validation in November (validation). It is not enacted and no parliamentary date is set, so the 2013 Act is the operative instrument throughout.	MOVEMENT
Somalia	The constitution has required an access-to-information law since 2012; the bill drafted in March 2024 was still before the lower house in October 2025. Article 32 of the Provisional Constitution guarantees access to state-held information and directs Parliament to enact an implementing law (constitution). Fourteen years on, none is enacted. A ministry official told a September 2025 event that Cabinet had passed the law and it awaited presentation to the lower house (event). A civil-society submission to an international review a month later recorded the March 2024 bill still before the house, criticising its broad national-security and confidentiality exemptions and its lack of independent oversight (submission).	STALLED

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
South Africa	The regulator issued a precedent-setting access-to-information enforcement notice against a private body in June 2026, the first of its kind on the record. 2026-06 — the Information Regulator issued an enforcement notice against a mining company under the access-to-information Act, which the account records as precedent-setting for private bodies. Before this window the base held no enforcement notice of any kind. It is one notice, not a series. The regulator publishes no enforcement register, and the base holds no figure for requests made, refused or appealed under the Act, so what can be said is that the power was used and not how often it is needed.	MOVEMENT
South Sudan	A technical committee was given fourteen days in January 2026 to launch an Official Gazette and clear a publication backlog of every law since 2011, and no edition is on file. The committee was formed by the President on 12 January 2026 (committee). A protocol issued the week before classifies all documents bearing the President's signature as privileged executive communication that cannot be photographed, scanned or shared online. Those two facts together are the single most consequential entry in this ledger. A country with no operating gazette and a rule against reproducing signed instruments cannot have its laws read, which is why the ICT Authority's status is unresolvable and why the cybercrime Act's text is withheld.	STALLED
Sudan	The Right to Access Information Law of 2015 is in force, and the commission it requires was never effectively established. The law was ratified by the National Assembly on 27 January 2015 and signed on 22 February. It establishes a citizen right to obtain information from public institutions, and a commission with powers to compel publication (law). Available reporting indicates the commission was never made operational, so the law's practical reach is unverified. Nothing later amends or replaces it, and no implementing regulation was located.	NO CHANGE
Tanzania	The 2016 statute is unamended, but a civic platform was suspended and a nationwide shutdown is before a regional court. The founding right-to-information statute was gazetted on 30 September 2016 and came into force on 1 July 2017, applying to mainland Tanzania only. The regulator suspended the country's leading civic discussion and whistleblowing platform for 90 days under the online content regulations in September 2025, ahead of the general election. A rights organisation filed a reference at the East African Court of Justice in December 2025 challenging the nationwide internet shutdown of 29 October to 4 November 2025 as an unlawful restriction on access to information under the regional treaty and the African Charter. No request or appeal statistics under the statute are published for any year.	REGRESSED the statute stands while access itself was suspended and shut down
Togo	The 2016 statute and its 2017 decree are in force; the 2025 international return records no oversight body operating. The 53-article statute of 30 March 2016 sets a 30-day response period, 15 days for researchers and journalists, and vests oversight in the Mediateur de la Republique rather than the broadcasting authority. Its implementing instrument, decret n 2017-104/PR of 10 August 2017, runs to 26 articles across nine chapters and confirms that arrangement. Togo's 2025 return on the international access-to-information indicator answers No to a dedicated oversight institution, to any national or subnational oversight body, and to public bodies reporting request statistics. The law is complete and the machinery behind it is not: a negative implementation finding, not a reform.	NO CHANGE
Tunisia	The 2016 statute is unamended, but its authority has had no president since 2024. Organic law 2016-22 creates the national access-to-information authority, a proactive-publication duty, request and appeal procedures and sanctions, and repeals the two 2011 decree-laws it replaced. No amendment or repeal has been located. The government confirmed in a written answer published on 1 December 2025 that the authority has operated without a president or vice-president since its nine-member council's mandate lapsed, which blocks legally valid meetings and has suspended staff allowances; the authority itself calls for urgent legislative revision. This is institutional paralysis and not amendment: no request volume, appeal outcome or compliance figure is held for any year.	REGRESSED the statute stands while its oversight authority cannot lawfully meet

COUNTRY	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Uganda	The 2005 Act is unamended, but the Constitutional Court struck down its court-records exemption while the High Court widened its privacy exemption. 2025-12 - the Constitutional Court held the Act's exemption for pre-conclusion court records unconstitutional, while upholding the judicial service commission's shortlisting discretion and the privilege of its communications. 2026-08 - the High Court went the other way on a different exemption, setting aside an order that had compelled an examinations board to release a parliamentary aspirant's examination scripts to a rival, quashing a UGX 12,000,000 damages award and treating the scripts as personal data. Both moved the statute's boundaries without amending it, and the direction is opposite in each case, which is what makes this mixed rather than advanced. No amendment bill follows either ruling on the record, and the base holds no request-and-response statistics under the Act - so whether the right of access works in practice is not something this base can say.	MIXED one exemption struck down and another widened in the same window
Zambia	The 2023 Act gained its first implementing regulations and then commission guidelines translating its duties into operational guidance. Act No. 24 of 2023 came into force on 25 June 2024, granting a citizen or residence-permit holder the right to access information held by an information holder. 2025-08-29 — Statutory Instrument No. 56 of 2025 supplied the request forms, fees and procedures needed to make the right operative — the step without which an access statute is unusable. 2025-12-05 — the rights commission issued guidelines as Government Notice No. 1624 of 2025, translating the Act's duties into operational guidance. Two years from enactment to a usable procedure is the shape of it. No count of requests made, granted or refused under the Act is published.	MOVEMENT
Zimbabwe	The Freedom of Information Act is in force, and two 2026 High Court rulings pull in opposite directions on what the section 62 right reaches. The Act of 2020, commenced on 1 July 2020, implements the section 62 constitutional right of access to information and repealed the Access to Information and Protection of Privacy Act (Act). On 24 December 2025 the High Court held that withholding the report of the commission of inquiry into urban state land sales violates section 62 and ordered its publication within 90 days (judgment). On 17 August 2026 the same court dismissed an application to compel a bank to disclose foreign-currency allocation records, holding that banking secrecy under section 76 of the Banking Act barred disclosure without the central bank's authorisation (ruling). Whether the commission report was published inside the 90 days is not held.	MIXED a court ordering publication under the constitutional right while another read a statutory secrecy provision as limiting it

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-09-10-14**
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/topics/gov-legislate/gov-legislate-progress-2026-09-10-14.pdf